

The A.A. Message in a Changing World

**THE FORTY-SECOND ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

***1992
Final Report***

Holiday Inn Crowne Plaza, New York, NY, April 26–May 2

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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses, just as A.A. directories do.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

SERVICE



42ND GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

The A.A. Message in a Changing World

"... we expect that our Conference will always try to act in the spirit of mutual respect and love—one member for another. In turn, this sign signifies that mutual trust should prevail; that no action ought to be taken in anger, haste, or recklessness; that care will be observed to respect and protect all minorities; that no action should ever be personally punitive; that whenever possible, important actions will be taken in substantial unanimity; and that our Conference will ever be prudently on guard against tyrannies, great or small, whether these be found in the majority or in the minority."

Following the calling of the role, these words, of A.A. co-founder Bill Wilson in Concept XII, were read to the 42nd General Service Conference by G.S.O.'s general manager George Dorsey.

The 42nd General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous in the United States and Canada was held at the Holiday Inn Crowne Plaza, New York City, April 26–May 2. The 134 members who make up the General Service Conference consist of delegates from the 91 service areas, Class A (nonalcoholic) and Class B (alcoholic) trustees, and directors and staff of the two corporations—A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. This year's Conference was co-chaired by Michael Alexander, chairman of the General Service Board, and George Dorsey, G.S.O.'s general manager. G.S.O. staff member Pat Rosenstiel was Conference coordinator.

Conference week began Sunday morning with opening remarks by Michael Alexander, the roll call, and a general orientation for the week ahead. In the afternoon the Conference body gathered for greetings from the delegate chairperson, Rod Brown, of Iowa (see p. 6), and the keynote address, by general service trustee Desmond Towey (see p. 7).

The Conference opening dinner was held Sunday evening in the hotel's Broadway Ballroom, attended not only by Conference members and their guests, but also by appointed committee members, past trustees and staff members, G.S.O. employees, and volunteers, freelancers and vendors who work with us throughout the year. Dinner was followed by an A.A. meeting, chaired by Jude Tims, delegate from Northeast Texas and chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee. Jimmy Downes, Southeast New York, led the meeting. Speakers were Hugh Freyer, A.A.W.S. director; Maxine Miller, Western Pennsylvania; Don Huff, Utah; Jackie Martin, Southeast regional trustee; and Richard Bush, G.S.O. staff.

Monday morning's general session began with reports from the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. Board and the Grapevine Corporate Board, followed by the chairpersons of each trustees' committee. Then Conference members went to the joint meetings of the trustees' and Conference committees.

Monday evening General Service Board trustees Michael Alexander, Robert Morse and Desmond Towey gave a presentation "A.A.: Past, Present and Future," in which they reported that the board had been giving thought to a plan to, on a nine month experimental basis, relieve the A.A.W.S. Board of responsibility for the oversight of the general service work of the General Service Office, with the thought that this would give the A.A.W.S. Board time to concentrate on the production and distribution of literature. It was suggested that Conference members consider the matter for three days and that a "sense of the Conference" be taken on Friday as to how to proceed. After much floor discussion, this suggestion was referred to the Conference Agenda Committee for discussion and recommendation, which ultimately resulted in Advisory Action #8. The presentation "Advisory Action #32: Merit Pay," given by trustee Phil Cels on Thursday evening, resulted in Floor Action #1.

Wednesday afternoon Conference delegates elected two regional trustees. Gerry Flegel, of Humboldt, Saskatchewan, will

be the new Western Canada trustee, replacing Phil Cels; Les Leuthaeuser, of Scottsbluff, Nebraska, replaces rotating Don Bruner as West Central/U.S. trustee. Fran Polek, of Spokane, Washington, is the new general service trustee, replacing Desmond Towey. Fran, who becomes the first general service trustee from outside of the greater New York area, has served as a Grapevine director for the past four years.

Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee Joan Jackson, Ph.D., rotated off the board at the end of the 42nd Conference after nine years of service to the Fellowship. The Conference Nominating Committee recommended, and the General Service Board approved, the appointment of Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D. to fill the Class A opening. Elaine, of Catonsville, Maryland, is acting administrator of the Alcohol, Drug Abuse and Mental Health Administration.

Every morning the General Service Conference Serenity Group held an open A.A. meeting; the topic was based on the reading for the day from *Daily Reflections*. In the tradition of self-support, the G.S.C. Serenity Group turned over \$260. to G.S.O.

Activities throughout the week included presentation/discussion periods (see p. 14) and area service highlights by new Panel 42 delegates (see page 45). A delegates' meeting and dinner was held Tuesday evening, where Elaine Strome, Alberta/Northwest Territories, was elected delegate chairperson for the 1993 Conference; alternate delegate chair will be Michel Girard, Northwest Quebec. Four "What's On Your Mind?" sharing sessions during the week addressed, among many topics: ways and means of handling delegate mail from G.S.O. in a more efficient and economical way; the presentation "A.A.: Past, Present and Future"; use of the AS 400 computer; A.A. literature pricing; and the computerized A.A. Birthday Plan.

The major work of the Conference takes place during the meetings and deliberations of the eleven standing Conference committees. Delegates review background material on items forwarded to them from their corresponding trustees' committees, and the resulting committee recommendations are presented to the entire Conference for a vote. Most of these recommendations result in Conference Advisory Actions (see p. 10). Committees often discuss other matters which do not result in Actions, and these may be found on page 52.

Closing brunch on Saturday morning began with the laughter and humor found any place sober alcoholics gather. Then it was time for the closing talks from rotating trustees. For sentimental reasons, Joan Jackson wore the blue suit and white blouse she had worn when she was appointed to the board in 1983. Joan's involvement in the field of alcoholism began in 1951, when she was given a grant to study alcoholism and received much help, support and experience from A.A. and Al-Anon members. Being invited to stand as trustee, Joan said, "began the most meaningful phase of my life. After I've been dropped off the end of the world, I'm going to remember you."

Rotating general service trustee Desmond Towey, was next. Desmond said he had asked a former trustee what happened after rotation, and was told, "Your hair and nails continue to grow, but your phone arm falls off." Serving as trustee, Des said, had given him the opportunity to "understand the Fellowship in a different way," and that, in turn, had enabled him to "grow up and view everything in a different way."

"A.A. gave me back my life, dignity, and self-respect," said Don Bruner, adding that three of his four children and one son-in-law are now sober. He told the Conference that the following week he and his wife, Marian, would be celebrating their 50th wedding anniversary, and "this would not have been possible without all of you. I've learned not to say goodbye in A.A. So long, I'll see you another time."

Phil Cels, Western Canada, admitted to always having a weird



Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

I extend a heart-filled welcome to all of you. The week before us offers many challenges. The many long hours and variety of experiences will form the outcome of this Conference. An open mind and hard work in our various committees will produce many spiritual experiences; the friendships made and many memories will be everlasting.

"The A.A. Message in a Changing World," our theme this year, will challenge us to the limit. The A.A. message has not, and hopefully will not ever, change. What is the message this Conference wants to take back to the Fellowship? Love and service should permeate our every thought and action. We try to carry this same message to the new member of Alcoholics Anonymous. Here are some of my ideas on the A.A. message in a changing world.

In the very beginning of A.A. in Akron, Ohio, temporary sponsor and contact people were assigned calls for help. Sometimes the contacts themselves were only a few days sober. Twelve-Step work is sometimes thought to be a dying art. Sponsorship and our good example will restore this life-saving action. Sponsorship was vital to my early recovery and very first A.A. meeting.

mind, except "now it is not working against me." Basically Phil said he just showed up, not knowing who he was, and "walked and served with good people and began a journey of incredible proportion in my life."

Actually, that is what every alcoholic in that room did, each in their own way—just showed up and became willing to listen and seek information, to trust in the experience of those in the room before them, and to begin to accumulate their own personal experience, strength and hope. After a week of pros and cons, dissent, open sharing, differing viewpoints, talking problems through, it all came together—just as it does in our groups. At the end, as always, the group conscience of Alcoholics Anonymous was expressed through A.A.'s one ultimate authority—a loving God, as we understand Him.

The A.A. message travels very quickly today; through telephones and faxes and by overnight mail. The old saying that bad news travels fast also applies today. We as Conference members have great, impatient demands for information from our Fellowship. Can we be positive examples of the Conference process? The information given back in our areas should not be opinions but rather our shared experience of the Conference. The Concepts inform us that we cannot recommend every move of the General Service Office.

The Conference process has worked for more than 41 years. The committee system has the greatest strength through its informed members. Trust the process and always remember that the Higher Power is really in charge. Let us be the channel of information, not the source. The God of my understanding has always been with me. I must remember to ask for His strength and courage and that His will be done during this week.

Rod Brown (Iowa)
delegate chairperson

Keynote Address

The relevance of the topic, "A.A.'s Message in a Changing World" is that it underscores by contrast the timelessness and unchanging essence of A.A.'s message of recovery. That message is none other than the one experienced more than 50 years ago by Bill when he was spiritually awakened in Town's Hospital and then went on to carry that message to Dr. Bob in Akron, Ohio. That message is the profound spiritual transformation that helps us stay away from a drink one day at a time.

I ask you to reflect on the profound conversion that took place in your own life. How did you receive the message? What enabled you to change? Bill quotes William James in saying that this type of conversion is not uncommon but we must be in the throes of a life-threatening situation; we must admit powerlessness; and we must request help from a Power greater than ourselves. In those circumstances overcoming the impossible becomes the ordinary. It was under the guidance of the God of our understanding that Bill then found another drunk to whom he carried the message. That message is the laser beam by which the world knows that recovery from the unrecoverable is possible.

It is to carry the A.A. message of recovery that the A.A. service structure has been developed. To carry the message effectively and efficiently, we must work within mutual trust, confidence and, to be sure, unity. Hence, A.A.'s Three Legacies of: Recovery, Service and Unity. In a very real sense then, we are talking about recovery in a changing world, service in a changing world, and unity in a changing world.

Change is the constant of life. It is that sometimes unwelcome intruder that forces us to change plans, rewrite the letter, alter a fixed opinion. For example, many of us come to Conference with certain fixed opinions about things on the agenda. It is an ego-deflating experience to submit those fixed "stars" to the chewing process that will go on over the next week. It is a sign of our resiliency, openness and flexibility, however, if we allow the Spirit to blow where it will. We thereby arrive at proper decisions and actions in the best interests of carrying the message to a world that needs it.

Change has been difficult for me. My experience of working on the book *Daily Reflections* is illustrative. I vehemently opposed the book and spoke against it on the floor of the Conference the year the idea was introduced. I felt it duplicated many other books. The Advisory Action authorizing work on the book passed. With typical A.A. irony I was promptly appointed to the subcommittee to proceed with what became our reflections book. The first thing I did was buy every other competitive book. Much to my surprise, none of them would fill the bill as well as ours would. My next task then became convincing Jan Kelly Williamson, my fellow committee member and a trustee, that the book was a good idea. The book was completed in time to be read at her funeral last year. The rest is history.

There is a different vocabulary in today's self-help world. There is dysfunction, codependency, A.C.O.A. issues and all the rest. All this appears to run interference with our message of recovery. Or does it? Do we say, Isn't it too bad that roses have thorns, or do we wonder in gratitude that thorns have roses? How can we use these changes to further our miraculous message? That is the challenge that lies before us. This week, day by day, as the seeds we sow germinate and extend their roots throughout the world, we need to ride the winds of change with joy. We must hold on to the message but not so tightly as to become reactionaries who try to codify recovery and make it a cult, ritual or religion.

The composition of the Fellowship itself has changed. Our studies show more people addicted to drugs, more women and

more young people. Rather than complain that there are so many different kinds of alcoholics in A.A. today—high bottom, low bottom, young, old, white, black, yellow, dually addicted, cross addicted, singly addicted—we can rejoice that the house of A.A. is built upon such a rock of sober experience that it can withstand the tremors caused by such diversity.

Once again, change is not to be feared provided we stick to the essence of our recovery message. Fear is the product of the need to control and the impossibility of doing so. Once we admit that it is out of our control, beyond our control, and accept the fact that it is in the hands of the God of our understanding, then we can move forward and begin to make inroads into other areas as yet darkened to the A.A. message. Today we have the benefit of the Steps, the Traditions and the Conference. Our predecessors didn't have these guideposts. They were forged "on the anvil of experience." Once we have accepted the unchanging nature of our collective experience and the contemporary relevance of that experience, then we no longer need be afraid. Confident of our identity, we can look outside of ourselves and continue the process and allow that message to flow through us. As a young woman sober one year told me the other night, "It's really important to me to know that you have 20 years of sober experience. The fact that this program has given you the power not to pick up the first drink for so long is awesome." Incidentally, that newcomer later stated she was an alcoholic, addicted to drugs and a homosexual.

Recovery and service are so closely interwoven that it sometimes makes us silly, especially at the Conference or other service functions. We may experience what I'm going to speak about at this Conference. The role here is to discuss and find ways to carry A.A.'s message more efficiently and more effectively in a changing world. Unless we are living the message of recovery in our service life, the message is truncated and diminished. A leader leads by example. We serve merely to get the channels clear, make sure the system functions with a minimum of static. We need to have an ever outward looking perspective focusing on the needs of people who have to hear the message; who have to be reinforced in the message; who have to receive what they need from us. Are medallions important? I don't know the answer. Are birthday plans necessary? Is a change in reporting procedures necessary? What do people in need of recovery need? Sometimes, instead of looking outward we at the Conference begin to look inward at the need to not let this process end; to not let this exchange between each other end; to not let our experience of being with each other end.

I sometimes think that we, this small group of privileged people at this Conference, allow ourselves to be distracted by minutia, by procedural discussions, by seemingly inconsequential red herrings. Why? Because we don't want it to end. Because the experience of being here is good. The experience of sharing with another alcoholic is the most profound experience in my life and in your life. At the same time there are people dying in the streets out there. The need to be with each other needs to be tempered by the outward focus of what those who are in need of recovery need. And how can we get them what they need? We need to develop a method and prepare better presentations. We need to move away from the fear.

Vision is the ability to make good estimates both for the near term and for the future. It is the ability to see and stretch beyond where we are today so that we may arrive at tomorrow and be prepared to be there. In the not too distant future, all the living links with our founders will also disappear. A.A., in a very real sense, will be cut loose on its own to face the challenges of carrying a timeless message to a culture that deals in ten-second sound bites, instant gratification, seemingly hopeless poverty and

cultural diversity. We will be forced to come to grips with elements of orthodoxy versus adaptability; ritual versus substance; regionalism versus balance.

We have, in our arsenal, an incredibly powerful weapon, for carrying the message through all of this. That tool is anonymity. For us, the principle of anonymity is immensely important. We must place principles before personalities and practice humility. The Twelfth Tradition asks that our blessings not spoil us and that we "forever live in thankful contemplation of Him who presides over us all." This is jet fuel. The Big Book tells us that our stories are not glorious ones but ones of consummate degradation made whole by the healing power of A.A. and the saving grace of God.

Jan Kelly Williamson used to say that the worst thing about rotating from being a trustee is that you would no longer be special. When I first came to the program, I wanted to be anything other than a plain, ordinary alcoholic. I wanted to be a special kind. I wished I were cross addicted or paranoid—anything but an ordinary alcoholic. In an article written in 1955 and reprinted in the *Best of the Grapevine*, Harry Tiebout, M.D. speaks about the meaning of anonymity, and says that, "Its practice results in the preservation of a reduced ego, and second, the continued presence of humility or humbleness." Bill tells us that his ego took a hell of a licking in the recovery process. Anonymity is of

such importance to our Fellowship that it is the subject of Bill's last message to us. We are challenged to practice this principle in all our affairs. The challenge here today and for this week is to practice it during the Conference. We're talking here about ego deflation and the principle of anonymity. We are here to contribute to the enhanced consciousness and growth of the miracle of recovery through our unified service structure. We are the vessels through which the spirit of unity, recovery, and service is speaking. Ask yourself, what does what I'm saying have to do with carrying the message? In that same attitude, Tiebout goes on to say, "The self as nothing is not easily developed. It runs counter to all our desires for identity, for apparently meaningful existence; one with hope and promise. To be nothing seems a form of psychological suicide. We cling to our somethingness with all our strength at our command. The thought of being nothing is simply not acceptable, but the fact that the person who does not learn to be nothing cannot feel that he is but a plain, ordinary, everyday kind of person who merges with the human race, and as such, is humble, lost in the crowd and essentially anonymous. When that can happen, the individual has a lot going for him. People with nothing on their minds can relax and go about their business quietly with a minimum of fuss and bother. They can even enjoy life as it comes along. In A.A., this is called the 24 Hour Program."

A.A.'s circle and triangle reminds me of the Zen symbol for man as he strives to achieve growth, happiness and basic humanity. It is a circle (for nothingness) encompassed in a square (limitations). Man as nothingness with limitations. Inside that circle for A.A. is the triangle of Recovery, Unity and Service. Paradoxically, from that posture, everything is possible. The closer we as individuals get to the nothingness of anonymity, the freer and more joyful is life. The closer our Fellowship gets to the principle of anonymity, the more unified we are in recovery and service and the more limitless are the boundaries for carrying the message. If you are nothing, you have nothing to lose by simply being sober. From this posture we can surely ride winds of change and allow them to fill our sails.

J. Desmond Towey, general service trustee



Workshop

Sunday Conference members split up into groups of 12 to 14 for a workshop discussion based on the Conference theme, "The A.A. Message in a Changing World." Following are the workshop questions and a summary of the report backs.

1 What message is the group and its members giving the newcomer when she or he arrives?

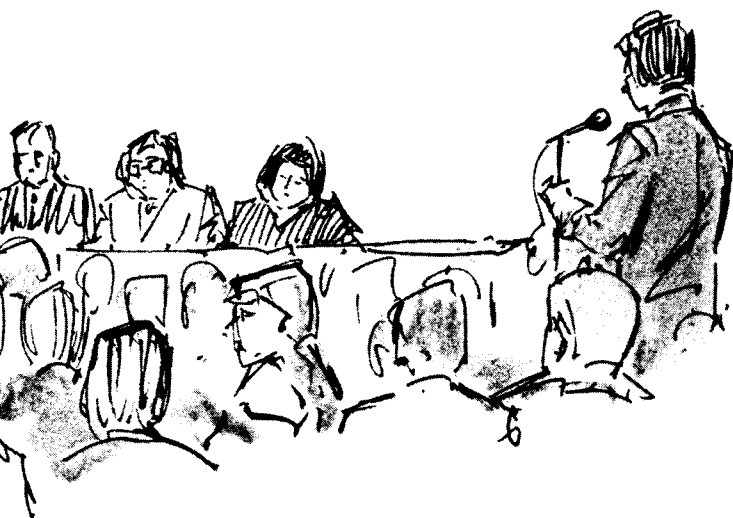
On the whole, the message "seems to be stronger," thanks to plenty of Beginners, Step and Tradition meetings, plus the use of the Big Book, and periodic group inventories, but also because many groups specifically keep an eye out for newcomers to help them feel a warm welcome. Members must understand that, to newcomers, "Actions speak louder than words." Greeters and beginners' kits help. Many groups take meetings to institutions.

The message becomes diluted when talk revolves around "other drugs"; confusing when non-A.A. approved material is also available. Newcomers should be "gently steered" to understanding A.A.'s primary purpose. Many groups use the blue card. In the long run, "Basic A.A." is what works best, freely offered with lots of hope, patience and tolerance.

2 Why are so many oldtimers leaving A.A.?

Are they really leaving or only spread thinner because of the rapid and huge influx of newcomers? There is talk of "underground" meetings and the perception exists that many oldtimers have stopped going to regular meetings for a variety of reasons—their dislike for the use of profanity, as well as their belief that A.A.'s singleness of purpose is too often being ignored and the discussion of other problems too much condoned.

Whatever the case, the consensus was that oldtimers' experience, strength and hope are needed for group health and viability. Moreover, many groups are already actively engaged in keeping their oldtimers active by: giving them rides (many can't drive at night); asking them to speak; having them serve on panels and workshops; designating in directories and meeting lists where oldtimers meet.



3 How does the group stay focused on our A.A. message while being faced with many kinds of "outside influences," such as treatment facilities, other "recovery" literature, open discussion meetings in which non-A.A.s share, etc.?

"Structured groups, in which the Steps, Traditions and the Big Book are routinely studied, stay focused better than unstructured groups," was how one participant summed up this question. The general feeling was that there has been an improvement in group focus during the past year, due in part to the taking of periodic group inventories; the use of the blue card as an aid to group unity; and a renewed emphasis on their "singleness of purpose."

Group vigilance in electing "solid A.A. chairmen" is another factor that contributes to group focus. Others include taking regular meetings to rehabs so that the A.A. program can be "shown by example." Newcomers from treatment centers should be taught A.A. "language and principles" as soon as they start coming to meetings.

4 What can be done to make sure that the hand of A.A. is still there for our children and grandchildren who might have a problem with alcohol?

Since "we are responsible that 'the message' remains 'the A.A. message,'" the best way to do this is to "stick with the Big Book, the Steps and Traditions." Several stressed the "vital role" of strong group chairmen, keeping G.S.R.s fully informed, scheduling periodic Traditions workshops, and reading from time to time the long-form of the Traditions. A commitment to service should be continuously shown by actively engaged members—from the group level to scheduled panels on service at conferences and assemblies.

A.A.'s hand can also be extended in the form of literature distribution in schools and libraries. "Put oldtimers with newcomers and build a bridge to the future," one delegate said, always emphasizing dedication, personal commitment, group conscience and service.

5 Are we as groups extending the hand of A.A. to all who suffer from alcoholism—minorities, handicapped, different cultures, etc.?

Many expressed the opinion that "we could do better" in this area, though progress has been noted on various fronts: there is more signing for the hearing impaired and more translation problems are being addressed. However, lack of awareness and communication problems persist in many cases.

More attention should be directed to specific needs: make sure facilities are prepared for access by the physically challenged; arrange for signing, whenever it is necessary; hold meetings by telephone for those physically unable to attend; invite a blind member or one in a wheelchair to speak at a meeting; set up special needs committees; take an interpreter with you when speaking to a non-English speaking group; eliminate racial and ethnic jokes; become more sensitive to the "unique" cultural differences which need to be understood before our common A.A. experience can be shared.

"They really cater to drunks in this hotel," observed Jimmy Downes (Southeast New York) at the opening A.A. meeting. "They have a rack by the door so the drunk can hold on. They put towels on it, but I know what it's for."

Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole, or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the Conference.

FLOOR ACTIONS

It was recommended that:

- 1** The general manager of the General Service Office and the Alcoholics Anonymous World Services Board devise an equitable system of pay for the G.S.O. staff that embraces the spiritual principles of Concept XI and complies with all applicable laws.
- 2** The trustees' Committee on Literature develop material on Service Sponsorship to be forwarded to the 43rd General Service Conference Committee on Report and Charter for possible inclusion in *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- 3** A feasibility study be undertaken by the General Service Board of all possible methods by which sobriety chips/medallions may be made available to the A.A. Fellowship; and that:
 - a) The study culminate in a report to an ad hoc committee of 1993 Conference delegates.
 - b) The report presented to the ad hoc committee also be mailed to all 1993 Conference members by March 15, 1993.
 - c) The ad hoc committee be charged with bringing forward a recommendation to the 1993 Conference reporting their conclusions.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 4** The format of the A.A. meeting following the Opening Dinner of the 1993 General Service Conference be as follows: the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be chair of the meeting, with his or her duties limited to introducing the meeting leader and monitoring the time allotted by means of a light-timer system; and the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be leader of the meeting, introducing five speakers: one Class B trustee, two delegates, and two other A.A. members alternating from among the A.A. staff, Grapevine staff, archivist, and corporate boards.
- 5** The theme for the 1993 General Service Conference be: A.A. Takes Its Inventory—The General Service Conference Structure.
- 6** The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1993 General Service Conference:
 - a) A.A. Takes Its Inventory
 - 1 The Purpose of the General Service Conference
 - 2 The Conference Relation to A.A.
 - 3 The General Service Conference and Its General Procedures
 - b) A.A. Takes Its Inventory
 - 1 Conference Relation to the General Service Board and Its Corporate Services
 - 2 The General Service Board: Composition, Jurisdiction, Responsibilities
 - c) The General Warranties of the Conference

d) A.A. Takes Its Inventory: Finance

e) A.A. Takes Its Inventory: The Grapevine

7 There be two workshops for the 1993 General Service Conference: one workshop to be on the Conference theme with the focus to be on the other six articles of the Conference Charter; and another workshop to be titled "A Vision for Us—Where Are We and Where Are We Going?" with questions to be gathered from the Fellowship.

8 The proposal of the General Service Board to directly manage A.A.W.S./G.S.O. on an experimental basis for nine months not be implemented.

9 Members of a Conference Committee be informed as soon as practical after it becomes known that an item will be on the agenda of their Conference Committee, rather than waiting until January.

10 The 1993 Conference Agenda Committee investigate the possibility of forming an ad hoc committee similar in intent to the inventory committee proposed by Area 36 in their April 7, 1992 letter.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

11 The revised pamphlet "A.A. as a Resource for the Healthcare Professional" be approved, replacing "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession," because of the need to include information for all healthcare professionals.

12 The following changes be made in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" when reprinted:

a) Delete the words "self-help" in two places.

b) Change the second sentence, third paragraph on page 5 to read "Consequently, while we welcome the opportunity to share our principles and methods with others, only they can provide the essential ingredient for success: their common bond."

13 The Preamble, Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions be added to all C.P.C. pamphlets when reprinted, to provide consistent and uniform information.

14 The following paragraph be added to all C.P.C. pamphlets when reprinted, to provide consistent and uniform information:

"Many local A.A. service committees will, upon request, provide informational presentations for your organization. Sessions can be tailored to meet your needs. A typical agenda might include one or several A.A. films and a presentation by one or more A.A. members on 'What A.A. Is and What It Is Not.'

"Please check your local telephone directory or newspaper for the number of Alcoholics Anonymous."

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

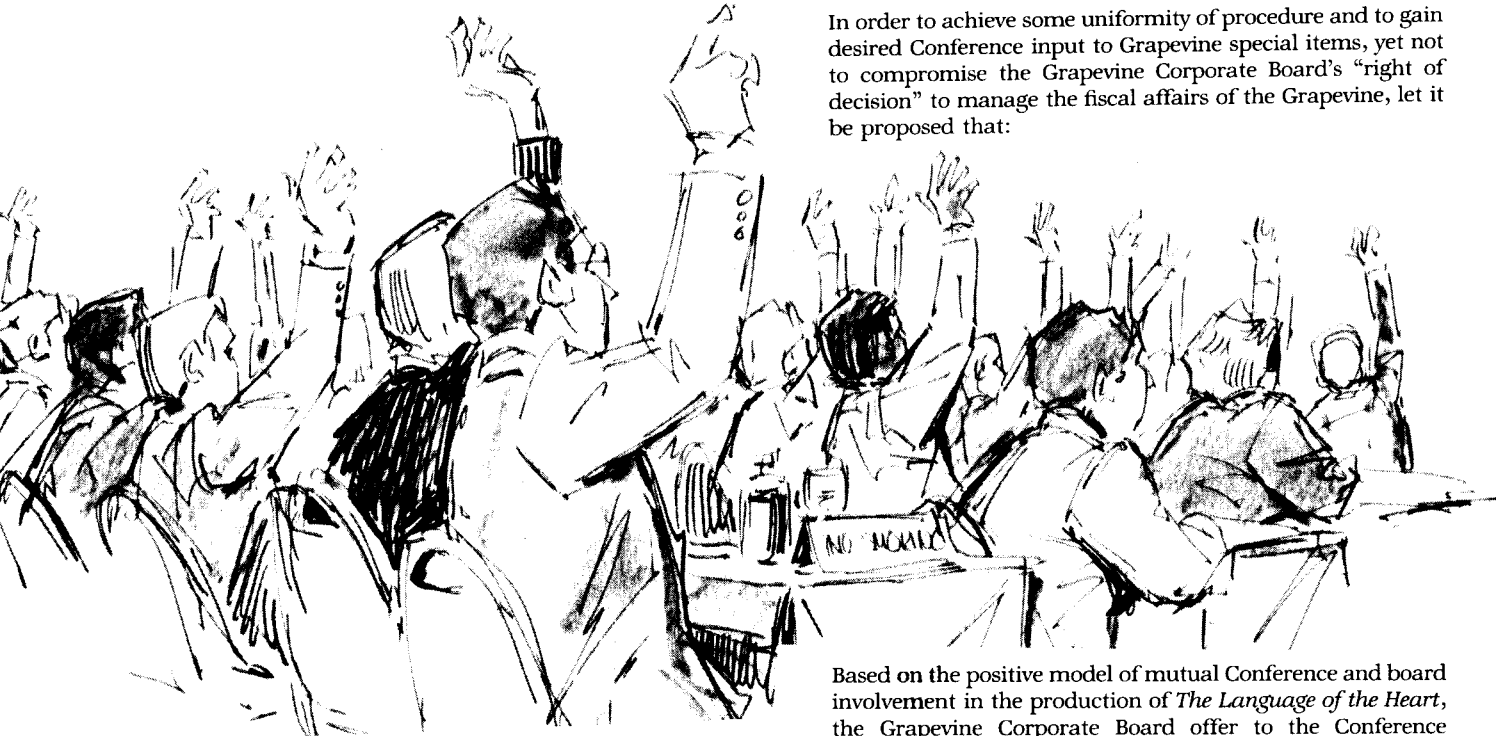
15 The Correctional Facilities Workbook be published in a soft-cover format and be enclosed in a folder which would include the appropriate pamphlets and A.A. Guidelines. The committee felt it would allow more versatility for the use of the Workbook within correctional facilities and would result in annual cost savings of \$3,400.

16 The Correctional Facilities Directory be discontinued. It was felt by the committee that there is no viable service provided to inmates and the Directory serves no purpose to warrant the annual expenditure of \$5,600.

17 The following paragraph be included in the pamphlets "A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators" and "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" when reprinted:

"Many local A.A. service committees will, upon request, provide informational presentations for your organization. Sessions can be tailored to meet your needs. A typical agenda might include one or several A.A. films and a presentation by one or more A.A. members on 'What A.A. Is and What It Is Not.'

"Please check your local telephone directory or newspaper for the number of Alcoholics Anonymous."



FINANCE

It was recommended that:

18 The new computer monitored Happy Birthday Contribution Plan instituted in 1991 be discontinued immediately and that any data-base of A.A. members' names and addresses, together with sobriety birthday dates, that may have been created be destroyed.

19 The financial statements presented to the Fellowship do not show allocation of expenses between various funds and entities until the basis of such allocations can be justified.

20 The term "Shortfall of group services supported by group contributions" not be used until the basis of allocations resulting in the amount shown as shortfall can be justified.

21 The request that contributions to the General Service Office from conferences, conventions, and roundups be limited to the maximum amount an individual may contribute in a given year be forwarded to the 1993 Conference Finance Committee, as there was insufficient information, and that there be input from the areas prior to any action.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

22 After review of 1991 Conference Advisory Action #12:

- a) The Grapevine continue to include at least one article in Spanish in each month's issue.
- b) As a possible future replacement for the monthly Spanish articles in the magazine, the Grapevine Corporate Board investigate the feasibility of developing a quarterly Spanish newsletter based on original material and translations of current Grapevine articles, and bring cost and format proposals to the 1993 Conference Grapevine Committee.

23 The following proposal from the Grapevine Corporate Board be accepted:

In order to achieve some uniformity of procedure and to gain desired Conference input to Grapevine special items, yet not to compromise the Grapevine Corporate Board's "right of decision" to manage the fiscal affairs of the Grapevine, let it be proposed that:

Based on the positive model of mutual Conference and board involvement in the production of *The Language of the Heart*, the Grapevine Corporate Board offer to the Conference Grapevine Committee, on an ongoing basis, a general list of proposed special items at least two years in advance of possible production in order that the Conference should offer any guidance or register any disapproval they might have. Having so presented the conceptual basis of these special items to the Conference Committee, final approval for the completed items would rest with the Grapevine Corporate Board.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

24 The story of "John" (a young person who entered A.A. while in prison) be added to the pamphlet "Young People and A.A." as per the 1991 Conference Action.

25 The 1986 Advisory Actions (listed below) pertaining to sexist language in the Big Book and other Bill W. writings adequately address the issue:

- #31. "As the preface to the Big Book clearly states that the text was written in 1939 and that it has not been changed, no further explanation regarding out-of-date

phrases and/or gender-oriented pronouns or chapter titles is necessary.”

- #35. “The A.A.W.S. editorial staff continue to degenderize A.A. literature, with the exception of Bill W.’s writings, as the items are reprinted, e.g., ‘staffing the booth’ rather than ‘manning the booth,’ etc.”

26 In lieu of a moratorium on new literature, the ongoing Literature Advisory Subcommittee composed of trustees, delegates and G.S.O. staff continue to review in-depth all current and proposed Conference-approved material and service pieces to assure that:

- a) we discourage unnecessary duplication;
- b) we encourage that our singleness of purpose is foremost;
- c) we encourage simplification wherever possible.

and report back to the 1993 General Service Conference.

27 The Twelve Concepts for World Service (short form) be included in all service pamphlets, wherever feasible.

28 The six-point definition of an A.A. group be removed from all literature and replaced by the long form of Tradition Three and a section of Warranty Six, Concept XII (listed below):

Tradition Three:

“Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover. Nor ought A.A. membership ever depend upon money or conformity. Any two or three alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group, provided that, as a group, they have no other affiliation.”

Warranty Six:

“. . . much attention has been drawn to the extraordinary liberties which the A.A. Traditions accord to the individual member and to his group: no penalties to be inflicted for nonconformity to A.A. principles; no fees or dues to be levied—voluntary contributions only; no member to be expelled from A.A.—membership always to be the choice of the individual; each A.A. group to conduct its internal affairs as it wishes—it being merely requested to abstain from acts that might injure A.A. as a whole; and finally that any group of alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group provided that, *as a group*, they have no other purpose or affiliation.”

29 The trustees’ Literature Committee review the terminology of “minorities” and consider that our singleness of purpose is carrying the message to *alcoholics*.

30 The new A.A. History Book manuscript be returned to the 1992 Conference Literature Committee for further review, and then forwarded to the 1993 Conference Literature Committee.

POLICY / ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

31 The alternate delegate from Area 30, Eastern Massachusetts, Bob McElroy, be seated as a Conference member in place of the delegate, Ronald Gauthier, who is unable to attend.

32 The Annual Conference Questionnaire be reviewed in the future by the Conference Committee on Agenda, instead of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

33 The 45th General Service Conference be held April 30–May 6,

1995, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

34 A revised, amplified form “Application for Additional Delegate Area” be approved.

35 The Conference review in April of the same year any request for a new Delegate Area submitted to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee by January 1st of that year.

36 Final Conference Committee agendas be automatically sent to all Conference members no later than March 15 each year.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

37 The 1992 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire be changed as follows:

- a) Add item “f” to Question #3: “this is my first A.A. meeting.”
- b) Revise item “1” of Question #5 to read: “Newspaper, magazine, radio or TV.”
- c) Change Question #9 to read: “Do you belong to an A.A. Home Group?”
- d) Revise item “a” of Question #10 to read: “Do you have a sponsor?”
- e) Change item “b” of Question #10 to read: “Did you get a sponsor within 90 days of coming to A.A.?”

38 That Question #14, “In addition to your alcoholism, were you addicted to drugs?” be removed from the 1992 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire because the question:

- a) emphasizes problems other than alcohol;
- b) has a tendency to lead to disunity;
- c) could be construed as conflicting with our primary purpose.

39 The 1992 Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis, as was done in the 1989 Membership Survey.

40 The video directed to young alcoholics be approved for distribution with one editing change: delete the segment at approximately 3 minutes, 23 seconds of the tape run that appears to show a drug transaction during a street scene; and add the anonymity disclaimer that appears at the beginning of the video to the closing credits.

41 The outline for an ongoing Traditions Communications Program not be developed. This project does not fall within the Scope of the Conference Public Information Committee, does not appear to be covered by the Scope of the trustees’ Public Information Committee, and does not respond to an expressed need.

42 All materials already developed for the Traditions Communications Program be available to future Conference committees that may wish to consider utilizing some or all of this information.

43 The six-segment Public Service Announcement directed to teens and seniors, produced by three California Area Assemblies, be approved with the tag line changed to read:

“Alcoholics Anonymous—look us up in the phone book, or check your newspaper.”

44 Future audio-visual proposals be reviewed by the appropriate Conference committee prior to expenditure commitments to

insure maximum economy and communication within the Fellowship.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

45 The "Procedures for Election of Class A Trustees," previously approved by the General Service Board, be added verbatim to *The A.A. Service Manual*.

46 A reference to the "gray pages" of the Grapevine on page S134 of *The A.A. Service Manual* be eliminated in compliance with 1991 Advisory Action #11.

47 The words "(or a vocal majority)" from line 19, page S80 of *The A.A. Service Manual*, be deleted.

48 The third sentence, first paragraph, page S81 of *The A.A. Service Manual* be changed to read "To take care of that situation, the Charter provides that, as a matter of tradition, a two-thirds vote of Conference members voting shall be considered binding upon the General Service Board and its related corporate services, provided the total vote constitutes at least a Conference quorum."

TREATMENT FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

49 The six points defining an A.A. group in the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" be deleted, and that the definition of a group in the pamphlet be consistent with the definition of a group in the "A.A. Group" pamphlet.

50 The following paragraph be added to pamphlets directed to treatment facilities professionals to provide them with as much information as possible:

"Many local A.A. service committees will, upon request, provide informational presentations for your organization. Sessions can be tailored to meet your needs. A typical agenda

might include one or several A.A. films and a presentation by one or more A.A. members on 'What A.A. Is and What It Is Not.'

"Please check your local telephone directory or newspaper for the number of Alcoholics Anonymous."

51 The following sentence of the third paragraph on page 1 of the "Bridging the Gap" pamphlet be removed from all subsequent printings as the Membership Survey is not specifically related to the temporary contact program: "Responses to questions in the most recent Membership Survey indicate that approximately 50% of those coming to A.A. for the first time leave within three months."

52 The words "temporary sponsor" and "sponsorship" on pages 8 and 13 of the "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" pamphlet be replaced with the words "temporary contact(s)" when the current supply is depleted, to reflect current A.A. terminology.

53 A.A.W.S. retain a three-ring binder format for the Treatment Facilities Workbook.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

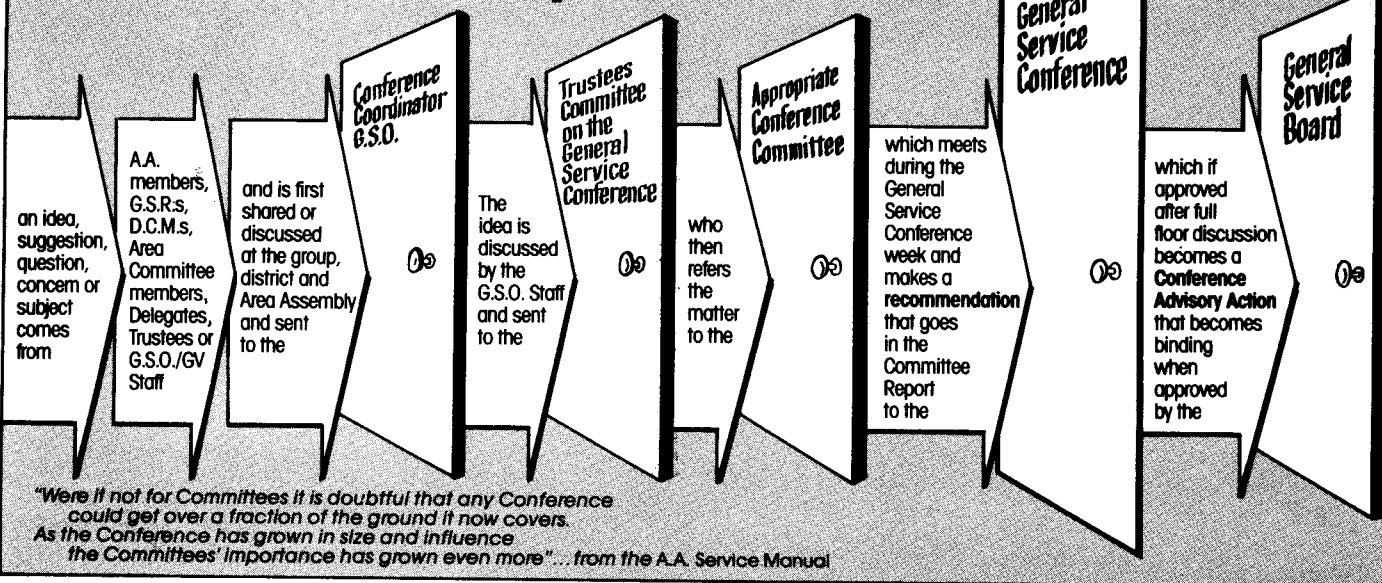
54 The slate of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in May 1992 (see page 37; the Conference and board approved the slate approved by the trustees' Nominating Committee).

55 The slate of directors be elected to the A.A. World Services Corporate Board (see page 37; slate of directors approved).

56 The slate of directors be elected to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board (see page 37; slate of directors approved).

57 Delegates who become chairpersons of Conference committees, and the delegate chairperson, continue to be invited to attend the quarterly board weekend/General Service Board meeting prior to the General Service Conference.

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



Presentations Address Timely Issues

THE A.A. MESSAGE IN A CHANGING WORLD

Presentations played an augmented role in the 1992 Conference. The first presentation session got under way at 10:45 a.m. Monday with moderator John J. Quinn, trustee-at-large/U.S., at the helm. The subject was the 1992 Conference theme, The A.A. Message in a Changing World.

Our Common Welfare

The long form of Tradition One states that "Each member of Alcoholics Anonymous is but a small part of a great whole. A.A. must continue to live or most of us will surely die. Hence our common welfare comes first. But individual welfare follows close afterward." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 189)

And in *The Language of the Heart*, Bill writes, "Tradition One asks us to place the common good ahead of personal desire." (p. 93) He continues later in this same text, "This really means that our personal ambitions will have to be set aside every time they conflict with the safety or the effectiveness of our Fellowship. It means that we must sometimes love our Society more than ourselves." (p. 317)

When I arrived at the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous, my welfare came first. The whole world revolved around me. If it didn't pertain to me, I wasn't interested. I wanted meetings to be held at times and in places that were convenient for me. I wanted the chairperson to select a topic that addressed the Step

or dilemma that faced me at the moment.

I wanted to be allowed to talk as much or as little as I thought

I needed at the time. I

looked for the piece of literature that addressed . . . "the alcoholic old-maid school teacher in a small town."

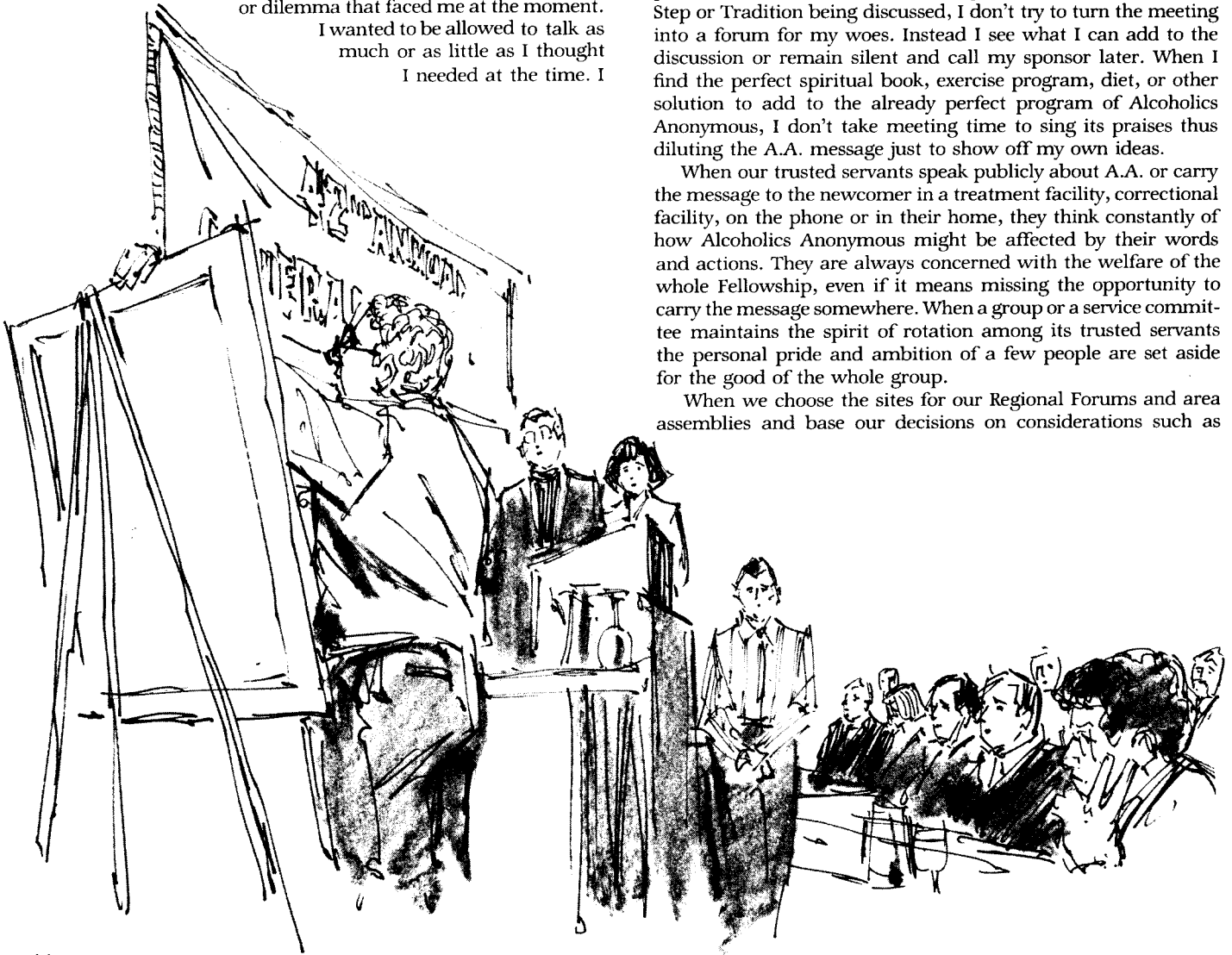
Attention to our common welfare describes mature action I wasn't capable of taking when I arrived. It was only by following the directions my sponsor gave me that I began to take these actions. I learned to observe the Twelve Traditions by taking correct actions long before I really felt like it. I had to act my way into right thinking. By taking the actions of the Twelve Traditions, which assured that our common welfare would come first, I began to feel and believe that it should.

What are some of the things our groups and members do to place our common welfare first? "True brotherhood, harmony, and love, fortified by clear insights and right practices, are the only answers." (*A.A. Comes of Age* p. 98) When we quietly usher a drunk or disruptive member out of a meeting to talk to him privately, we assure that a meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous will continue for those others who want it. When the meeting chairperson selects a topic from A.A. literature and calls on sober members of Alcoholics Anonymous to share their experience, strength, and hope, this assures that a meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous is being held, rather than a self-help group meeting or group therapy session. When we hold closed meetings for alcoholics only, or allow only alcoholics to share at open meetings, we are not excluding our nonalcoholic friends, rather, we are placing the welfare of Alcoholics Anonymous first.

When I go to an A.A. meeting and have pressing personal problems that seem to have nothing whatsoever to do with the Step or Tradition being discussed, I don't try to turn the meeting into a forum for my woes. Instead I see what I can add to the discussion or remain silent and call my sponsor later. When I find the perfect spiritual book, exercise program, diet, or other solution to add to the already perfect program of Alcoholics Anonymous, I don't take meeting time to sing its praises thus diluting the A.A. message just to show off my own ideas.

When our trusted servants speak publicly about A.A. or carry the message to the newcomer in a treatment facility, correctional facility, on the phone or in their home, they think constantly of how Alcoholics Anonymous might be affected by their words and actions. They are always concerned with the welfare of the whole Fellowship, even if it means missing the opportunity to carry the message somewhere. When a group or a service committee maintains the spirit of rotation among its trusted servants the personal pride and ambition of a few people are set aside for the good of the whole group.

When we choose the sites for our Regional Forums and area assemblies and base our decisions on considerations such as



giving everyone a chance to host the event, holding it in an area or district that would most benefit from the service activity and not requiring the same people to drive long distances all the time, we choose the site based on considerations other than great tourist attractions or large concentrations of population. Thus we assure participation in service by all members of Alcoholics Anonymous, not by just the urban, affluent, mobile, or some other subset of our membership. Our concern is with all of us, not just some of us.

Delegates to the General Service Conference gather, not as representatives of their areas ready to fight for what the folks at home want, but instead as each area's contribution to the collective group conscience of Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole.

There will be decisions that we are asked to make here this week that will demand that we set aside our personal ambitions and opinions in order to assure that we accomplish what is best for all of Alcoholics Anonymous. It should be the hope of each of us that the 42nd General Service Conference will be guided by our Declaration of Unity. "This we owe to A.A.'s future: to place our common welfare first, to keep our Fellowship united. For on A.A. unity depend our lives, and the lives of those to come."

Barbara Madger, California (Northern Coastal)

Unity: Together We Can

In this changing world of ours, except for some nations barely out of communism and understandably eager to taste independence again, more and more free countries want to unite around common interests. Instead of going apart, most have found that their own survival lies in unity.

Survival: Don't we in A.A. know what that means? Each of us faced a moment in his or her own life when personal failure became apparent. And each of us found the solution in an A.A. group, where our common powerlessness over alcohol (Step One) is answered by our common welfare (the First Tradition).

Unity in A.A. started when Bill W. met Dr. Bob. Our association was born out of one alcoholic's need to talk to another. Thanks to that first A.A. meeting, Dr. Bob became sober and Bill remained so. Then both helped other alcoholics, who joined them in that first A.A. group. Our first service Conferences were conversations between Bob and Bill about their newly born Fellowship and about its growth. They then reported to the early members who freely gave their opinions—which, I might add, were not always along the lines of our co-founders but which never broke that early group's unity.

Today, as a Conference, do we work in unity? Do we have unity? As distinct groups of people, the trustees, the staff, and the delegates have the same high interest in A.A.'s common welfare and survival, but their perspectives, rightly so (and as clearly stated in the Concepts), cannot always be the same. We cannot all come to this Conference with the same kind of preparation.

Staff members work close to each other in the same offices all year long. They also work closely with and assist the trustees and directors who meet regularly throughout the year. The delegates meet regionally in small groups, at Regional Forums and conventions that trustees and staff members also attend regularly. Many delegates often call or write to each other throughout the year. But the delegates never get an opportunity to meet as a whole, apart from the Conference, which makes it difficult to feel the same kind of unity.

However, in spite of our sometimes very different points of view, whether we are a delegate, a trustee, a director or a staff member, we still need to work in unity to achieve unity. And in order to do so we must overcome our own personal individualities

and certain natural boundaries in service work. The key, like in recovery, is our common spiritual principles. Only through them can we make A.A.'s welfare our truly common interest. Our spiritual principles are what make us different from any other organization or enterprise—not any expertise whatsoever.

Of course, we have to do business, and a lot of it. We couldn't do without our literature, our offices and phone lines and services and, in a changing world, our computer system—among many other things. Even this Conference, the Mecca of our spiritual sharing, needs material organization—and not in a small quantity, as we can all witness. But business is not what makes A.A. what it is. Business is not what pulls and holds us together. Our common problem pulls us together and our spiritual principles hold us so. All other things have been tried before and have failed. This is why we have our beloved Traditions and Concepts. The Concepts do just that; they prevent us from merely doing business. Instead, they help us do business according to and for the sake of those spiritual principles.

When I came in A.A. I was alone and I was nothing. You made me the person I am today. Joining a group was not a natural thing for me to do. But I had no other option. I had to put aside my personal interests, if only for a while, and to join with you in what seemed to be working for the group. Only then was I able to put a stop to the destruction in my life. Strangely enough, I very seldom agreed with what most of you thought. Still I had no choice but to listen to what you had to say when you shared your experience, and to follow your lead. Thus I learned humility and the strength therein, which kept me from falling apart.

At the Conference, our divergent opinions force us to take time before we reach a clear-cut decision, thus keeping us humble as a Fellowship. Humility, there's what both Step Twelve and Tradition Twelve teach us: the supreme value of our spiritual principles.

The title of this presentation, "Unity: Together We Can," may not be entirely well phrased. On the one hand, unity necessarily implies togetherness, at least in A.A. On the other hand, unity to us is not a matter of capacity, but of necessity. Therefore, the title of this presentation could easily have been "Unity: We Must."

Robert Pare, Quebec (Northeast)

The Language of the Heart Worldwide

Many of us are here today because an alcoholic who was a member of Alcoholics Anonymous told us their story. My journey to sobriety in A.A. began because a member shared with me what she had been like and, as a result of practicing the principles of our Fellowship, what she was like then. She simply spoke to me in the "language of the heart." I heard a voice on the other end of the telephone and I identified with her description of the pain she had suffered as a practicing alcoholic. Her love literally flowed through that telephone and I was immediately attracted to her and to A.A.

To illustrate what I believe the language of the heart is, I would like to share the story of a member of my home group in Houston with you. Cleveland came to the La Branch Street Group from the streets—he literally slept in the weeds while he was drinking. He wanted to stay sober but his skin was a different color and he could not read. No one in the group noticed these differences. They spoke to him in the language of the heart. They sponsored him, loved him and purchased Big Book tapes and a recorder for him. They made sure that he got to the meetings and they invited him into their homes. Cleveland is now sober for almost ten years and he shares that he is happily sober because he *listened* to the members of the La Branch Street Group. He is

a useful, responsible, literate member of society and a shining example of what the language of the heart, spoken with love, can do for any person who comes to us.

Miracles like my friend's are happening daily all around the globe because in 1935 Bill Wilson shared with Bob Smith in the same manner. From our North American continent to Europe, across Africa and Asia and down to Argentina, our message of hope has transcended language and cultural barriers. We know that A.A. meetings are held in 134 countries and that our Big Book has been translated into approximately 22 languages. Our membership has grown at a rate of 10 percent per year over the past ten years.

It is my hope that our members still speak the same language that I heard when I came to you some years ago. Are we communicating our basic message or has our original message changed or become diluted in the past few years? Are the Traditions being given the important place in our meetings that they deserve? I am concerned when I experience unity problems and read of the problems in Europe and Australia.

Our general service structure is the example for others to follow; we are responsible for living our principles and being sterling examples for others (worldwide) to see. Let us pray, as we begin this week of work, that God's grace and guidance will be heard through the Conference process.

The language of the heart translates into gratitude, love, open-mindedness, respect and sincerity. While we do live in a changing world, it helps me to recall Bill's words: "for so long as we remain sure that our 'one world of A.A.' is God's gift rather than any virtue earned or created by ourselves; and for so long as our 'one world' continues to be ever more inclusive of those in need; and for so long as we speak and try to perfect the language of love—for just so long may we count upon making whatever rendezvous with destiny that God would have us." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 312)

Linda O'Brien, Texas (Southeast)

FINANCE

The Monday afternoon presentations concluded with a report and discussion on G.S.O. finances moderated by Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee Robert P. Morse. Michael McPherson, A.A.W.S. director, delivered the report that preceded a question-and-sharing session.

Two years ago, I attended my first Conference and made my first presentation. At that time—in all sincerity—I said "What in the name of God is an Irish Catholic drunk from the South Bronx doing addressing the A.A. Conference and talking about money?" A wonderful delegate from Massachusetts came up to me later and asked "Who better?" Well here I am again.

Ladies and gentlemen—fellow drunks—we are here today to talk about the finances of A.A.W.S. and the General Service Office. Let me begin by telling you my view of finances in general. If "war is too important to be left in the hands of the generals," I believe strongly that money is too important an issue to be left in the hands of accountants. And I say that with all due respect to my friends and accountants—Bud Flanagan (our outside auditor), Stanley Silverman and others. I believe we should be able to present accurate numbers to all of you and do it in such a way that you do not need to be a C.P.A. to understand them.

However, let me tell you the problem in taking such an approach. On the one hand, if you present data that is so simplified that in effect you are showing nothing, there is a tendency to believe you are trying to hide something (and I would urge you to trust that tendency). On the other hand, if your

presentation goes into great detail—to the delight of accountants—calling attention to such burning issues as using LIFO or FIFO methods to calculate your inventory, or discuss the merits of adopting FASB's Statement 87 on the requirements of accruing the net periodic cost of employee pensions, you lose most of your audience—the very people you want to reach.

I will take a middle road today. I will discuss: Where we are—with particular emphasis on the 1992 budget, and spend considerable time on the major components of both income and expenses. Then, Where we are coming from—showing our performance over the past years, and finally—Where we are going.

Bob Morse spoke this morning about the results for 1991 (see Finance Committee report). By anyone's definition, it was not a good year—at least in terms of income—both from literature and contributions. If a silver lining is to be found anywhere, it is that the A.A.W.S. Board did not wait until the end of the year and say "Oh boy, what lousy results!" As early as April of last year, the A.A.W.S. Board called out that the income side of the 1991 budget was not going to be met. In July of 1991, the board recommended a revised budget to the trustees' Finance Committee, based on the projections we had made. I am happy to say that the trustees' Finance Committee adopted the recommendations, even though there were a few people who believed A.A.W.S. was being too pessimistic and that we were proclaiming the "sky is falling" doctrine. The results proved our predictions. So, as I said earlier, while the results for 1991 are indeed disappointing, the early, accurate call out of what the results would be is somewhat reassuring.

The A.A.W.S. Board prepared the 1992 budget with the 1991 anticipated results in mind. The board decided to do a "zero base" budget: that is, instead of every function requesting the same amount in 1992 as it received in 1991 (or even asking for an increase), the board asked why should this function receive a single penny in 1992. We spent long hours over many meetings reviewing every line in the budget and asking the same question—do we really need this expense? The result is the 1992 budget (see Finance Section). This is the budget for A.A.W.S. and the General Service Office—it does not include the Grapevine. The 1992 budget has operating expenses less than 1991. This is the first time in recent memory that we are planning to spend less than the preceding year. It is a realistic reflection of what we believe the income will be for 1992, combined with the legitimate funding needs for the year. We are budgeting total income for the year of \$9,663,800. This comes from literature sales of \$5,464,300 and contributions of \$4,179,500. Fifty-seven percent of our total income comes from literature; 43 percent comes from contributions. Total operating expenses are budgeted to be \$8,874,050. Expenses are listed in the order of size—from Salaries of \$3,738,600 (or 42% of total expenses) to \$12,600 for Self-Support. I must point out here that sacrifices and cuts were made across the board—for example, staff and exempt employee raises are being withheld until July.

Subtracting the Operating Expenses from total income produces a profit of \$789,750. However, we will have extraordinary expenses in 1992 related to the move of the offices. After deducting for these extraordinary expenses, we will show a loss of \$1,191,150. This loss will be made up by using the anticipated earnings on the Reserve Fund (\$550,000) and actually dipping into the Reserve Fund for an additional \$641,000. You should be aware that this is exactly what the Reserve Fund is used for—to finance "extraordinary, or capital type expenditures such as: moving and/or refurbishing and renovating the office premises of the General Service Office." Normally, organizations would go to banks for capital improvements such as the cost of our move. The Reserve Fund is our bank for such expenses.

In 1992 we expect to receive less income than in 1991. This

is only the second time in the past 12 years that that is the case; 1988 income was less than 1987. As you are aware, there has been concern for some time that we should not be entirely dependent on the income from literature to support the services of the office. Without getting into the merits of that argument, in 1992 we expect the percentage of income from literature and contributions to be exactly where they were in 1981—57 percent of income coming from literature and 43 percent coming from contributions. Only in 1988 and 1989 did the percentage from contributions exceed the percentage from literature. There is always concern about the percentage of non-A.A. literature sales. In 1985 A.A. sales dipped below 70 percent and non-A.A. sales rose above 30 percent. In 1991 A.A. sales reached their highest percentage—over 80 percent. However, we project that there will be some slippage in this percentage in 1992.

Our auditor, Bud Flanagan, is fond of saying that two titles which A.A.W.S. publishes are the engine that drives the A.A. train, and he is perfectly correct in this. The Big Book and the Twelve and Twelve produce the lion's share of the total income from literature. The dip in dollar sales in 1988 was due to the reduction in the price of the book. For the past two years, the number of Big Books sold (in all formats) has declined and we believe this will happen again in 1992. It is indicated that in 1992 we will sell the same number of Big Books as we did in 1987. The number of Twelve and Twelves expected to be sold in 1992 is dramatically reduced from the high in 1989 (which, by the way, was the year the soft-cover edition was introduced).

The reduction of the number of books being sold—especially the Big Book and the Twelve and Twelve—is of real concern to the A.A.W.S. Board. The literature subcommittee of the board is reviewing this troubling trend. I invite you to offer any comments or ideas you have on this topic. Perhaps, the introduction of *Daily Reflections*, which had sales of over \$2 million during its first year or so of publication, had some impact.

To emphasize how important the Big Book and the Twelve and Twelve are to total literature sales, I would like to point out that in 1981, 45 percent of total sales came from the Big Book and over 20 percent came from the Twelve and Twelve. In 1992, 43 percent will come from the Big Book and almost 20 percent from the Twelve and Twelve. Sixty-three percent of all literature sales comes from the sale of two titles. This is indeed an engine which must constantly be looked after.

Now for a review of expenses. Expenses have risen in every year but one—1992. The largest single expense we have is salaries and in a service organization you would expect this to be the case. I have been told by a few members that today's salaries are out of line to total expenses and when I informed them that this was not the case, at least in the past ten years, the reply was "Oh, I'm talking about longer than that." So I went back to 1973 and it is still not the case. Indeed, in 1974 salaries were nearly 50 percent of total expenses—in 1991, they were only 37 percent of total expenses—the lowest percentage in 20 years. They will rise in 1992 to about 42 percent because of other reduced expenses, especially the reduced rent in the new office location. However, they will still be well below the good old days of 49 percent!

So far we've spoken about where we are and where we are coming from. I would like to close with a few words about where we are going. The A.A.W.S. Board is in the process of adopting a "mission" statement for itself. A draft of that statement states that we derive our purpose for being from the General Service Board and the General Service Conference. I believe strongly that this is the case. A.A.W.S. will invite you to judge our performance compared with the mission statement. Moreover, as I told the A.A.W.S. Board when we were discussing this, a budget is also a mission statement and you should judge us also on the financial planning and the results. The board has adopted an "intentional"

approach to its objectives. We will not be a "reactive" board—just as we were not a reactive board during 1991. The #1 objective we have is to prepare for our successors. Will A.A.W.S. and the General Service Office be better off after we all rotate off? Our goal is that it will be. We now have a "hands-on" management team and you have an activist A.A.W.S. Board. As a former trustee, who served eight years on the A.A.W.S. Board, recently told me, "rarely has the A.A.W.S. Board been in a better position to face the problems and challenges of the 90s." I believe this and I hope you believe it also.

You are the trusted servants of A.A. We are but the servants to the trusted servants. I salute you in your task during the coming week. I invite any questions you may have and, as always, I thank you for my sobriety.

Michael McPherson
A.A.W.S. treasurer and director

NEW DELEGATE AREAS

The Monday evening session began at 7:30 p.m. with three presentations on Delegate Areas. The moderator was Harland F. Sercombe, delegate, from Central Michigan.

Percentage and Participation of Conference Membership

As we gather for the 42nd annual General Service Conference, the Fellowship of A.A. continues to be served, as it has since 1951, by the Conference plan, which "... provides a movement wide forum for the discussion of principles and problems that affect A.A. as a whole." (*A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. S25) As trusted servants we act as custodians of our Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions within the framework of Bill W.'s Twelve Concepts for World Services. We have grown from 4,052 groups and 111,765 members in 1951 to 52,159 groups and 1,153,209 members in 1991. This presentation will focus on Conference membership, especially on area delegate representation, as it relates to our ability to function as A.A.'s collective group conscience and to provide Twelfth-Step service to fellow alcoholics.

The proportional makeup of the Conference over the past 30 years has been about the same with delegates averaging 69.3 percent, board averaging 20.3 percent and staff averaging 10.4 percent. The number of delegates increased from 84 in 1961 to 91 in 1974; the number of board members has remained fairly constant at 27, although the makeup has changed as the number of trustees increased from 15 to 21; and the number of staff has increased from 10 to 15 in 1991. A review of the growth of the Conference is important to understand communication, participation and representation, as we discuss the problems and needs affecting A.A.

As part of the Third Legacy Plan proposed by Bill W., the United States and Canada were divided into delegate areas. In 1952, the membership included 75 delegates, 15 trustees, and other board and staff members. This experimental period ended in 1955 when the Conference Charter was adopted. Article 4 states, "The Conference will be expected to afford a reliable cross-section of A.A. opinion for this purpose." (*ibid.*, p. S32)

As this Conference plan was developing, requests for new delegate areas were approved. In 1957 the Conference approved the "Guide For Future Admissions Committees in Regard to Acceptance of New Delegates," which focused on growth and increased delegate participation at the Conference. This guide

established criteria for maximum A.A. population in a state or province as well as mileage. Emphasis was placed on working through the current system/structure first before changing delegate areas.

In 1960 the Conference Committee on Admissions requested that new delegate areas be reviewed to study the growth of the Conference in light of the geographic needs in all states and provinces. A.A. had grown to 7,178 groups and 135,186 members. In response, Bill W. wrote a memorandum reported to the 1961 Conference which, with the 1957 guide, was used to recommend new delegate areas. Bill wrote, "Therefore, the Conference Committee on Admissions should weigh each new application for a new Delegate on its own merit, taking into consideration the primary factors of the population, geography—and also expense. But this process of adding Delegates ought to be gradual, aiming at the remedy of obvious and marked flaws in local communications. We should, our budget allowing, continue to remedy the obvious flaws in local communications, and that is all." The memorandum continues, "It should be re-emphasized that the Conference is not a political body demanding a completely rigid formula of representation. What we shall need will always be enough Delegates at New York to afford a reliable cross-section of A.A. plus enough more to make sure of good local communication." (*Final Conference Report*, 1961, p. 34)

From 1961 to 1969, the number of Conference members grew from 120 to 127; delegates grew from 84 to 90. This growth reflected the gradual growth Bill had envisioned. The number of trustees grew from 19 (with six regional trustees) in 1962 to 21 (with eight regional trustees) in 1967. The number of trustees and the ratio of alcoholic to nonalcoholic trustees changed in 1967, marking a turning point in our Fellowship. This decade could be considered the growth period of the Conference membership in terms of numbers and responsibilities.

This growth period stopped in 1969 when a two-year moratorium was declared on applications on added delegates. The Fellowship consisted of 11,690 groups and 222,197 members. After the moratorium ended in 1971, the Conference adopted guidelines stating that the Conference size should not become much larger than it was at the time; that the makeup of the Conference should remain similar to what it was that year (delegates represented 70.3 percent, board members made up 20.3 percent and staff members accounted for 9.4 percent); and that nondelegates should not exceed one third of the total Conference membership.

The two-year moratorium terminated and a detailed questionnaire was prepared for those areas seeking additional representation. Requests for new delegate areas would require review by two Conferences. The committee also called for a detailed examination of area structure by the Admissions Committee with emphasis on the working structure. Finally, these questionnaires were sent to each area every two years for review of the Conference area structure. This process was reaffirmed at last year's Conference and is our current process.

Following this process, the last delegate area to be approved was the fourth delegate for the Province of Quebec in 1973. However, this request was approved by the Conference after the Admission Committee had denied it. The Fellowship had grown in 1973 to 16,069 groups and 309,300 members. In 1981 the last formal request for additional delegate representation came from New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island, Canada and was denied. By this time the Fellowship had doubled its 1973 numbers—there were 32,907 groups and 652,881 members.

More recently, the 1991 Conference marked a renewed interest in the participation and makeup of the Conference. The Washington State Area assembly requested that the Conference be expanded to 150 members and that a long-range planning

committee develop policy on Conference and regional growth. During the discussions many Conference members became aware for the first time of the process that had been established in 1971 and received copies of applications for additional delegates. This lack of information and understanding came when the number of groups had almost doubled within a ten-year period to 53,159, and the number of A.A. members had nearly doubled to 1,153,209. Since the 1991 Conference a number of areas (including Washington, Eastern Pennsylvania and California) have seriously reviewed additional delegate representation.

The question facing us now is where to go from here. The history of Conference participation and makeup focuses on communication and participation and provides guidelines for the gradual growth of the Conference as envisioned by Bill W. Given the growth of A.A. groups and membership, the question arises as to whether the Conference today affords a reliable cross-section of A.A. opinion as embodied in the Charter, particularly given the low levels of participation by groups at the district and area levels. Is the answer in creating additional delegate areas or in reevaluating the working structure in existing delegate areas?

Some Conference members have raised the question of how big is too big. Was this problem or need created by not following the principles and guidelines for the gradual growth of the Conference as set forth by Bill W. and previous Conferences? This issue takes on added meaning when we consider that the proportional makeup of the Conference has decreased from what existed in 1971 in that delegates now make up 68.9 percent as opposed to 70.3 percent in 1971. The impact of this shift becomes clearer when one considers that the addition of five more nondelegates to the Conference would result in the delegates dropping below the adopted policy of representing two-thirds of the Conference body.

There are many other questions that relate to these issues and needs. As trusted servants and as the conscience of the Fellowship, we have a responsibility to discuss these principles and problems and, as those who have served before us, to propose solutions that will best serve A.A. as a whole.

In conclusion, the Conference and the Fellowship need to reevaluate the working structure of the existing delegate areas, the existing regional organization and the Conference itself. The Conference Committee on Policy/Admission needs to continue its efforts to inform delegates about the process of applying for additional delegates and its examination of area structures, including sending the questionnaire to each area every two years for reevaluation of the Conference area structure. The Policy/Admission Committee and the Conference need to determine if the time has come for a long-range study of this issue and the overall needs of the Fellowship. By discussing these needs and issues and by understanding the principles involved, we will ensure that the Conference continues to serve as the effective voice of the informed group conscience of A.A. as a whole.

Ron Gauthier, Massachusetts (Eastern)

New Delegate Areas—Demographically: The Benefits and Drawbacks

The letter from our Conference coordinator said simply that I was invited to participate at this Conference by sharing on the topic "New Delegate Areas—Demographically: The Benefits and Drawbacks." I thought to myself that there's nothing simple about that, and then ran to my dictionary to look up the word "demographically." It was then that I began to pray and I haven't stopped since. You see, in Area 59—Eastern Pennsylvania—we have been talking about an additional delegate area for quite

some time now; except the terminology we've been using is not "a new delegate area," but rather, "splitting the area." I wouldn't be at all surprised to find that other area committees who might be looking into new delegate areas for themselves are using that same terminology, because their experiences, interests, and efforts are primarily concentrated within their own areas.

It is "intra-area" demographics which I will address here: area finances, area structures, characteristics and size of the A.A. population, and the number of groups and districts in the area. When it comes to discussing the benefits and drawbacks of splitting areas, these demographics cannot be separated from each other. The benefits of establishing a new delegate area to the area itself might include better informed A.A. members; greater participation at the area and district levels; opportunity for more people to get into service at the area level; more manageable area committee meetings; greater abilities for the delegate and other area officers to be in direct contact with individual groups; more ease in finding accommodations for area-level functions; and, more chances for interaction among the area, area subcommittees, district committees, A.A. groups, intergroups and central offices. Almost all of these benefits involve communications, but their real emphasis is on time and numbers. If we were interested solely in cutting down the time we spend in general service work, and in reveling about the number of A.A. members and groups we have, then there would be (from an area's standpoint) few, if any, drawbacks to splitting the area. But we would, I feel, be in real trouble if that were the case. Luckily, I don't think it is.

The drawbacks to new delegate areas would be for most of us, I suspect, more difficult to pinpoint, simply because no new areas have been formed for more than 20 years. Whatever drawbacks there might be, though, would not involve time or numbers. Rather, they would be much more subtle. One would be that the area's perspective overall would be narrowed, and we would lose whatever diversity we have among our members. A.A. populations in rural areas would be more isolated from metropolitan areas, and those in metropolitan areas would not have the opportunity to share experiences, strengths and hopes with those in rural and suburban communities. Perhaps a more ominous result of forming a new delegate area might be increased competition or rivalry between the new and the old areas, and in overall disunity in A.A. as a whole. This would be, I believe, most damaging when the real reasons for forming new areas were not communications or even numbers, but individual resentments, prejudices, egos and/or drives for power and prestige. The final drawback to forming new delegate areas which I'd like to mention is the possibility that more services than are really needed will be developed to justify the new area, and that there will no longer be sufficient funds to carry out those services which are needed. Our Third Legacy says that we need the least possible organization which will maintain us in effectiveness and in unity. Essential to that "least possible organization," to successful communications, and to carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic is, I feel, a strong belief in and reliance upon trusted servants throughout all levels of A.A. service, including G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s and other area officers.

This brings me to my final point. It has been my observation that there are still many in A.A. service who choose to paternalistically take care of everything and everybody. This may be well-intentioned, but all too often the result is that others are denied the opportunity to serve or to participate in ensuring that the A.A. message continues to be carried. This is true, I feel, even in some areas where the role of the D.C.M. is more figurative than actual. These areas tend understandably to emphasize their numbers of groups and A.A. members, and they have serious difficulties in getting the message to all of their groups. For such

areas, those difficulties can only mushroom as their exploding A.A. populations do, and additional delegate areas might be their only solution. Areas which have, on the other hand, knowledgeable area committees, active subcommittees, and dedicated and informed D.C.M.s, seem to carry the message very effectively, regardless of how many members or groups those areas have. For these areas, an exploding A.A. population might mean only that their structures need to be revamped, or that additional districts need to be formed. Their leaders are already deeply entrenched in service and trusted by the Fellowship.

As an unnamed past trustee from Canada wrote: "Leadership is a continuing problem, just as Bill foretold. If you want better trustees, we need better delegates. If we want better delegates, we need better committee members. If we want better D.C.M.s, we need better G.S.R.s. Better service suggests better Unity, and better Unity suggests better Recovery. . . . What is important is that we grow under God quietly and calmly and in freedom. . . . We have no membership which has to be enlarged. No authority that has to be supported. No prestige, power, or pride that has to be satisfied."

It will be up to those of us here and at future Conferences to decide between adding new delegate areas and suggesting that areas revise their structures, for the growth of our Fellowship is inevitable. It will be up to us, as trusted servants, to find the ways to best respond to this growth, and to ensure the continued success of A.A. as a whole.

Marcia Goldblatt, Pennsylvania (Eastern)

New Delegate Areas—Geographically: The Benefits and Drawbacks

I would like to share my experience as a member of a geographically large delegate area that has struggled for the last decade with the issue of dividing the area in two, possibly three geographical areas.

Prior to 1982, there had been some dissatisfaction expressed within the area. The focus of discontent seemed to be based on three different sources. The first of these was a flaw in communication within the area as a result of the vast distances members of the Fellowship had to travel in order to meet. Because of the problem with communication, there was some concern that we were beginning to no longer work together in unity and, as a result, in recovery and service. It was difficult for members to meet more than once a year at a general service assembly because it would probably have entailed a trip of more than one day. Because of travel, job and money hardships, difficulties were arising among many G.S.R.s regarding having the resources to attend even one assembly per year; thus continuing to decrease participation and communication.

Expense was a second major factor. Obviously, a trip of more than one day can be costly when gas, lodging and meals are considered. Many groups have small memberships. The spiritual dollar is sometimes spread thin when covering group expenses and supporting our Twelve-Step work. An extra financial burden is placed on the groups. Smaller groups often seem to be located in rural communities away from large metropolitan areas. However, the larger urban areas are obvious locations for assemblies.

Thirdly, the vast percentage of the population in Alcoholics Anonymous in our area centers in our two large cities. This generated some idea that members could not be involved if they lived in distant rural locations and thus created a feeling of "why bother?"

Finally, after ten years of debating this issue in our home groups and at assemblies; forming committees to study the

possibility of creating new areas and dealing with several motions revolving around this issue, we came to an understanding that perhaps we should "be aiming at the remedying of obvious and marked flaws in local communications." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. 572) As a result, we began to split districts. At the beginning of 1990 we had twenty-eight districts. Today we have fifty districts. The alternate delegate is supporting the delegate by attending A.A. functions throughout the area and by sharing much of the remaining workload.

As a result, communication and participation rapidly improved and continues to do so. More people are able to be active in service and to feel "part of." Enthusiasm is again one of the foundations of our participation and through enthusiasm, we continue to attract others to service. At our 1991 area assembly we voted not to split our area. Expense is still a problem because the vast travel time and distances are still a fact. However, it could also be very costly to add new delegate areas, as each new area would have to form a new committee, perhaps with little in the way of funding, initially. And, the assemblies and area committee meetings would still be included in the structure of each new area.

Looking at the situation that may arise within the United States and Canada with our one General Service Office, there are certainly some drawbacks that may occur with the addition of new delegate areas. Large participation could bog down the Conference and perhaps confusion in the distribution of literature would result. Record keeping would certainly become more complex. Necessary correspondence by G.S.O. staff and trustees would increase and there would be an escalation in expense as the probable result of adding staff, as well as room, board and travel expenses for delegates attending the Conference. Additional delegate areas may result in dramatic changes within our structure and our *A.A. Service Manual*. This could be gut-wrenching for A.A.

However, we would also be looking at better communication, more participation, a more realistic workload for Conference members; and most importantly, a clear voice of the group conscience resulting in an increase in participation, support through contribution, and willingness to participate in our vital Twelve Step work, which includes the Legacies of Unity, Recovery and Service.

In conclusion, Bill Wilson's writings are a reminder to "Let us never fear needed change. Certainly we have to discriminate between changes for worse and changes for better. But once a need becomes clearly apparent in an individual, in a group, or in A.A. as a whole, it has long since been found out that we cannot stand still and look the other way.

"The essence of all growth is a willingness to change for the better and then an unremitting willingness to shoulder whatever responsibility this entails." (*As Bill Sees It*, p. 115)

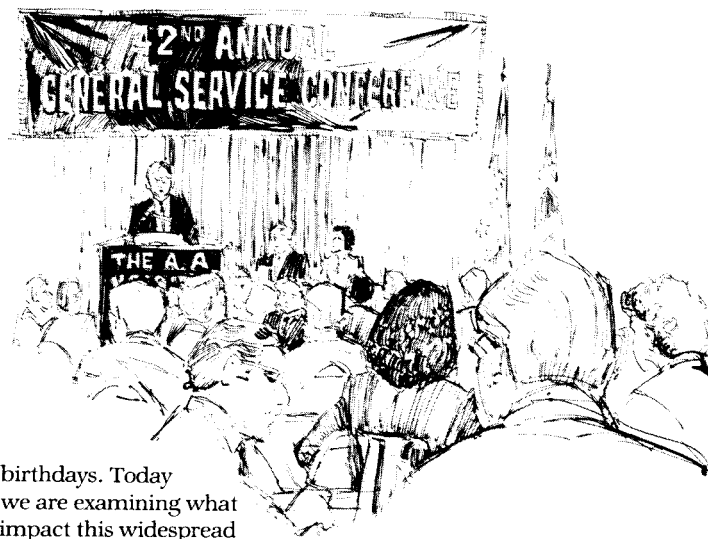
Susie Terrell, Washington

MEDALLIONS, TRADEMARKS AND LOGOS

The Wednesday afternoon session included a presentation session on the topic, Medallions, Trademarks and Logos. Moderator Jan Whitney, East Central U.S. regional trustee and A.A.W.S. Board chairperson, led the discussion on three distinct topics.

A.A. Should Not Produce Medallions

Medallions and chips, as sobriety tokens, have been with us for some time. Beginning as early as the 1940s, successive generations of A.A.s have been introduced to this means of recognizing A.A.



birthdays. Today we are examining what impact this widespread practice ought to have on our world services.

Some would urge A.A. to produce medallions simply because the practice of giving sobriety tokens is very common among many A.A. groups. Others would make a case for the value placed on them by individual members. Still other A.A. folks would explain that many of our members would not be sober were it not for the ability to hold a symbol of A.A. in their hand at a critical moment. All would suggest that this rightly and reasonably falls under the definition of an A.A. service.

We can easily see that there are strong feelings and a long history surrounding this question. Fortunately, our heritage of unity contains clear examples of how we might find a solution. Early in A.A. history the events that will serve as our signposts were in the making. These experiences eventually resulted in our Twelve Traditions. We need only review them to gain a sense of the direction we might follow.

Join me, if you will, in the classroom of the spirit. Our lessons are illustrated by a love for one another and the alcoholic who still suffers. The principles which have held our society together, the Twelve Traditions, are our textbook. Overseeing the lesson, the schoolmaster is none other than the loving God which presides over Alcoholics Anonymous. Applying spiritual principles, in service to our Fellowship, is our assigned homework.

Our first divine lesson was in the area of hospitalization for alcoholics. This was seen as necessary early on. At one point, Bill was even offered a lay therapist position. As a Fellowship, we also had visions of what is described in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* as "chains of hospitals." The result, which became Traditions Two and Six, was an awareness that medical-service activities are not well suited to Alcoholics Anonymous. We saw that this was a service best provided by our friends and those A.A.s who, as individual business people, wished to be so engaged.

Another instance was an attempt to provide social services for the new A.A. members. This included clubrooms and financial services, designed to reduce back debts, as cited on p. 147 of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*. In other places there were adventures in providing housing. All culminated in Tradition Four. Although these were often needed services, we again learned that they are services best provided by someone other than Alcoholics Anonymous.

Our desire to educate about alcoholism was also used as a lesson by a loving God. Both Bill W. and the Fellowship at large felt that much was needed in this area. Dr. Bob's and Bill's names appeared on the letterhead of a notable public agency engaged in this effort. In another case, a member was going to break his anonymity on radio in order to provide education on A.A. Information about alcoholism was produced and distributed in yet another case, in which a member's anonymity also came under fire. Once more we say that even the most needed of services,

for current and potential alcoholics, were not always suited to be a service activity of Alcoholics Anonymous. Today we see this experience reflected in Traditions Six, Eleven and Twelve.

The lesson is clear. With the exception of a small amount of literature which keeps our message from being garbled, we ought to carry the A.A. message by sober drunks *talking* to drunks wanting sobriety. Therefore I believe that Alcoholics Anonymous should not produce medallions.

Does this mean that those A.A.s who want medallions with an A.A. logo cannot have them? Not at all. We, like other societies, can treat the use of our logo on medallions as a reprint issue. For example, we can say to those who would produce medallions for the groups, "You are free to use our logo and some A.A. text on your medallion so long as it is the only graphic representation on the piece." This would neither tie us to anyone through affiliation nor require us to litigate in defense of our logo. It would steer us clear of a path whereby we could become dependent on income from this high-volume item. At the same time, it would give the groups the freedom to purchase medallions with our logo. This is the example of cooperation and compromise we have been shown by our Higher Power. We are to cooperate and compromise in order to live in harmony with each other and those who also occupy this world which is our home. That is our *homework* lesson.

One final note. Regardless of the outcome of this discussion, we need to come away from it with a deep resolve to better communicate about our general services. Our members ought to understand clearly why we provide some services and not others. The primary focal point of this communication needs to be *within* Alcoholics Anonymous. Let's share with one another and our society at large.

Dennis Bauer, Minnesota (Southern)

A.A. Should Produce Medallions

The theme of our Conference, "The A.A. Message in a Changing World," lends itself to looking at what we do, and at the habits our groups have grown accustomed to. One of those customs is the presentation of chips and medallions at certain stages of our recovery. Human beings need recognition and alcoholics have this tendency too. Chips and medallions are used to recognize our sobriety in many groups.

I have polled Eastern Canada's ten areas and they all use the chips and medallions system in one form or another. If I trust the letters that G.S.O. has transmitted to me, they come from the many regions in the states and they also favor the use of chips and medallions. If the groups favor the use of chips and medallions to mark certain milestones of sobriety, we have to respect the group conscience, providing it is well informed.

In most of the groups, including my home group, the funding to stock those chips and medallions comes from the Seventh Tradition. They are purchased from outside sources. In leaving the production of medallions and chips in the hands of outside entities, are we encouraging the groups to have outside business affiliations? If they purchase them from within the Fellowship it would be in line with our self-support program. When the groups purchase from outside entities, are they doing anything different than we do when we hire a consultant for our International Convention, or when we enter into a contract with a printing company to print our literature? Is it different than letting rehabilitation centers sell our literature for profit? Is it different than letting outside firms tape the content of our International Conventions to resell them for profit? Is it different than selling tapes, calendars and diaries? If it is the group conscience to have

them available, maybe we should arrange to control the production and recover our Seventh Tradition money.

Based on the above, and considering that there is a custom that a sobriety anniversary deserves to be highlighted by G.S.O. returning a thank you card when the member sends in his contribution to the anniversary plan, maybe we should consider making chips and medallions available when the group members wish to celebrate their own anniversary. How we could go about it is not easy. Let me suggest a few ways:

1) We could transfer the use of our logos to three serious manufacturers strategically located in the U.S.A. and Canada and contract with them to produce our chips and medallions. This would need to be done after we have polled the groups via our structure to establish what is required and in what quality and quantity.

Those manufacturers would have exclusive usage of our logos and we would assure them that our groups would buy from them. On the other hand, the manufacturers would also have the responsibility of taking care of any litigation necessary to protect those logos from being used by others without their consent. The name of A.A. should never be involved in any court action. If it is financially viable we could ask the manufacturers to pay us a small royalty on the units sold.

2) We might consider producing them ourselves and the responsibility should rest with A.A.W.S. The catch here is that A.A.W.S. would have to look after litigation and it is not clear if this respects Tradition Ten and Warranty Five.

3) We could continue the way it is now if the groups agree.

4) This alternative would be to produce a series of chips and medallions inspired from the idea of celebration without using our logos; maybe something like the small illustration used on the thank-you card G.S.O. returns when we send our contributions to the anniversary plan. This would eliminate the need to worry about litigations.

In conclusion, we believe we are facing a reality that will not fade away, so if we are to have chips and medallions, let us structure the process of producing and distributing them to our groups in our usual efficient way and in due respect for our Traditions and Warranties.

Marc Pineau, trustee, Eastern Canada

To What Length Should We Go to Protect Our Trademarks and Logos (Litigation)?

I am very happy that the issues surrounding medallions, trademarks and litigation have been brought to this Conference, where they can be discussed fully. When I received my loving invitation (and as soon as my heart started beating again), I wondered how I could possibly talk about so complex a topic in only five minutes. I decided that I would do what has always worked best for me in A.A.: I would try to keep it simple and share from my own experience.

First, several years ago, I opened an issue of *Publishers Weekly* magazine and was startled by what I saw. My first thought was, since when did A.A. advertise here? I was looking at a book cover whose design looked exactly like the design being used at that time on our pamphlets. With the large letters "A.A." on the front, it was indistinguishable from our literature. No one could have figured out that this was not an official A.A. publication. Fortunately, the publisher was willing to change the cover before the book was published.

Second, at a meeting recently, I heard a speaker make an outrageous statement, beginning with the words, "The program says. . . ." At the break I asked her where she had gotten that

idea. She answered that she had read it in the literature. "A.A. literature?" I asked. "Well," she said, "maybe it was Al-Anon or C.O.A. but I got it from a Twelve-Step store."

Third, when I was traveling on business in the Midwest, I saw an ad on local television for a treatment center, and the circle and triangle were used with the center's name. It looked as if the center were run by A.A.

When I got sober, we were the only game in town. Except for Hazelden's 24-hour book, just about all the literature was ours. But now recovery is *big* business, and there is an amazing proliferation of literature from other sources, and a lot of A.A. members are reading it, even buying it at A.A. meetings and at intergroups. I honestly believe that one of the reasons we are having problems regarding singleness of purpose and unity is that much of our message is being blurred. In the May 1964 A.A. Grapevine, Bill Wilson stated what would have happened during our first 25 years if A.A. "had never published any standard literature . . . our message would be hopelessly garbled. . . . Without its literature, A.A. would certainly have bogged down in a welter of controversy and disunity." That statement clearly says why we must have *standard* literature and what can happen without it.

We are at a time, then, when I feel that the integrity of our message is being challenged mightily and when, more than ever, we must ensure that *we know* and that *others can tell* just what the A.A. message is. Legally, trademarks have two purposes: to indicate source and to indicate quality. "Source" means knowing that Alcoholics Anonymous is the single source of anything so marked. And "quality" means knowing that it is the specific A.A. program of recovery. When publications duplicate our covers and use our trademarks to increase sales, it is increasingly difficult to ensure that people know what *our* message is. When treatment centers and others in the recovery business use our marks, it is increasingly difficult to ensure that people know what *our* program is and what it is not. And when our logo is used for commercial purposes so much that its source and quality are diluted, it becomes meaningless, and we lose the ability to clearly mark what is and what is not A.A.'s message.

I have no position on whether or not we should do medallions, but I do feel strongly that *our* marks should not be used on them and that we must take whatever steps are necessary to ensure that they are not. The cries of anguish from these who want the circle and triangle on medallions are clear proof that this symbol is A.A. to many people. And it is also clear proof of why people in the business of making money want to use it, even if that use eventually makes it meaningless. Yes, as a trustee-director, I have a legal responsibility to protect A.A.'s property, including its marks. But as a member, I also feel that I have a moral and spiritual responsibility to ensure that the A.A. message is there for those who come after me, *and* can be recognized as such.

Jean Smith, general service trustee

QUESTION #14 FROM THE P.I. MEMBERSHIP SURVEY

Wednesday evening's dinner was followed by two presentations expressing pro and con viewpoints on Question #14 from the A.A. Membership Survey questionnaire. Stanley Silverman, general service trustee, moderated the session.

A "Con" Viewpoint

Question 14 has been a thorn in our side since it was first introduced into the A.A. Membership Survey questionnaire in

1977. It has caused endless soul-searching and argument among us. And this is not a matter of oldtimers vs. newcomers, of personalities overwhelming principles. The arguments on either side of this issue are real. There are valid and sound arguments for retaining the question—and there are thoughtful and serious arguments against it.

One of the arguments against is, of course, that drug addiction is an outside issue. Having that question on the survey questionnaire gives the impression that Alcoholics Anonymous might have something to say about drugs—a clear violation of our Traditions. How can we claim singleness of purpose in one breath and ask our membership if they ever did any drugs in the next one? It is inconsistent and misleading.

We are having trouble enough coping with the often downright erroneous information being given to newcomers by healthcare professionals in detoxes and rehabs. They are being told that A.A. will do it all. We are the answer, the solution to every ailment that humans are heir to. But we're not. We do alcohol. That's what we know. That's our group experience. That's our primary purpose. By retaining this question on our survey, we are inferring that we have something to say about drug addiction.

And why are we collecting this information? Who is the information for? It is not particularly useful to any of us at the group level. One doesn't go on a Twelve-Step call armed with the latest statistics on A.A. membership. It is used principally to inform doctors, public agencies and the media of our makeup. Is this not involving ourselves in outside issues? Is there not the danger of becoming embroiled in controversy? Why would we care if people think they are addicted to drugs? It's none of our business. Besides, public agencies and health organizations are perfectly capable of organizing their own information-gathering devices to find out how many people may be dually addicted.

We are not a health agency. We don't do social work. We are a Fellowship of the heart and spirit dedicated to the proposition of staying sober and helping other alcoholics to achieve sobriety. We have no business boiling ourselves down to statistics for purposes and people over which we have no control.

Question 14 reads: In addition to your alcoholism, were you addicted to drugs? Is there anyone in this room who is willing to define what "drugs" that refers to? Heroin? LSD? Nicotine? Caffeine? Can you bear hearing one more "new-ager" talking about being addicted to sugar? How about gambling? or sex? There are people out there who will tell you that those things are drugs. Maybe they are. I don't know. Neither do you. And as a group, we are equally ignorant about the issue. The wonderful thing about alcohol is that it is so easily identifiable. There isn't any discussion about what it is. It's simple. The way we need to keep it.

Jane M. Schulberg, Grapevine director

A "Pro" Viewpoint

With the exception of a few phrases added by the writer to provide clarity or continuity, the following points are taken from background information provided by the trustees' Public Information Committee and a past G.S.O. general manager.

The first Alcoholics Anonymous Membership Survey was conducted in 1968 for two reasons. First was the need to provide the professional community with credible and quantifiable facts about A.A. The second reason was to provide A.A. with accurate information about itself so members could more effectively carry the message. The survey as a whole is indispensable from the perspective of A.A. as an organization. The information we get from the survey helps to inform our group conscience so, together,

we may make sound decisions affecting A.A. as a whole.

In pursuit of these two purposes a question concerning drug usage appeared on the June 1977 survey in which 18 percent of the respondents said they were addicted to drugs besides alcohol. In 1989, 12 years and four surveys later, about 46 percent of the sample indicated they were addicted to drugs in addition to their alcoholism. These recent findings are corroborated by the many members we hear identifying themselves in meetings as being dually addicted.

While that verbal information is alarming to some, the factual information of the survey confirms that a large influx of people coming into Alcoholics Anonymous consider themselves to be addicted to drugs, in addition to their alcoholism. This is important information for Alcoholics Anonymous. It tells us that our singleness of purpose is being severely challenged.

The ultimate purpose of the presentation this evening is to help us fully and openly gather a renewed and true conscience on our single purpose, carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Drugs are the "elephant in our living room." To think that the issue will go away if we don't refer to it, and that it will disappear if we stop asking about it, is not realistic. We need to take constructive action based on information Question 14 is delivering to us. Even if the perceived threat from drugs is real, choosing the stance of the proverbial ostrich is not the way to oppose it. On the other hand, the Conference-approved "blue card" is an honest attempt to confront the problem. The resolution of this question will be found in open-minded and factual discussion, not in uninformed and biased opinion.

A careful rewording of the question might reduce the present level of disagreement. The words "drugs" and "addicted" are broad to the extent that they may generate confusion and denial. There are prescription drugs and street drugs. Members may have illegally used and abused either or both types of 'drugs' without considering themselves addicted. Possibly the trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees could refine this wording to be more specific and more easily understood by those responding to the survey.

At the very least, however, Question 14 does tell the Fellowship what percentage of its membership considers itself to have a problem with drugs. That is a judgment which is similar to how we judge ourselves to be alcoholics. We settle that question only with honesty and our own admission.

Resolution of the Question 14 dilemma is likely to be found in the same combination of admission and acceptance. Because acknowledgment of this reality is so important in maintaining our single purpose of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic, Question 14 should be retained on the 1992 Membership Survey.

Julian Rhinehart, Nevada

LOVE AND SERVICE

The final presentation session on Wednesday evening was on Love and Service. Don Bruner, West Central U.S. regional trustee, moderated the session that concluded at 8:25 p.m., prior to the final sharing session of the day.

Love and Service

Love and service—when I received a request to do a presentation on this topic I was at first panic-stricken and then "at calm"—all within a few minutes. You see, I do believe. My third reaction was, love and service, or is it love of service? This is how I feel.

I serve in gratitude for my sobriety. My service work is how I give back what I was so freely given. I haven't had much success in my Twelve-Step calls, so I feel this may be the only way I can give it back, through service.

Bill W. wrote, on page 129 in *The Language of the Heart*, "our first General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous gathered at New York City in April 1951. . . . The single purpose of our Conference was to serve A.A. throughout the world." Bill adds, "This unexciting statement now carries a deep meaning for all who were there. We came to believe that A.A.'s future had been made secure. We became certain that A.A. could live for so long as God might need us."

Bill continues, "Why did each witness of the Conference feel so deeply about it? I think for two reasons: The group conscience of all Alcoholics Anonymous was heard to speak for the first time. And we realized, as never before, how perilous 'faith without works' might really become. So it was, that A.A.'s group conscience heard its first high call to service." Bill goes on to write, "Of course much work would always have to be done, much responsibility would have to be taken by many. To A.A. as a whole, every member would need to give a little."

On page 130, Bill adds, "The Conference scene that Sunday afternoon we last met will always be a precious memory in the annals of A.A. For in that historic assemblage we could all hear the voice of Alcoholics Anonymous. These were the words: 'To serve A.A. is to live. We gladly accept our Third Legacy and may we guard it well and use it wisely. God grant that the Legacy of Service remain ever safe in our keeping.'"

Look around you. This is love of service and of each other. I believe we are all here for the same reason: to do our best to ensure our Fellowship will continue as it has always been intended, through a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience. Let us reflect on this today. What do we, as individuals, want to see for the future of A.A. as a whole? How can we ensure that we are carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic? There are so many of us still out there.

Someone at my home group said almost 15 years ago, "Marne, it's not a requirement that you like everyone in this room, but it is a requirement that you love them," and I do. I want always to be able to go to my group, shake someone's hand and be happy to be there in sobriety.

My sponsor has given me many things over the years; all of her cards and books over the years have always been signed, "your friend and sponsor." She cares for me, helps me, straightens me out—a lot. She makes weekly trips to the treatment facility for Fifth-Step work and sponsorship. Her service work is there and she does a wonderful job.

On March 7, 1992, at the end of a long-distance telephone call, she said, "Goodbye, Marne. Thanks a lot. Take care and I love you, eh." "I love you" was said for the first time. This is love and service. So I say, "Thanks a lot. Take care and I love you."

Marne Crary, Ontario (Northwest)

Twelfth Step: Our Basic Service

All parts of our Fellowship—group meetings, committees, offices, conferences, and group jobs—have one joint purpose: to help that newcomer who has a drinking problem. But, in order for A.A. to run itself, we have to have a system for finding out how A.A. as a whole feels about its world affairs and how it wants to operate. We need constant, honest communications from one part of A.A. to every other, furnishing a wide cross-section of A.A. experience. The General Service Conference makes that possible.

You and I may not need a General Service Conference today to insure our own recovery, but what about the millions of sick alcoholics still stumbling out there in the dark? When they come trying to find us we want each of them to get the same loving help we all had. The Conference and the whole general service system has that responsibility: to keep A.A. alive and well for those who are still to come.

I discovered the love of all alcoholics for each other many years ago. I stumbled in and out of the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous for twelve years after having five years of sobriety. During those twelve years of using and abusing almost every A.A. member I came in contact with, not once was I ever refused admission to an A.A. meeting. Every time I literally crawled back to a meeting, I was always greeted with a smile and a handshake and they all said the same thing, "Welcome back, Bill. Come on in and try it again." I didn't realize it at the time, but when I later got sober and got involved in A.A. service work, I discovered that they were offering me their "love and service" in Alcoholics Anonymous.

When I was sober about three years, I started to want more from my program than just going to the closed and open meetings of my home group. I had heard about G.S.R.s, but I had no idea what they were about. I called a friend (from a different group) who I knew had something to do with G.S.R.s and asked him about it. He said I was welcome to come to the next G.S.R. meeting. I later discovered that he was the D.C.M. at the time. I went to the G.S.R. meeting and went back to my home group and told them that we needed a G.S.R. for our group. They didn't know what I was talking about, so they said if the group needed one, I was it. That was the start of my service experience and I've been at it ever since . . . for twelve years now.

Shortly after I became a G.S.R., I was talking to one of the oldtimers in A.A. who had more than twenty years of sobriety. He said, "Don't get involved in that service stuff. It's all politics. You'll get drunk for sure." When I was elected delegate for Area 75, I went back to him and told him what happened and that I hadn't gotten drunk yet. I just had to rub it in a little bit.

Being involved in service work over the years has given me a lesson in love for my fellow alcoholic that I never dreamed would be possible. Sitting in prison meetings, treatment center meetings, district meetings, area assemblies, area conference committee meetings and through last year's General Service Conference proceedings has given me the whole scope of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. I have sat in all these various meetings and heard many things I didn't like, many things I did like and many heated arguments; held many resentments, been blamed for many things for many different reasons; been praised for many things that I had nothing to do with; and have walked out of these meetings to be hugged and greeted by everyone. That is the true love of one alcoholic for another.

Just a few months ago, I had the opportunity to attend a regional young peoples conference in A.A. in Milwaukee, Wisconsin. The love and enthusiasm that they have for Alcoholics Anonymous proves that the future of our program is in good hands and will always be available for our children and grandchildren.

Even though you and I may disagree at various times about our beloved Fellowship, I love each and every one of you and I know that each and every one of you loves me. We all have the same common goal, to stay sober today and try to help another alcoholic get sober today. I will never forget what my first sponsor said to me as he was taking me to my first A.A. meeting. I asked him what was this A.A. thing going to cost me? He replied, "A.A. is free. Someday when you have helped someone else to get sober, then you have repaid me." With the help of my Higher Power, I have tried to repay that debt, one day at a time. That is my

concept of love and service in Alcoholics Anonymous.

William Hellesen, Wisconsin (Southern)

JOY OF LIVING

The final presentations of the Conference were delivered Friday afternoon after the final committee reports. Moderator Jim Key, delegate from North Carolina, introduced three speakers on the Joy of Living.

The Newcomer: A.A.'s Future

Just as A.A. assures that the newcomer has a future, so must the newcomer assure the future of A.A.

I sincerely believe there will always be three very distinct elements of time or history involved in our Fellowship—the past, the present and the future. Just as most of our founding fathers have passed from the scene—the past—so too must the present. And like good and caring parents we must allow the newcomers—the future—to write their own chapter in the archives of A.A. history.

Being the bankrupt idealist that I am, I would like to tell them how to accomplish that, but I believe our Second Tradition tells it best: "For our group purpose there is but one ultimate authority—a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience. Our leaders are but trusted servants, they do not govern."

Thus, throughout the years, our Fellowship has found many turning points, and the right decisions have been reached to enable A.A. to continue to grow and carry the message of hope and recovery to many dark corners of the world. I have to believe that has happened largely due to our spirit of rotation, which allows newcomers the opportunity to be of service to God and those about us.

I have entered each new level of service work as a newcomer with a bit of apprehension. But always, by the time I had to move on, I had acquired a great deal of enthusiasm and anticipated great accomplishments. But, alas, you told me to move over and allow a newcomer an opportunity to grow.

When I entered the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous, my first sponsor, who was very active, went to great lengths to encourage me to get involved with newcomers. This has given me the opportunity to see them grow, and I, in return, have had many enjoyable moments.

Once again, as rotation time grows near, I look forward with eager anticipation to spending time with newcomers and their families, and seeing the joy of living becoming a reality in their lives, as it has been for so many of us.

Elmer Chaney, Illinois (Southern)

Principles Before Personalities

The joy of living was always my goal in my pre-A.A. days. I knew that when I discovered the right formula life would become one long joyful and exciting experience. I tried very, very hard to find exactly the right mixture of people, places and things. You can well imagine how successful I was in accomplishing this goal.

It took a long time in A.A. before I began to understand that the elusive joy of living wasn't to be found outside myself. This spiritual quality of life was, for me, attained through a change in attitude. I accomplished this by practicing, to the best of my ability, the Twelve Steps along with the Twelve Traditions.

What does the topic, "Principles Before Personalities," have to do with the joy of living? As I began to read, I discovered our literature tells us that this phrase is very closely linked to anonymity, humility, sacrifice and honesty—none of which I connected to joy! When I heard the last Tradition read, I didn't understand it, but I was struck with the power of the words: "Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our traditions. . . ." But how could it be spiritual? When it finally occurred to me that anonymity had something to do with attitude, I could grasp that anonymity might be spiritual. I sensed that if I practiced anonymity, I might develop or alter my attitudes. Even without understanding it, I tried to practice anonymity and started to develop an attitude which was far different than my natural state. I felt the desire to be the center of attention, to receive constant recognition and credit, was being curbed.

When people speak of anonymity they are often referring to the privacy aspect. A more important point is that anonymity is a tool which allows us to practice humility. Before A.A., I was quite familiar with "humiliation" but "humility" was foreign to me. I was embarrassed, ashamed and humbled by my disease. My urgent needs, when a newcomer, made me teachable. But I knew myself well enough to know that my newfound humility would not last. I sensed that I'd soon be bouncing back into my normal state of know-it-allness or arrogance. I was afraid of having my own confidence restored. I understood that I was beaten. I wanted to stay beaten and stay teachable. In A.A. I had learned that humility would be an important factor in my recovery. It was the doorway to spirituality.

A spiritual writer said that the purpose of humility is to remove obstacles to God's grace. This is how it has worked for me. In the beginning, I was in a hard shell. As I tried to follow the Twelve Steps, a tiny crack occurred. As I tried to practice the Twelve Traditions, a ray of light widened the crack. I heard that the problem with humility is that once a person thinks they have it, they've already begun to lose it. Newcomer fear was good only for a limited time, and I knew it. If the newcomer's teachability was not going to last I needed tools to practice and cultivate humility. I found a very important one in grateful action; doing things that say thanks. Service of any kind keeps me mindful of where my strength is coming from. I do not stay sober alone. This knowledge is very important for me because I'm not naturally grateful. An attitude has developed within as a result of my actions. I try hard to apply the two vital tools of anonymity and grateful service in my personal life.

Today the Twelfth Tradition is very important to me. "Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our traditions, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities." An attitude of openness to God's grace and a desire for humility have developed within from a willingness to be in action. I found the formula and found from Whom my joy of living comes.

Jackie Johnston, California (Southern)

Humility Through Rotation

On page 267 in *Best of the Grapevine*, Vol. I, Bill says that ". . . the A.A. custom of rotation in office can be a healing experience for those who can take it and understand the spirit behind it. Rotation is not spelled out in any Step or Tradition, . . . But it mercifully helps solve the seniority problem we older members can inflict on new ones. . . ."

In the years before Alcoholics Anonymous my life consisted of the party life. I was involved in country club, service and civic organizations, trade organizations (of which I became a director of the national institute); I was a member of a political executive

committee, and part owner of a construction company, a swimming-pool business and a fast-food franchise. I had lived this life-style of power, authority and control for about 20 years before coming into Alcoholics Anonymous and thought it was the only way to go. There was no rotation there—lots of arrogance—but certainly no humility. So, you can imagine that when I went to my first meeting, I wanted to get connected and find the person who headed this thing up so I could work my points and offer my assistance.

It so happened that this meeting had a literature raffle and the tickets were being sold by the door. It was a large meeting and it looked, I now know, like your average A.A. meeting. A short while before the meeting started, this man came in, neatly dressed in a blue seersucker suit, shirt and tie, with every hair in place. He went directly to the lady selling the tickets and sat down beside the money. Where I come from, the guy who gets the money is the guy who runs the show. I don't remember many of the people I met that night but I have never forgotten him. I later found out this man worked for the local radio station and came to the meeting directly from work. So much for my first power play.

It was a while after that they invited me to my first business meeting and he wasn't even there. Someone else was chairing the meeting and it was explained to me that this was the business meeting for the home group I was now a member of, and that each of these officers only served so long and then they rotated out and someone else would come in. This was my first experience with rotation and I was just rotating into a new way of life that I knew nothing about—and few of them let me know it. They weren't especially nice, either.

After a couple of years, I was asked to be the general service representative for the group. I was now becoming familiar with the Traditions and soon learned that the Second Tradition meant just what it said about one ultimate authority, "a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience." I also learned that our leaders "are but trusted servants; they do not govern."

This was the start of many rotations over the years, from G.S.R. to A.C.M., to D.C.M., to district chairman, to the area level and then to delegate. With each rotation came a higher level of not understanding, a little more humility, a lot less ego and arrogance and a great deal more patience and tolerance for the new person moving into service to start on their own cycle of rotation. I guess this is what Bill meant when he said it would solve the seniority problem we inflict on the newer members.

I believe that as I rotated up in service, I went through that period when the fog began to clear and I came to understand better the wisdom of rotation. I became more willing to turn over the office I had and make myself available to help (if asked). I became more willing to allow them to make the same mistakes I had made as they started their journey in service. As I moved up in service and advanced from office to office, I found that there was as much humility involved in taking on a new office about which I knew very little, as there was in giving up the one I had done such a great job with and in which I had a proprietary interest.

My sponsor had told me early on that I should encourage the people I sponsor to get involved in general service; become their service sponsor and have alternates ready and willing to stand for the openings as I moved out. Rotation and humility would be part of the message I could pass on to them. I firmly believe that if we adhere to the spirit of rotation, "the *spirit* which now binds us together in our common cause will always be stronger than those personal ambitions and desires which tend to drive us apart." (*Language of the Heart*, p. 8)

Dick LaGasse, South Florida/Bahamas/V.I.

Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees, and G.S.O.



These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: In March, the General Service Office and the Grapevine moved into new quarters at 475 Riverside Drive in New York City. It is a welcome move that gives us the best office accommodations we have ever had at perhaps the lowest rent we have ever had, adjusted for inflation. The low rent is possible because our new offices are in a building that houses only tax exempt organizations.

The move to the new offices was accomplished without disruption to our customary activities. Much credit for the smooth transition goes to G.S.O.'s management personnel who, with the assistance and oversight of the A.A.W.S. directors, supervised the construction of the new space and organized the move. We also owe a debt of gratitude to the G.S.O. and Grapevine employees, whose hard work contributed to this move becoming a reality.

A year ago the Conference convened in Rye, New York, a pleasant community about 25 miles north of New York City. Under the Conference Charter, the Conference is required to meet in New York City, unless otherwise agreed upon. Last year's Conference considered the site for this year and, as a result of that consideration, we are back in New York City for the current sessions. We hope you will be pleased with the return to what is fondly referred to as "The Big Apple."

While the computer system is completely operational, it is not, as yet, being fully utilized. Soon, we will be able to get essential information quickly, consistently and in greater detail than ever before—in short, we will be able to provide more efficient service to A.A. The management and auditors are winding-up the process of defining what kind of financial reports will best meet everyone's needs.

Both A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine operated profitably in the past year. That is welcome news. However, sales of both organizations decreased during the year, as did contributions from the Fellowship. The decreases may be the result of a depressed

economy, but the General Service Board is keeping close watch over the situation. Corrective measures will be taken, if necessary. We live in changing times, and, without question, we have to change with the times or risk being left behind.

The chairpersons of Conference committees attended the quarterly meeting of the General Service Board in early February of this year. With rare exception, that arrangement has been enthusiastically endorsed by all participating in it. The policy recognizes that the Conference is a year-long activity and that frequent communications among Conference members helps in carrying out the work of A.A.

During 1991 we published the Big Book in four new translations: Arabic, Lithuanian, Turkish and Vietnamese. We are indebted to the Houston Intergroup, which, at its own expense, provided us with the Vietnamese translation. In all, the Big Book has been translated into 22 languages. More and more, A.A. is reaching out to alcoholics all over the world in languages that they understand.

In the past year, we tried to identify, through an informal study, measures that are effective in extending the hand of A.A. to hard-to-reach alcoholics. A report of the study will be distributed to members of this Conference to do with as they please. What is clear from the report is what we have known all along, namely: the best way to deliver the A.A. message is by one alcoholic talking to another alcoholic, in words and ways they both understand. We hope the report will remind A.A. groups and individual members of our solemn obligation to carry the A.A. message to all alcoholics who need it.

Once again, we are at the threshold of a new Conference year. Our predecessors have done well to bring A.A. to the point at which it now stands. It is for us, their successors, to move forward resolutely so that the hand of A.A. will always be there when anyone, anywhere reaches out for help. With the grace of God, we too will advance the cause of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Michael Alexander, chairman

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: A.A. World Services, Inc. is a wholly-owned subsidiary of the General Service Board. It has the delegated responsibility to maintain oversight of the group services, including publication of Conference-approved and service literature,

effected by G.S.O. The board meets monthly to: hear G.S.O. staff reports; consider requests from A.A.s and non-A.A.s for permission to reprint A.A. copyrighted literature; review budgets; and discuss matters of G.S.O. administration.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors. Four are trustees, including two regional trustees; three are nontrustee directors; one is the G.S.O. general manager; one is the staff coordinator. Also attending board meetings, but not voting, are other G.S.O. staff members, the controller, assistant controller/business administrator, the services director, the publications director, director of human resources, and the secretary. In addition, a Grapevine staff member is usually present.

The following items of significance are noted:

Big Book in ASL: Production of the Big Book in American Sign Language (ASL) was approved.

New pamphlets: Packages of two new pamphlets, "The Twelve Steps Illustrated" and "Bridging the Gap," were made available to P.I., C.P.C., corrections and treatment facilities committees at a discount.

Regional Forums: A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff members coordinated and attended four Regional Forums in 1991: Northeast in Bethesda, Maryland; West Central in Omaha, Nebraska; East Central in Columbus, Ohio; and Southwest in Tulsa, Oklahoma.

Intergroup Seminar: The Sixth A.A.W.S./Intergroup Seminar, coordinated by G.S.O., was held September 27–29 in Memphis, Tennessee. Three directors, two regional trustees and ten G.S.O. employees participated. Ad hoc committee meetings during the weekend resulted in approval of a Site Committee, a Policy Committee and guidelines for future Seminars. Full responsibility for the seminars has now been assumed by the central offices and intergroups, and will no longer be coordinated by A.A.W.S., although A.A.W.S. will continue to participate. The 1992 Seminar will be held in Mesa, Arizona.

Foreign-language Literature: The March 1989 translations policy statement on the Big Book and other translations of Bill W.'s works was revised to include the following: "Upon publication, all translations of the Big Book, regardless of how initiated, shall contain all of the front matter appearing in the U.S./Canada English-language version, including 'The Doctor's Opinion'; the forewords and prefaces; the basic text (pp. 1-164); 'Dr. Bob's Nightmare'; and the appendices. Whether any other material which does not appear in the original will be permitted to be included in the translation shall be determined on a case-by-case basis. Where the material is in conflict with the message conveyed by the Big Book, permission to include such additional material, will not be granted."

The following materials were priced: Big Book in Lithuanian, Turkish, Polish and Vietnamese; "The Twelve Steps Illustrated," "Is A.A. for Me?," and *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, in Spanish; "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic," "Understanding Anonymity," "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" and "Young People and A.A." in Russian.

Group Registration: Group registration guidelines were developed as service material and will be mailed to area committees.

Reprint/Publishing/Translations Subcommittee: The board accepted three of the subcommittee proposals: 1. that the A.A.W.S. Board continue to set prices for new items, whenever possible, within existing guidelines, but never at less than cost; 2. that the category "Special Literature Packages" be expanded to include multiple copies of individual pamphlets, for which there is a large demand by certain committees, at low costs; 3. that each spring there be an annual review of pricing, gross margins,

discount policies, and shipping and handling costs.

It was suggested that, as a cost-saving measure, service workbooks be produced as paperback booklets.

The board approved the expenditure of \$10,000 for a four-color printing of the literature catalog, with illustrations.

G.S.O. Personnel: In the absence of a general manager, the services director served as acting manager from August 1991 until the position of general manager was filled by George Dorsey in March 1992.

After years of service as the G.S.O. staff member handling the Spanish Services assignment, Vicente Mejia retired in March 1991. Danny Mooney, a native of Argentina, joined the staff as Vicente's replacement.

Reprint Permission: The board granted permission/did not object to 141 requests to reprint from A.A. literature; 14 such requests were denied.

Literature Pricing: The following materials were priced: Large-print edition of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*; "Bridging the Gap," "The Twelve Steps Illustrated"; Unity Placard; three film strips on ½" cassettes.

General Service Conference: At the request of the 1991 Conference, that a suitable hotel in New York City be found, the Holiday Inn Crowne Plaza was selected as the best choice for the Conference.

Litigation: The board adopted services director Tom Jasper's Presentation on Litigation. The board also agreed that, on the advice of legal counsel, the board has no alternative but to proceed with litigation against a jewelry manufacturer who continues, in spite of correspondence from G.S.O. over the last two years, to infringe our trademarks by using the circle and triangle on jewelry.

Data Processing: The separate modules of the computer program are operating and the General Ledger has been implemented. The board expects to have financial statements from the computer for comparison with the manual statements.

Long-Range Planning Subcommittee: This subcommittee considered a number of matters ranging from the composition of the A.A.W.S. Board and the participation of its directors to missions and goals of the general manager. It also reviewed salary compensation practices for the G.S.O. staff and the A.A.W.S. retirement plan.

In discussing the board's communications with the general service structure, the subcommittee suggested that "A.A.W.S. Highlights," reporting board and G.S.O. activities, be sent to all Conference members on a trial basis. The subcommittee plans to explore additional means for improving communications and also suggested that the A.A.W.S. Board consider a yearly inventory in terms of its planning.

Salary and Budget: The 1991 budget, including price increases effective April 1, was recommended to the trustees' Finance Committee. In July, A.A.W.S. adjusted the contributions budget, reducing it by 8.5%.

For the year 1991 we sustained a loss of \$431,000, represented by \$715,300 net operating income and \$1,146,300 nonrecurring duplicate rent and construction expenses.

The 1992 budget, as recommended to the trustees' Finance Committee, projects net sales of approximately \$9,800,000; and contributions of approximately \$4,180,000. Total operating expenses are projected at slightly over \$8,870,000. Net operating income is projected at \$790,000. After construction expenses of approximately \$1,200,000 and duplicate rent payments of \$240,000, a 1992 net expense is projected at \$651,000.

Self-Support: The board approved the recommendation of the

A.A.W.S. Self-Support Committee that the Individual Birthday Plan Program developed through the General Service Office, be implemented. A letter to that effect was sent to the Finance Committee chairperson, and to all Conference members. The letter was included in the February/March 1992 issue of *Box* 4-5-9.

The Self-Support Committee recommended that the Conference Finance Committee consider an ad hoc Self-Support Committee consisting of delegates, which would communicate with the trustees' Self-Support Committee throughout the year.

The board approved the recommendation that the A.A.W.S. Self-Support Committee be dissolved, and that we send a liaison to the trustees' Self-Support Ad Hoc Committee.

Directors: In 1991, Greg Muth replaced Phil Cels as trustee-director. Subject to Conference approval, Peter Brock has been recommended to replace Hugh Freyer as director, upon Hugh's rotation effective May 1, 1992.

Relocation: Over a weekend in March 1992, the General Service Office moved its entire operation to new quarters at 475 Riverside Drive, where they occupy the 11th and part of the 10th floors.

Jan Whitney, chairperson

ARCHIVES

Trustees' committee: During this past year, the trustees' Archives Committee has continued to evaluate the Archives as it is now and to plan for the Archives as it will be in the next century. We focused on revising the Archival Handbook, adding to the scope of the G.S.O. Archives, insuring the security of our holdings, carrying further the Gathering of Experience Proposal, and, as a beginning of implementing plans to classify archival materials in a way that better serves the Fellowship, we have arranged to incorporate Group Birthdates into chronological listings for area archivists.

Consideration was given to the completeness and representativeness of the G.S.O. Archival holdings. It is hoped that important area archival documents, either the original or photocopies, will be sent to the G.S.O. Archives so that they will be available to the Fellowship as a whole and for researchers. Our collections, in turn, would be shared with local archives wherever access, security and guarantees of anonymity are satisfied. International materials will continue to be gathered.

Evaluation of G.S.O. Archival holdings also brought to light the sparsity of documentation in many important areas. It seems probable that if we proceed with one aspect of the Gathering of Experience Proposal, some filling in of gaps of the records may be begun. (Parenthetically we should note that, as proposed last year, we did take the Gathering of Experience Project to a board Sharing Session and came away with the sense that the input of past trusted servants was of value and should be sought, but that the project as originally envisioned should be modified.) As a trial run, we are now planning to send questionnaires to the 135 past delegates and trustees from the first ten General Service Conferences to see if it is possible to increase substantive background information on selected Conference Actions. The trustees' Archives Committee will continue to concern itself with making the archival holdings a full and accurate record of the Fellowship.

Recognizing the growing interest in group and local area histories, the G.S.O. Archives will soon be able to make available the date of a groups' founding or registering with G.S.O. This will allow groups and areas to be aware of their places in the overall tapestry of the Fellowship.

The G.S.O. Archives was established to be the repository of our shared experience. In the past, our founders and founding members lived the history, grasped the patterns in it, could protect us from distorting the record and could help us to find

our way. These members have either left us, or will soon be leaving; thus, now and in the future, the Archives must concentrate on capturing our past and continuing experience for the use of the future. For, as Bill remarked, "On the anvils of experience, the structure of our Society was hammered out."

Joan Jackson, Ph.D., chairperson

Archivist's report: Our former archivist once observed that the fires of interest ignited and fueled by an International Convention rage long after the last booth is struck and banner rolled. And so this wisdom was again proved during 1991. By all measurements—visitors; correspondence; gifts; phone calls; and now, faxes—1991 was a stellar year.

Measurements aside, however, Archives is very much a matter of the heart. As our individual histories are vital to an understanding and appreciation of our own recoveries, some understanding of our collective history seems necessary to celebrate fully the magnitude of our gifts within this Fellowship. The stories of those who have gone before help us toward this insight. And the oral histories of many of these earlytimers swelled our collection in recent months.

In the near future, we plan to collect systematically the recollections of past delegates and trustees of early General Service Conferences. Also in development is a plan to provide areas with the founding dates for all groups; this would provide a draft of chronological listings of the A.A. groups. With the aid of the area archivists, we can then refine this information, adding the many groups that we hitherto had no knowledge of, to complete the picture of the growth of Alcoholics Anonymous across the U.S. and Canada.

Frank Mauser, archivist

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 1992

	Groups	Members
United States	48,747	1,079,719
Canada	5,173	90,735
Correctional facilities	1,783	54,782 ¹
Internationalists		248
Lone members		386
Total	55,703	1,225,870
Outside U.S. & Canada	40,755	894,260 ²
Total	96,458	2,120,130

1. U.S. and Canada only.

2. We are still in the process of updating statistics for groups and members outside U.S. and Canada. These numbers are the same as reported for 1990. As of this date, only eight G.S.O.s have responded to our survey. Therefore, these figures will be updated for 1991 at a latter date.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each nonreporting group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: The committee met three times since the 1991 General Service Conference. Over that period we reviewed the 1991 Advisory Actions pertaining to the General Service Conference, and approved that the theme for the 42nd General Service Conference be "The A.A. Message in a Changing World." It was also recommended that the Conference Workshop be on the Conference theme. The committee reviewed suggestions received through the Conference Evaluation Questionnaire, the G.S.O. Post-Conference Sharing Session, and other suggestions received from the Fellowship and from the Conference Committee, and recommended the following:

- That the Conference be extended to start earlier on Sunday morning at 10:00 a.m.
- That the Conference Workshop be held on Sunday afternoon, in order to enhance communication and raise the level of comfort for all Conference members through participation and sharing early in the Conference week.
- That more time be allocated for Sharing Sessions, and that after each presentation a time be set aside for questions and sharing.
- That there be presentations/discussions on Medallions, Trademarks and Logos; New Delegate Areas; a report from the General Service Board on Advisory Action #32—Merit Pay; a presentation/discussion on Question #14 from the P.I. Membership Survey; and a presentation on A.A. Past, Present and Future—A Report from the Board.
- That a Topic Sharing Lunch be held on Monday and that it be evaluated by the participants and a report be given to the trustees' Committee on the Conference.
- The committee reviewed all items submitted for the 1992 Conference consideration, and referred each item, as appropriate, to the standing Conference committee, Sharing Session, Workshop, or trustees' committee. All items were addressed and responded to, including those not placed on the Agenda because of recent Conference discussion or where matters were more appropriately referred to local autonomy.
- The committee reviewed and finalized the Conference Agenda, assigning participants for the various presentations.

Greg Muth, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the contact for all General Service Conference members. The coordinator's desk also serves all of the committee members of the 91 areas throughout the United States and Canada. The General Service Conference, created in 1951 by our co-founders Dr. Bob S. and Bill W. became, in July of 1955, the "guardian of the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous, the perpetuators of the world services of our Society, the voice of the group conscience of our entire Fellowship, and the sole successors of its co-founders, Dr. Bob and Bill."

The General Service Conference is a year-long process and the Conference coordinator is actively involved with Conference members in a cooperative effort to make the annual meeting of the Conference all that the Fellowship needs it to be. All A.A. members are asked through the area committees to submit items for the Conference to address. These are brought to the trustees' Committee on the Conference for consideration and referral to an appropriate committee or back to local autonomy. The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presenta-

tion/discussion and workshop topics, which are then reviewed for selection by the Conference Agenda Committee and recommended to the trustees' Committee on the Conference for approval.

- Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Corresponding regularly with delegates, alternate delegates and other area committee members throughout the year.
- Working with the general manager and G.S.O. staff in planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and all material for the Conference Manual, Early Bird Edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.
- Reviewing all area and district correspondence, as well as minutes and reports received from area and district committees.

Pat Rosenstiel

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community has met three times since the last General Service Conference. At the July meeting, the recommendations and suggestions of the 1991 Conference C.P.C. Committee were reviewed. It was noted that the Preamble, the Twelve Steps and the Twelve Traditions will be added to the pamphlets: "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs," "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession" and "If You Are a Professional" as soon as the current supply has been exhausted.

A subcommittee also met three times since the last Conference, and prepared a revised draft of the pamphlet "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession," which was referred to the Conference C.P.C. Committee for their consideration. The text has been expanded to include A.A.'s views on alcoholism from the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*. The text has also been revised to use language which would be helpful to members of healthcare professions as well as members of the medical profession. The Conference Committee has also been asked to consider revising the title to "A.A. as a Resource for the Healthcare Professional."

The subcommittee presented a revised text of the C.P.C. Workbook section "Working With Treatment Facilities" which will be reviewed by the Conference C.P.C. Committee. The subcommittee reviewed the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" and recommended that the words "self-help" be deleted in two sentences of the current pamphlet, based on several letters submitted from the Fellowship. This recommendation was forwarded to the Conference C.P.C. Committee.

The service sheet "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous" was reviewed by the subcommittee and minor changes were approved by the full committee. Information about four videos was also added.

The committee accepted the subcommittee's recommendation to ask the Conference C.P.C. Committee to consider deleting the six-point definition of an A.A. group from page 19 in the pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Other Community Efforts to Help Alcoholics" and replacing this definition with the Conference-approved language from the pamphlet "The A.A. Group," page 15. The recommendation is based on the 1991 Conference Advisory Action #15.

The committee has asked the subcommittee to continue examining the effectiveness of our participation in national conferences and the effectiveness of the visual content of the C.P.C. Professional Exhibits.

The committee reviewed the A.A.W.S. request to consider changing the format of the C.P.C. Workbook to a less expensive format similar to the A.A. *Service Manual*, and agreed to ask the Conference Committee to consider the proposed change in format.

Professional Exhibit Schedule 1992: To date, the C.P.C. Committee has committed to exhibit at 20 national conferences or professional meetings in 1992. The selection of these conferences was based on evaluation questionnaires, submitted by local C.P.C. committees, which evaluated cost factors, requests for A.A. literature, interest in A.A.'s exhibit, requests to be added to the *About A.A.* mailing list and emphasis on reaching minority populations effectively. To date we have received 50 additional requests for A.A. participation in national conferences and professional meetings.

Presentations Requested in 1992 (a partial list): I.Y. Solovki Forum, Archangel and Solovki Islands, Russia; National Council on the Aging Convention; Conference Focusing on Substance Abuse With Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing People; Texas Commission on Alcoholism and Drug Addiction Summer Institute. We have completed several Calls for Papers and continue to try to participate in both national and local conferences and meetings where we are unable to exhibit due to financial restraints.

The committee recommended the purchase of two additional tabletop exhibits. One new tabletop exhibit is now stored in the Toronto Intergroup Office for use by Canadian C.P.C. committees. The second additional tabletop unit is located at G.S.O. and is used primarily for Regional Forums and local C.P.C. service events. The committee's focus has been to increase the awareness of the role of C.P.C. committees at the district and group level as well as the area and regional levels within the Fellowship.

Projects in progress:

- *About A.A.*—The committee is considering including a letter emphasizing A.A.'s position on our primary purpose, nonaffiliation, anonymity and self-support in a future *About A.A.* mailing. Future editions of *About A.A.* continue to focus on basics: What A.A. is and is not, singleness of purpose, anonymity and a consistent and accurate message. It was also suggested that the C.P.C. staff member contact various conferences to request that *About A.A.* be included in complimentary Conference literature packages.

- *Professional Exhibits:* The committee will continue to research the most effective way of communicating the A.A. message through professional exhibits. Local C.P.C. committees will be encouraged to borrow or purchase tabletop units to be used at local and state events.

- *Communication With Area C.P.C. Chairpeople:* The committee has asked the staff member to notify area C.P.C. committee chairpeople of all correspondence from local professionals to give the local C.P.C. committees an opportunity to contact these professionals.

Summary: At every trustees' C.P.C. Committee meeting we discuss the wide range of professionals with whom C.P.C. committees continue to cooperate. One area C.P.C. committee contacted medical students, sheriffs, probation officers, community health center officials, clergy, mental health professionals, university residence managers, community members with older adults, teachers, and home health aides. We hope to support the Fellowship's C.P.C. Twelfth Step work.

John Hartley Smith, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: The C.P.C. staff person is responsible for responding to any professional from the United States and Canada requesting information about A.A. In 1991, the majority of mail inquiries

were from healthcare professionals, treatment facilities administrators, clergy and, on a weekly basis, from middle and elementary school teachers and guidance counselors. Area C.P.C. chairpeople are notified of all inquiries from professionals so that, in making referrals to Alcoholics Anonymous, professionals will be able to share their own experience that A.A. definitely responds with not only letters and literature but also with personal contact from local C.P.C. committee members.

We now have listed 87 out of 91 area C.P.C. chairpersons and the staff person communicates with them on a regular basis. Area, district and central office C.P.C. committees are encouraged to forward minutes of C.P.C. committee meetings to the General Service Office. Their experiences and successes in C.P.C. Twelfth Step work are a basis for sharing with other C.P.C. committees, as well as in *Box 4-5-9*.

The C.P.C. staff person coordinates the storing and shipping of six C.P.C. Professional Exhibits to national and local C.P.C. events in the United States and Canada. Complimentary literature is also provided for both local and national professional events, tailored to the participants. The C.P.C. staff person also responds to requests for more information about Alcoholics Anonymous and requests to receive the *About A.A.* bulletin from professionals who attend these events.

The C.P.C. staff person receives an evaluation questionnaire from each C.P.C. committee involved with a national professional exhibit. These evaluations are used to determine which professional exhibits will be recommended for participation to the trustees' C.P.C. committee. Local C.P.C. committees are encouraged to include videos in their exhibits where appropriate. In 1991, the C.P.C. assignment forwarded to local C.P.C. committees information about 100 different professional conferences where, due to budgetary constraints, we did not exhibit. As an alternative, local C.P.C. committees are encouraged to contact exhibit organizers to offer open A.A. informational meetings, A.A. presentations or regular A.A. meetings for participants, as well as complimentary literature.

We continue to help the professional gain knowledge of Alcoholics Anonymous through the triennial newsletter for professionals, *About A.A.* In 1991 the topics for *About A.A.* were: "The A.A. Grapevine: A Meeting in Print," "A.A. in the '90s: Same Aim but Broader Outreach Efforts," "A.A. Reaches Out to Our Friends in the Corrections Field." A computer sweep has reduced the *About A.A.* mailing list from 28,000 to approximately 11,000.

Professional conferences that trustees' C.P.C. committee members, Class A trustees and the C.P.C. staff person have attended since the last Conference are: Fourth Learning Community Conference; Troubled Adolescent Conference; Aging and Alcoholism Seminar, National Council on Aging; Twelve Step-Twelve Traditions Conference; National Association of Alcoholism and Drug Abuse Counselors, University of California, San Diego, Annual Summer School of Alcohol and Other Drug Studies; Drug Free Workplace Conference and Exposition; 20th E.A.P.A. National Conference; and S.E.C.A.D./91.

The contents of the C.P.C. Workbook continue to be reviewed by the Conference and trustees' C.P.C. Committees. A new section on Anonymity has been added.

The staff member serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference C.P.C. Committees, continues to provide information about C.P.C. Twelfth Step work to the Fellowship, and information about A.A. to as many professionals as possible. As the definition of "professional community" expands, we strive to continue to carry an accurate and consistent message to those professionals who come in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic before he or she comes to Alcoholics Anonymous.

Valerie O'Neill

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities is to recommend ever-improving ways to help carry the message to alcoholics in correctional facilities.

Since the last Conference, our committee has met three times and through the work of subcommittees completed the following projects:

- Reviewed submitted examples of area Correctional Facilities Committees work and selected one area for inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook.
- Reviewed submitted stories from young people in correctional facilities and forwarded two to the trustees' Literature Committee for their consideration to include one in the pamphlet "Young People and A.A."
- Selected stories for audio tape of A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate.

The committee recommended the addition of page 575 of the Big Book, "How to get in touch with A.A.," to the booklet A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate.

In discussing the magnitude of free literature sent by G.S.O. to correctional facilities and inmates, the committee recommended that the staff members on the assignment contact local committees for those who indicate our literature is needed for a substance abuse program. The committee thought that local members are in a position to help by suggesting ways these programs can obtain our literature. In addition, the committee agreed that a letter based on the one sent to treatment facilities in the United States and Canada in 1991 clarifying our Traditions on primary purpose, anonymity and nonaffiliation be developed for correctional facility personnel with the inclusion of a paragraph on self-support. This mailing should also include delegates and correctional facilities chairpersons so that local follow-up can be made.

The committee agreed with the recommendation of the A.A.W.S. Board to change the format of the Correctional Facilities Workbook from a loose-leaf version to a paperback booklet.

We referred to the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities the suggestion to review the Correctional Facilities Directory and consider whether it should be continued in its present form.

This committee welcomes all suggestions to help search for ways to better communicate the A.A. message to those on the "inside."

Amos E. Reed, chairperson

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities desk extends the hand of Alcoholics Anonymous to those who are unable to walk to a meeting, call a sponsor or otherwise participate in the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous which we on the "outside" take for granted. At the present time there are 1,900 correctional facilities groups and 1,000 correctional facilities committee chairpeople, members, group sponsors and contacts.

In addition to serving as secretary to the Conference and trustees' Correctional Facilities Committees, the staff member on this assignment writes over 6,000 letters a year. Basically, correspondence with inmates falls into three main categories: Providing information about the Fellowship through complimentary literature; providing information about the Corrections Correspondence Service; answering requests to set up an A.A. support network prior to an inmate's release.

Other correspondence responds to all aspects of correctional facilities service. The Correctional Facilities desk writes directly

to local correctional facilities committees when an inmate has contacted G.S.O. with release dates and information. The intent is for correspondence to begin with A.A.s in the inmate's home community so he or she leaves the facility with personal experience of the "outside" Fellowship prior to and immediately upon release. This correspondence is in addition to the Corrections Correspondence Service in which an "outside" A.A. member shares the message of recovery during the inmate's term of confinement. Large literature requests are referred to local correctional facilities committees to establish direct contact between correctional facilities' groups and local committees. The Correctional Facilities desk has collected a current list of correctional facilities committee chairpeople and local contacts to refer inmates' requests for prerelease support to local committees. The waiting time for an inmate to be connected with an "outside" A.A. member through the Corrections Correspondence Service has been reduced from months to weeks. Articles in *Box 4-5-9* about the Corrections Correspondence Service will, hopefully, create more interest in the ongoing need for correspondents to carry the message of recovery. The Correctional Facilities desk contributes articles to *Box 4-5-9* to assist communication of correctional facilities service work to the widest possible A.A. membership.

The Correctional Facilities Workbook continues to be reviewed and updated to serve as a resource to local correctional facilities committees. As the prison population is expanding rapidly and the rate of alcohol-related crimes is increasing, the work of the trustees' and Conference Correctional Facilities Committees, as well as local committees, truly is on the front line of carrying the A.A. message.

Helen Turnquest

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' committee: The results for 1991 of the General Service Office and the Grapevine reflect positives as well as negatives. First, there is the bottom line for the General Service Office, an operating income of \$710,100 for 1991 versus an operating income of \$1,049,600 for 1990. After adjusting for extraordinary income and expense items such as International Convention income (\$181,000 in 1990), computer implementation project (\$311,400 in 1990), and then relocation/construction project (\$1,146,300 in 1991), the net loss for 1991 was \$436,200. This compares with a net income of \$919,200 in 1990. The construction/relocation project enabled G.S.O. to move to lower cost facilities during 1992. Contributions, originally projected by A.A.W.S. at \$4,567,500, were revised downward at mid-year to \$4,179,500, came in at \$4,153,700, approximately \$25,000 below the revised budget, \$412,000 below the original A.A.W.S. budget and, of special note, \$260,000 less than 1990.

Net sales for 1991 were originally budgeted by A.A.W.S. at \$12,200,000, but actually finished the year at \$10,384,100. The reality was \$1,815,900 below original budget, but approximately \$150,000 higher than projected when A.A.W.S. realized that the original sales budget was unobtainable. Last year we noted with concern, that 1990 book volumes (exclusive of the new item) for the first time in anyone's memory declined by 6.3% from 1989. In 1991, exclusive of the newer items (*Daily Reflections* and *A.A. in Prison*), unit volumes again decreased. The decrease from 1990 in units was 5.6%. We also know that we distributed almost 80,000 fewer Big Books, or almost 7% less than the prior year. Internally A.A.W.S. has noted that the bulk of our reduction in sales is from those entities outside the Fellowship.

Total operating expenses for the year were \$9,349,300; approximately \$216,200 (2.3%) less than budgeted and approximately

\$500,000 or 5.6% over the prior year. The income generated by publishing was able to cover the shortfall of Office Expenses over contributions. This deficit (shortfall) was approximately \$269,200 compared with approximately \$11,000 for 1990 and a budgeted shortfall of \$510,000 due to strict office expense controls. Additional publishing income was then used to offset other expenses of the board as well as part of the cost of the relocation/construction project. The balance of the relocation/construction project funded in 1991 came from the Reserve Fund. As indicated last year the budget for 1991 reflected literature price revision toward the aim of obtaining adequate gross margins. For 1991 we had approximately a 56.4% gross margin after allowing for discounts and miscellaneous items compared with 53.8% in 1990.

The 1992 G.S.O. budget was prepared with a watchful eye toward lower sales volume. In addition, contribution revenue was projected as flat. The total G.S.O. income is budgeted at \$9,664,000. Total operating expenses for the year are budgeted at \$8,874,000, approximately \$475,000 (5%) less than 1991 operating expenses. There is a \$790,000 operating income projected for 1992 which will be used to offset part of the construction/relocation expenses for the move to the new building. The balance of funding will come from the Reserve Fund with net expense for the year 1992 estimated at \$1,200,000. Based on preliminary construction plans, \$1,686,000 was intended to be expensed on the project in 1991 and \$1,440,800 in 1992. However, once the project was actually underway, only \$1,146,000 was expensed in 1991 and it became necessary to defer \$540,000 until 1992.

During 1991 the Reserve Fund earned approximately \$550,000. The Reserve Fund received transfers from the Grapevine of \$119,650 and \$650,000 from A.A. World Services. \$1,100,000 was transferred back to A.A. World Services to fund the construction project. While the results of 1991 and budget for 1992 reflect expenses for the construction/relocation project, it is anticipated that over 10 years there will be considerable savings as square-foot rental cost drops from the old \$24.00 per sq. ft. (to which is added cleaning, etc.) to \$12.00 per sq. ft. (including cleaning).

The Grapevine had a reasonably good year. Net income for the year was approximately \$104,000, some \$38,000 higher than budget; however, approximately \$90,000 lower than 1990. Revenue amounted to \$2,038,000 while expense totaled \$2,032,000, thus resulting in a net income from operations of approximately \$6,000. This compares with a net income from operations of \$86,600 in 1990. While the gross profit from the magazine was higher than the prior year by approximately \$56,000, excess of income over expenses for the other items decreased by approximately \$128,000, as a result of lower unit sales, thus resulting in the decreased income from operations. The Grapevine budget for 1992 forecasts an operating loss of approximately \$35,400, offset by interest income of \$103,000, resulting in a net income of \$67,600. This is comprised of revenue estimated at \$2,031,000 and expenses estimated at \$2,066,000. Expenses are estimated to increase approximately 1.7% over 1991 actuals.

The General Service Board Reserve Fund had a fund balance of \$7,315,140 yielding approximately 7.2% on book value and representing approximately 8.5 months of coverage of combined operating expenses (G.S.O. and Grapevine). This is approximately \$220,000 greater than the balance at December 31, 1990.

Robert P. Morse, chairperson

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: The three General Sharing Sessions since the last Conference discussed issues of specific interest to the board and the Fellowship.

The topic in August 1991 centered on a proposal submitted to the trustees' Archives Committee regarding the gathering of experience of past trusted servants. This idea had been discussed at length by the committee, and, through questionnaires, the thoughts of 1,000 former trusted servants toward such a project had been surveyed. The proposal suggested that we might avoid losing the experience of our past trusted servants if we could somehow provide a historical context to help inform and enrich consideration of issues of current concern to the Fellowship. Sharing was lively on all sides of the issue, particularly as to how this considerable experience could be harnessed. The discussion was most valuable to the Archives Committee and all present.

In November 1991 the topic was "Twelve Concepts for World Service," and included two thought-provoking presentations. Discussion focused on how we can better implement the Twelve Concepts in the service structure today. Is it time for A.A. to make any structural changes? If so, what kinds of changes are advisable? Are the Twelve Concepts applicable to the 1990s? Bill W. said there might come a time when structural change would be necessary; but, he added, if a change were to be made, it should first be made on an experimental basis. Ongoing communication within our structure is essential and, when it becomes necessary to make changes, we need the widest possible input of those involved. The Twelve Concepts are a pillar of our Society, a vital tool on a worldwide basis. We A.A.s possess great freedom because of the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts.

The topic of the General Sharing Session in February 1992 was "Future Challenges for the World Service Meeting." Following the presentation, an interesting discussion followed. Most participants agreed that how to best carry the A.A. message worldwide—by working with World Service delegates and other countries' structures—is an extremely complex issue. Some believed that we should proceed cautiously in any effort, making sure that we do not inadvertently become involved in promotion rather than attraction. Questions were raised regarding the logistics involved in administering a foreign literature assistance fund equitably. Also, the task of checking translations for authenticity, international registrations and more was discussed. It was pointed out that our structure has begun, through the Overseas desk at G.S.O., to codify the handling of translations, assess priorities, and continue work on producing a current inventory of all existing foreign literature. Countries with strong structures do help neighboring countries with translations and more. The trustees' International Committee will continue to discuss, both in committee and with the World Service delegates, matters concerning worldwide literature and, ultimately, worldwide participation in the World Service Meeting.

Don Bruner, chairperson

GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: The chief responsibility of group services is to serve the groups. We provide service material to the Fellowship in order to communicate with each other and with the 54,023 groups in U.S./Canada. There is a variety of service material available to A.A. members upon request. A descriptive three-page service sheet describes these service items in detail. Service material is different from Conference-approved literature in that it has not come about through the Conference process but results because of an expressed need on a particular subject. Service material reflects A.A. experience and information that is shared through us here at G.S.O. and is subject to change.

Current service projects under Group Services involve:

- Production of the video cassette of the Big Book, *Alcoholics*

Anonymous, in American Sign Language (ASL). Translation, rehearsal and recording of the first 164 pages is in the works. The goal is to have the project completed by the end of the summer and available in the fall. Chapter V, "How It Works," is already available on the "Conference-approved Literature and other Service Material" order form.

- Communication with central/intergroup office managers and involvement with the newly established Policy Committee of the Central Office Seminar. The next Intergroup Seminar will be held in Mesa, Arizona, September 18, 19, 20, 1992.

- Implementation of individual A.A. Birthday Program, initiated by the Self-Support Committee of the A.A. World Services Board. The hope is to reach individual A.A. members and suggest an annual A.A. birthday contribution.

- Coordination and production of five A.A. Directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S., Canadian, International, and Correctional Facilities. The staff member on Group Services works closely with the Special Projects Manager regarding group printouts to areas and central/intergroup office records.

- Supervision of G.S.O. service files. There is a variety of service material available to A.A. members, upon request. Recent additions to the service files are "Suggestions For Group Registration," "Use of A.A.'s Trademarks and Logos," "New Group Information Forms," "New Group Change Forms," and additional information for Special Needs Committees.

- Supervision/production of service material which includes A.A. Guidelines, Group Handbooks, G.S.R. kits and D.C.M. kits.

Correspondence with the Northeast Region is another aspect of the Group Services assignment. Current group concerns in 1992 seem to be: Traditions questions, group concerns about disruptive members, questions about medallions and tokens, questions about incorporating and filling out group bank accounts, and communication about group apathy. Many A.A.s visit G.S.O. from the Northeast Region and the staff member talks with group members in person and on the telephone.

The staff member on Group Services serves as secretary for the trustees' Nominating Committee and the Conference Committee on Trustees. Both committees have had a busy year because there have been openings for a Class A trustee, as well as a search for a new general manager. The trustees' Nominating Committee has reviewed policies and procedures regarding openings for Class A trustees, general service trustees, nontrustee directors, appointed committee members, hiring of general manager, and hiring of G.S.O. staff and Grapevine staff.

Service meetings are coordinated by the Group Services coordinator every few months. We have met with the manager of the Data Control Department and the manager of Special Projects at the weekly staff meeting.

Susan Ulseth

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION / A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—The committee reviewed 1991 General Service Conference Advisory Action 13 regarding equal consideration of Atlanta, Minneapolis and Toronto as a site for the International Convention in the year 2000. The ad hoc site-inspection team was asked to inspect the three cities and report back to the committee. At the November 1991 meeting, following reports by the ad hoc site-inspection team and full discussion,

the committee unanimously recommended to the General Service Board that Minneapolis be the site of the International Convention in the year 2000.

The committee continued to review various suggestions and options for the program at the 1995 International Convention, and agreed that further consideration be given when other data, including cost factors, become available. In place of a full evening of professional entertainment, suggestions to be considered included an A.A. Pioneers Meeting, an International A.A. Meeting, and more. It was agreed that entertaining in a stadium is truly a challenge, and consideration might be given to entertainment in other locations.

The committee also discussed the audiotape and photo sales arrangements of the previous Convention and will review the bidding process for both of these vendors at its next meeting. The 1992 budget was reviewed, amended and accepted.

The committee read a letter from an A.A. member in Maine concerned about Canadian laws regarding D.W.I. convictions, and free passage between the U.S.A. and Canada, and how they might impact an International Convention in 2000, if held in Canada. The committee chair agreed to look into the matter. Subsequently, the chairperson apprised the committee that concern about Canadian laws regarding D.W.I. convictions and free passage between the U.S.A. and Canada had been investigated, and it was determined to be of no substance.

Regional Forums—From the West Central Region's record-breaking Forum in Omaha to the sometimes volatile sharing at the Southwest Regional Forum in Tulsa, 1991 was definitely a record-breaking year. The West Central, East Central, Northeast and Southwest Regional Forums all had the largest participation in their regions' history. All four weekends in 1991 were Forums with incredible energy and dedicated A.A. sharing. While each Forum is based on a similar format, each has its own flavor.

Dr. Jack Norris, late chairman emeritus of the General Service Board (Class A trustee), in his recognition of the need for continuing dialogue between the board and A.A. members in all regions, had the vision to describe and initiate A.A. Regional Forums. This vision is being fulfilled as A.A. service people in the United States and Canadian regions share directly with the trustees of the General Service Board, the directors of the two service corporations, A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine, as well as G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members and employees. There have been 68 Regional Forums since they began in 1975, four of which were held in 1991.

Each Regional Forum has an agenda which includes workshops, presentations, sharing sessions, reports, and Ask-It-Basket questions. Topics for presentations and workshops are suggested by the regions' delegates and other A.A. service people. After the Forum is over, a Final Report is produced and mailed to participants, delegates and trustees. These Forum reports are available for any members who would like to look at such an A.A. weekend in encapsulated form.

During 1991, the trustees' Committee on International Convention/Regional Forums agreed to have at least one of the four most-recent A.A.W.S. videos shown at the main session of all Regional Forums. The chairperson also established a subcommittee to consider special Forums and to make recommendations on how to improve the Forum Reports and regular Regional Forums. The committee also recommended that, in its initial contact with the host for each Forum, the host contact be asked to take responsibility for coffee arrangements with the hotel and to sell coffee to Forum attendees. The office would take responsibility, under present guidelines, if the host area is unable to do so.

The committee recommended that a special Forum be scheduled during October of 1992 in Whitehorse, Yukon, in response to a request from the British Columbia/Yukon Area. The committee also affirmed that no A.A. meetings will be included on the agenda for Regional Forums but, if host areas wish to schedule A.A. meetings outside of the Forum session times, that is their privilege. Finally, the committee recommended that a presentation on the service structure of A.A. be included on all Forum programs.

The schedule for 1992 Forums is as follows:

1992		
July 24-26	Pacific	Santa Clara, CA
September 25-27	Eastern Canada	Hull, PQ
October 16-18	Western Canada	White Horse, YT
December 4-6	Southeast	Virginia Beach, VA

Phil Cels, chairperson

Staff report:

Regional Forums—The Regional Forums assignment involves the coordination and follow through for all arrangements necessary for holding the Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These weekends of sharing help to foster better communication and deeper understanding between A.A. service workers, the General Service Board, the A.A. World Services and Grapevine Boards, and the General Service Office, with A.A.s in all of the regions. Regional Forums are held at the region's invitation every two years and there are usually four Regional Forums annually.

The Regional Forums coordinator requests topics for presentations and ideas for workshop themes from the area delegates. Invitations are mailed to G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area committee officers, central offices and intergroups, past delegates and past trustees. The staff member prepares the agenda for the Forum weekend, using the ideas for presentation and workshop topics that have come in from the areas within the region for which this Forum is being planned. The Forum coordinator works hand-in-hand with the hotel to make sure that all requirements for the meetings, workshops, sharing sessions, as well as coffee and other details, are covered. He or she is also responsible for seeing that there are displays of A.A. Conference-approved literature, as well as Archives material, at each Forum. Interpreters and simultaneous translations, when needed, are also arranged by the Forum coordinator. The work for a Regional Forum often begins three or four years in advance. Every effort is made to ensure that a climate of open sharing and communication can take place in a comfortable setting. The chairman of the board, other Class A and Class B trustees, directors of the A.A. World Services and Grapevine Corporate Boards, and staff members from G.S.O. and the Grapevine, usually attend and participate in each Forum. When the weekend of sharing is finished, all presentations, report-backs, Ask-It-Basket questions and sharing sessions are condensed into a report by the coordinator and sent to all A.A. members who registered for the Forum.

Under the present structure of G.S.O., the staff member on the Regional Forums assignment also serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*, secretary to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, and responds to correspondence from groups in the Southeast Region.

Richard Bush

INTERNATIONAL / WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' committee: This committee has the responsibility of suggesting to the trustees policies and actions which will result in carrying the message to alcoholics overseas, particularly in countries where there is no service structure established. In this regard, the committee is attempting to be visionary rather than reactive in responding to expressed needs. In addition, the committee serves as a focal point for information about A.A. around the world and is also a link between the World Service Meeting and the General Service Board.

Overseas Literature—The committee agreed that a master plan to assess the needs for A.A. literature be developed and a subcommittee for long-range planning was formed. As a result, the committee recommended the following agenda items for the Literature/Publishing Committee at the Twelfth World Service Meeting: 1) Discuss ways of improving, enhancing and satisfying literature needs around the world; and 2) Regarding the International Literature Fund (recommended at the Eleventh World Service Meeting), should the World Service Meeting develop a mechanism to establish a priority of needs?

The committee approved a budget of \$130,000 for foreign literature assistance and recommended that the monies allocated for foreign literature assistance flow through the International Literature Fund.

The committee also recommended that, in accordance with the spirit of the Seventh Tradition, the benefactors of the International Literature Fund should be informed in some way of the cost and offered the opportunity to pay for the literature when they can. It was further recommended that countries receiving literature assistance be apprised of the costs expressed in their local currency and be reminded of the Tradition of self-support.

World Service Meeting—"Service: Everyone's Privilege" will be the theme of the Twelfth World Service Meeting which will take place in New York City, October 25-29, 1992. Approximately 40 delegates from 25 countries are expected to participate. David O'Leary, trustee-at-large/Canada, and I will represent our service structure.

As a result of discussion by the long-range planning subcommittee, we have recommended a presentation/discussion session on "The Future of the World Service Meeting."

Since the World Service Meeting is scheduled to end just prior to the board's quarterly meeting, the World Service Meeting delegates will be invited to attend the General Service Board meeting as observers.

Overseas Information—The committee received my report on the First General Service Conference in Czechoslovakia which I attended, on behalf of the board, April 26-27, 1991, at their invitation. I felt very privileged to attend this historic event and found it remarkable that they had reached the stage of having a conference when, for all practical purposes, A.A. did not exist in that country a few short years ago.

In regard to assisting countries where A.A. is in early stages of development, a report on the activities of other general service offices was presented by the staff member on the international assignment. At the request of two members of the former board of trustees in Italy, the committee heard a report on unity problems within the service structure there. The Italian visitors came to the committee with the understanding that the General Service Board for U.S./Canada cannot get involved in disputes in other countries. They came simply to seek advice and guidance. The committee agreed that the problems presented should be resolved by Italian A.A.s working within their service structure.

John Quinn, chairperson



Staff report: A.A. Literature Translations—The staff member on this assignment serves as the intermediary for translations of A.A. literature. To ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message, careful consideration is given prior to granting overseas boards, intergroups, and literature committees permission to print A.A. literature in the native language of a country. The translation is reviewed and, if found to be satisfactory, the means of financing and distributing the material are explored. The request for permission to print or reprint is then presented to the A.A.W.S. Board.

Under the auspices of the trustees' International Committee, A.A. World Services, Inc. also initiates translations and prints foreign literature based on indicated needs from A.A.s in other countries. This policy applies to countries where A.A. is in the formative stage and no service structure exists or in countries that are unable to publish their own A.A. literature because of economic conditions.

Since the last General Service Conference, *Alcoholics Anonymous* has been published in Polish and Vietnamese.

World Service Meeting—Planning and coordinating the biennial World Service Meeting is a major responsibility of this assignment. Every four years the meeting is held in New York with alternate World Service Meetings held in a country selected by a Site Committee. The primary purpose of the World Service Meeting is the same as that of all A.A. activity—to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers, wherever in the world he or she may be, whatever the language he or she speaks. The World Service Meeting seeks ways and means of accomplishing this goal by serving as a forum for sharing the experience, strength, and hope of delegates who come together every two years from all parts of the world. It can also represent an expression of the group conscience worldwide.

Regional Service Meetings—The European and Ibero-American Service Meetings are also held biennially, alternating with World Service Meetings. The staff member on the assignment is often invited to attend the interim service meetings.

International A.A. Directory—The staff member also oversees the updating of the International A.A. Directory used by traveling members and for Twelfth Step purposes. The 1992 International Directory is scheduled for distribution in May.

Correspondence—All correspondence from groups or members outside the U.S. and Canada (with the exception of Spanish groups), is handled by the staff member on this assignment in addition to correspondence with 37 general service offices and literature distribution centers in other countries.

Lois Fisher

LITERATURE

Trustees committee: Projects completed—As the result of General Service Conference approval, the following items have become available: (1) "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, with minor changes. (2) "Circles of Love and Service" filmstrip, slides and video: discontinued after present inventory depleted; thereafter available in video format at cost. (3) "The Twelve Steps Illustrated" pamphlet, published. (4) *Daily Reflections*: Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions were added, and the reflection "One A.A. Miracle" was substituted for the original February 29 entry. (5) "The Twelve Concepts Illustrated" pamphlet: the inaccurate line will be deleted at the next printing. (6) *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* published in large print. (7) The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions are included in all recovery literature, wherever possible, when reprinted.

Projects completed and manuscripts or reports forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee (based on previous Conference Actions): (1) Complete draft of manuscript of A.A. History book; (2) The story of John, a young person who found A.A. in a correctional facility, is forwarded for inclusion in the pamphlet "Young People and A.A."; (3) Report from subcommittee to study the best possible ways to carry our message to minorities.

Project in progress—(based on previous Conference actions): Interim report of Literature Review Subcommittee forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee.

Other matters sent to the Conference Literature Committee: (1) "Your G.S.O. Today," recommended that this pamphlet be updated after the move to 475 Riverside Drive. (2) Consider new disclaimer on sexist language be added as a footnote to the Preface in the Big Book. (3) Subcommittee report on the inconsis-

tent use of the six-point definition of an A.A. group in literature and service materials was forwarded for consideration. (4) Suggested draft of Anonymity display card from P.I. Anonymity Subcommittee, forwarded for consideration. (5) Consider adding material on Service Sponsorship to "The A.A. Group," "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship," and *The A.A. Service Manual*. (6) Report on costs for alternate formats of *Daily Reflections* forwarded. (7) Forwarded directly to Conference Literature Committee a request from an area for a literature moratorium.

Jean Smith, chairperson

Staff report: The literature coordinator serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees and works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on preparing all new recovery pamphlets, books, displays and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. The coordinator, along with the editor, follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department.

The literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about literature. We maintain contact with all current area, district, intergroup and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and material to assist them in this vital responsibility. Additionally, the literature coordinator is the liaison with the French Literature Service in Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

John Grant

LONERS, INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS

Staff report: As the name implies, Loners are A.A.s who are unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. There are now about 386 Loners in 110 countries, including the U.S. and Canada. Seagoing A.A.s are known as Internationalists, and there are now about 248 Internationalists and 36 Port Contacts. Fifth-six Internationalist Groups meet aboard ships or in ports. We now have 150 Homers, A.A.s who are housebound due to long-term illness or physical disability, in the Loners/Internationalists Group.

Loners, Homers, and Internationalists stay sober reading A.A. literature and sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters and tapes. A literature package is sent to each new Loner, Homer or Internationalist. Each receives directories of Loners, Homers, and Internationalists. They also receive complimentary subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners/Internationalists Meeting (LIM)*, which is a bimonthly discussion meeting in print, sharing excerpts of letters received at the General Service Office from LIM members.

About 990 A.A.s serve as Loner Sponsors, sharing group activities and personal experience with Loners, Homers and Internationalists. With approximately 2,050 A.A.s (including Loner Sponsors) participating in the *Loners/Internationalists Meeting* by mail, we might call it the largest A.A. group in the world. A.A.'s phenomenal worldwide growth can be attributed largely to Loners in distant lands and Internationalists sailing the Seven Seas who carry the A.A. message wherever they may be.

The mail received on the Loners desk often makes you feel the same as you would sitting in the front row of an A.A. meeting. The openness and earnestness about A.A. and how it's working in our lives is the same. For instance, we recently heard from an

Internationalist who shared the following from aboard ship:

Since my last letter to you, some exciting things have occurred. We now have an actual group complete with G.S.R., treasurer, literature person, etc. We have only three meetings a week, but not a day goes by that we don't have contact with each other. Three of us have over a year of sobriety and the others are newcomers. Thank God for them, because as our Big Book states, ". . . nothing will so much insure immunity from drinking as intensive work with other alcoholics."

Whenever I received orders here to Lamaddelina, I was afraid. I tried to fight God's will by turning the orders down, but after five months, I had to see the truth. My sponsor pointed out to me that I had a purpose here. At that time, I had no idea what it was. Whenever I arrived, the purpose was clear and defined. I knew that if I didn't get into action, my serenity and perhaps my sobriety would slip away.

I basically placed myself in a position where I would be available by speaking to the ship's doctor and the chaplain. Through this effort, I was able to meet others who share the same disease. Three months have passed and we have the opportunity to attend on a regular basis. Most of the A.A. history definitely helps us because it is like the early days here in many ways. Despite the fact that this is the end of the 20th century, many are ignorant of the road to recovery for the alcoholic. But it brings back a statement my first sponsor made to me when I was a newcomer: It doesn't matter if anyone else understands my disease, but I had better understand it. This has rung through many, many times in my sobriety, especially here. Staying in touch through the LIM definitely helps me to stay in touch. You are all in my heart and prayers.

The following letter is from a new Homer in North Miami Beach, Florida:

I received your letter today with the greatest of pleasure and gratitude. Your letter was the hand of A.A. letting me know that I'm not alone anymore—a feeling I've not had for three years since I've stopped working.

Please add my name to the Homers list. Thank you and remember the next impossible day that you have, the letter that you are processing might be going out to reach one of the many "me's."—God bless.

Sarah Price

NOMINATING

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Nominating Committee has met three times since the Conference and held several special meetings to interview applicants for general manager and Class A trustee. The committee received some communication from the Fellowship about rushing through the process for interviewing applicants for general manager. Two memos were sent to delegates explaining that Emergency Procedures for Hiring General Manager were being followed. At the February 3 board meeting, the position of general manager was offered to George Dorsey.

The following committee recommendations have been approved by the General Service Board:

- that all candidates for regional trustees from West Central and Western Canada Regions were eligible.
- that Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D., serve as Class A trustee, replacing Joan Jackson, Ph.D.

- that Francine Ward serve on the Grapevine Corporate Board as an A.A. Grapevine director, replacing Fran Polek.
- that Jacob B. Ham serve on the Grapevine Corporate Board as a regional trustee, replacing Jacqueline Martin.
- that Fran Polek serve as general service trustee on the Grapevine Corporate Board, replacing Desmond Towey.
- that Ann Bruning serve on the A.A.W.S. Board as a regional trustee, replacing Jan Whitney.
- that Peter Brock serve on the A.A.W.S. Board as an A.A.W.S. director, replacing Hugh Freyer.
- that Anne Geller and Ray Stiver serve as appointed committee members on the trustees' C.P.C. Committee, as recommended by that committee.
- that Roy Drake, Warren Stafford and Martha Watson serve as appointed committee members on the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee, as recommended by that committee.
- that Richard Steins and Eugene Pitts III serve as appointed committee members on the trustees' Literature Committee, as recommended by that committee.
- that Isadora V. Drayton and Ben E. Shapiro serve as appointed committee members on the trustees' Public Information Committee, as recommended by that committee.
- that appointed committee members to serve on the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee be tabled because no interviews have been conducted to date.
- that Gary Glynn continue his service as a consultant on the trustees' Finance Committee, as well as the A.A.W.S. Board, including an active role on the Salary and Budget Committee.

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May, following presentation at the 1992 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Michael Alexander	Robert P. Morse
John N. Chappel, M.D.	Amos E. Reed
Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.	John Hartley Smith, M.D.
John E. King	

Class B

Ann Bruning	Marc Pineau
Harold Greene	Fran Polek
Jacob B. Ham	John J. Quinn
Jacqueline Martin	Stanley N. Silverman
Greg Muth	Jean Smith
David F. O'Leary	Jan Whitney

(Two regional trustees to be selected April 29, 1992.)

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Michael Alexander
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	John E. King
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	John H. Smith, M.D.
<i>Secretary</i>	John J. Quinn
<i>Treasurer</i>	Robert P. Morse
<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Eileen Gatza

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc. to be presented to

the 1992 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Peter Brock	Michael McPherson
Ann Bruning	Greg Muth
George Dorsey	Everett Smethurst
Eileen Gatza	Jean Smith
Harold Greene	

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to be presented to the 1992 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Bernard C. Benziger	Jane M. Schulberg
John E. King	Stanley N. Silverman
Jacob B. Ham	Ames Sweet
Marc Pineau	Francine D. Ward
Fran Polek	Ann Warner

Five subcommittees of the Nominating Committee have continued their work over the year. (1) A subcommittee was formed to look into our rotation principle as it relates to appointed committee members, consultants, directors and general service trustees. This subcommittee work continues. (2) A subcommittee was formed to look into regional representation, vis-a-vis Class B trustees. This subcommittee has no report to date. (3) A subcommittee was formed to report on nominating procedures still under review. Eight Nominating Procedures were forwarded to the board at the August 1992 meeting; Nominating Procedure 15, Procedure for Hiring Grapevine Executive Editor, was approved. (4) A subcommittee was formed on the Twelve Concepts for World Service to examine the existing Concept essays in terms of adequacy of the reflection of the actuality of A.A.'s World Service Structure today. This subcommittee's work is in progress. (5) A subcommittee was formed to review the general policy that the chairperson, first and second vice-chairperson of the General Service Board be Class A trustees. This subcommittee has not met to date.

New Business: The Nominating Committee received a proposal from the area delegate, Southern Minnesota, to discuss Conference Committee chairpersons becoming members of corresponding trustees' committees, as nonvoting members attending quarterly committee meetings. (It was noted this would cost up to \$40,000 annually.) This subject was forwarded to the Conference Committee on Trustees for further discussion. A report back to the trustees' Nominating Committee will follow.

The trustees' Nominating Committee has initiated a search for Class A trustee Robert Morse's replacement immediately, due to the technical role the treasurer provides in Corporate Finance. A letter has been sent to trustees, delegates, directors and staff regarding this opening in 1993. The successful candidate will be presented to the 1993 General Service Conference.

John King, chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' committee: The responsibilities of the trustees' Public Information Committee include: (1) creating a greater understanding of the A.A. Fellowship by carrying our message to the alcoholic who still suffers through the public media, informational meetings for the public, and by responding to invitations from community groups to speak about A.A.; (2) developing public information material for use by local area P.I. committees; and (3) implementing Conference Advisory Actions.

Through our triennial Membership Survey we try to maintain an awareness of the composition and growth of A.A. as a whole, and of some specific populations such as young people. The

Survey helps us to determine where we need to do more to assure that the A.A. message is available to alcoholics who seek help. We also know that the Survey is helpful to professionals interested in A.A. information.

The committee produces A.A. informational videos, TV and radio public service announcements based on actions of the General Service Conference, composes and distributes press releases, and maintains the P.I. Workbook. In the past year, the committee forwarded to the Conference Public Information Committee:

- An explanation of their recommendation to retain Question 14 on the Membership Survey Questionnaire, and the changes to the Questionnaire approved in 1991.
- Outline of proposal for Traditions Communications Program focusing on Anonymity, responding to 1991 recommendation.
- Video production directed to young inner-city alcoholics based on pilot approved in 1991.
- A six-segment TV P.S.A. produced by three California Area Assemblies.
- Minor changes to the P.I. Workbook, and a proposed format change.

The committee also:

- Approved the addition of two nontrustee appointed committee persons.
- Worked with the Arkansas P.I. Committee to staff a booth at the National Newspaper Association Convention, and developed a press kit for those attending this convention.
- Revised their Composition, Scope and Procedure to include their work with films, radio and TV P.S.A.s, and to delete the outdated statement on "preventing misinformation of the A.A. program."

Stanley Silverman, chairperson

Staff report: The purpose of the Public Information assignment is to be a part of carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics who may not be aware of A.A. help for their drinking problem. The staff person and assistant annually respond to thousands of written and telephone inquiries from the general public. Many of these requests are passed on to local P.I. committees, who are the best available source of A.A. public information. Each year, the P.I. assignment helps to coordinate about 250 requests for A.A. cooperation from health fairs and other events where an A.A. presence is appropriate. The majority of these events is passed along to a district or area P.I. committee, which will usually staff a booth and share A.A. literature with those attending.

Recently, we are experiencing an increase in calls from local TV stations for A.A. information. Often, such a request will first go to the nearby P.I. committee, area delegate or intergroup, and we then will receive a call for guidance. We are aware of several ongoing contacts between local P.I. committees and nearby radio or TV stations. The results so far indicate careful follow-through and good cooperation between all A.A. services and the local media.

New Public Information committee chairpeople receive a P.I. Workbook, pertinent literature and Box 4-5-9. P.I. Literature Discount Packages are available to all P.I. committees, and new material is sent to these committees as they become available.

The P.I. desk receives about 300 clippings from the print media each month. Those with anonymity problems are relayed to the area delegate for follow-through. We try to communicate



with those media people who seem to need more accurate sources of A.A. information. This year, our Anonymity Letter was sent to about 1,500 daily newspapers, 740 TV stations and more than 4,000 radio stations. The P.I. desk receives calls from the media for "interviews," most of which turn into sharing sessions on what A.A. is and is not. Some requests came from CNN, ABC, PBS, *New England Journal of Medicine*, *Modern Maturity*, the *Boston Globe* and over 50 other daily newspapers.

We will begin to organize the A.A. Membership Survey questionnaire following the Conference this year, relying on the outcome of Conference considerations for guidance. The same is true of the video directed to young inner-city people who may wish A.A. help with their drinking problem. Our existing films, *Young People and A.A.*, *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* and *Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View* are used by P.I. committees, and continue to serve as good resources for media requesting filmed A.A. information.

The radio and TV public service announcements (P.S.A.s) are utilized by local P.I. committees working with stations in their communities. Three area assemblies have jointly developed six television P.S.A.s directed to teens and seniors, and these will be considered by the Conference Public Information Committee this year. This work may be further indication of the maturity and capability of areas to know what and how to provide accurate A.A. information for nearby media outlets.

The success of any public information work at G.S.O. is measured the same way as any other A.A. service: are we doing what we can to see that the message of A.A. is available to all, and do we continue to strive to see that the information conveyed about A.A. is accurate?

Joanie Moncrief

SPANISH SERVICES

Staff report: Since the late 1930s, when our co-founder Bill W. had a small office in Newark, N.J., one of his concerns was "... if A.A. could ever communicate so it could transcend the barriers of the languages." With the passing of the years this G.S.O. has always provided services in several languages. One of these has been Spanish, but it was not until 1984 that the assignment of

Spanish Services was formally initiated.

In our general service structure there are more than 30,000 Spanish-speaking A.A. members who don't speak English. They meet in 1,000 Hispanic groups in the U.S., Puerto Rico and Canada. The Spanish Services coordinator, who does not rotate, coordinates and revises Spanish translations of material from the other ten staff assignments and assists other staff members in providing services to the Hispanic community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. All Hispanic groups receive *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish.

As more bilingual people come into A.A., communication between the Spanish- and English-speaking groups is improving; the groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings, where they elect bilingual D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been added recently to the areas in our service structure. Service material is translated into Spanish and kept up-to-date. More and more Conference-approved literature is published in Spanish by our publications department. Spanish services helps answer the correspondence received in Spanish by most other assignments and especially by the International assignment.

The staff member on this assignment represents G.S.O. at the Ibero-American Commission for Translation and Adaptation of A.A. Literature. In addition, the Spanish Services coordinator attends conventions, Hispanic intergroup meetings, Regional Forums, the World Service Meeting and the International Convention, and greets Spanish-speaking visitors to G.S.O.

Danny Mooney

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services provided by G.S.O. to A.A. groups and members are divided at present into 11 staff assignments. In addition to assuming a functional responsibility, for example, Public Information, Correctional Facilities, or Literature, staff members correspond with groups and members in a specific region of the U.S. and Canada, or with A.A.s in overseas countries where there is no national G.S.O. Staff members rotate assignments every two years. These staff assignments are monitored by the staff coordinator. Currently, the work is apportioned as follows:

Conference: Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; Early Bird *Box 4-5-9*; *Final Conference Report*.

Cooperation With the Professional Community: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community; editor, *About A.A.*; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant to C.P.C. page).

Correctional Facilities: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant on Correctional Facilities page).

Group Services Coordinator: Secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees; supervision of service material, Guidelines, and A.A. Directories; Self-support Committee; liaison with Intergroups/Central Offices.

International: Secretary, trustees' International Committee; coordinator of World Service Meeting; *World Service Meeting Report*.

Literature Coordinator: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees; preparation and updating of pamphlets, books, and audiovisual material; liaison French Literature Committee.

Public Information: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for P.I. page).

Regional Forums/Box 4-5-9: Co-secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee; editor, *Box 4-5-9*.

Spanish Services: Consultant on any committee providing services to the Spanish-speaking community; Spanish language correspondence; editor, *Spanish Box 4-5-9*.

Treatment Facilities: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for Treatment Facilities page); editor, *Treatment Facilities Newsletter*; editor, *Loners-Internationalists Meeting*.

The staff work is divided into three units so that G.S.O. mail is processed and responded to expeditiously. Unit A consists of P.I., C.P.C., C.F., and T.F. Unit B includes coordinators of Staff, Conference, Regional Forums and Group Services. Unit C includes International, Literature and Spanish Services.

During the year, the G.S.O. staff handles approximately 20,000 pieces of mail. The staff coordinator ensures that mail is answered during vacations, sickness, and staff members' involvement with large projects. Training new staff members is another part of the staff coordinator's service assignment. When there is a staff opening, a letter is sent out to the trustees and directors announcing the opening and briefly describing the requirements for the job. The information is also posted in *Box 4-5-9*. Six years of sobriety is a requirement for a G.S.O. staff member. Business experience, good communication skills, A.A. service experience and geographic considerations are among the criteria used in the selection process.

Weekly staff meetings are scheduled to provide a forum for discussion of problems that require direction from the group conscience. From time to time, a service meeting is scheduled to give the staff an opportunity to become better informed about a particular assignment. The purpose of all staff meetings is to seek more and better ways of providing the very best in services to A.A. groups and members.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff scheduled trips, and all other absences, to ensure that the office is covered at all times. She also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments, and as a member of both the Office Policy and Procedures Committee, and the Personnel Policies Committee.

During 1991, staff attended over 73 conventions, assemblies, roundups and forums in the U.S. and Canada. This provides the staff with opportunities to communicate about G.S.O. services, to become acquainted with A.A.s all over the U.S. and Canada and, most important, to gain information on local activities that can be shared with other groups.

Throughout the past year, approximately 1,500 visitors from around the world visited G.S.O. Each visitor has the opportunity to tour the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. These visits create an opportunity to explain services to the Fellowship and learn about A.A. activities in each visitor's hometown or country. Often members and guests attend the weekly A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on most Fridays.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is also responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance material, and preparing and distributing the minutes of the General Service Board meeting; she also serves as editor of the *Quarterly Report*, the newsletter account of the board's activities.

As secretary of the General Sharing Session during the board weekend, at which trustees, members of all board committees, G.S.O. and Grapevine directors, and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members share on a wide range of topics, the staff coordinator schedules the presentations, and produces a summary in the *Quarterly Report*.

The staff coordinator is a voting member of the General Service Conference, and serves as secretary of the trustees' Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. In accordance with Concept IV, the staff coordinator is a director and vice-president of A.A. World Services, Inc.

The staff coordinator also provides oversight of the Support Services (secretarial/clerical) department, ensuring that the work at hand is facilitated in an expeditious manner.

Additionally, the current staff coordinator is serving as Coordinator of the 1995 International Convention.

Eileen Gatz

TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The chairperson of the Bridge the Gap Committee in Oklahoma suggested that a Bridge the Gap subcommittee of the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities be formed. It was the consensus that all efforts of the Treatment Facilities Committee focus on bridging the gap between treatment and A.A., and the committee does not wish to fragment this effort at the board level, even though a division of responsibilities may work well at the area or local levels.

Concerns were raised regarding the price of the new "Bridging the Gap" pamphlet. The initial price, \$0.25, subject to a 20% discount, was seemingly prohibitive for treatment facilities committees—the primary purchasers. In response, A.A.W.S. offered greater quantity discounts to treatment facilities committees to make wider distribution possible.

In an effort to gain substantive material for the "Treatment Facilities Newsletter," the committee made the following suggestions: Interview A.A. treatment facilities service workers on the phone; put an announcement in the Treatment Facilities Newsletter suggesting that people can submit their sharing on cassette, as well as in writing; develop an outline on how to write an article for the "Treatment Facilities Newsletter" for inclusion in the Treatment Facilities Workbook.

In addition, the committee asked the Grapevine Editorial Board to consider inviting articles from the Fellowship about the problems and successes of A.A. cooperation with treatment facilities. The Grapevine has accepted the suggestion, and a notice will appear in the June issue.

The committee also agreed that it would be helpful to the professional community working with alcoholics to know that A.A. service committees are available to make presentations. The committee agreed that the following paragraph appear at the top of the service piece that is included in the video case cover of "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous" when the current inventory is depleted:

"Many local A.A. service committees will, upon request, provide informational presentations for your organization. Check your local telephone directory for the number of Alcoholics Anonymous."

As additional information, the committee recommended that the Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community, Treatment and Correctional Facilities consider including the following paragraphs in all pamphlets directed to this group:

"Many local A.A. service committees will, upon request, provide informational presentations for your organization. Sessions may be tailored to meet your needs. A typical agenda might include one of several A.A. films and a presentation by one or more A.A. members on 'What A.A. Is and What A.A. Is Not.' A sample presentation overview and outline is available as an A.A. service piece from the General Service Office.

"Please call Alcoholics Anonymous. Check your local telephone directory for the number."

The committee recommended that the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities be asked to consider deleting the six points defining an A.A. group in the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities," and that the definition of a group in that pamphlet be consistent with the definition of the group in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet.

John N. Chappel, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to help A.A. members carry the A.A. message to the suffering alcoholic in treatment. There are 300 active treatment facilities committees. The staff tries to assist by providing information and serving as a resource. Each committee chairperson receives a complimentary Treatment Facilities Workbook. All who are serving on treatment facilities committees receive *Box 4-5-9*, "Treatment Facilities Newsletter" and *About A.A.* The staff member also answers correspondence from people in treatment interested in receiving information about A.A. or in establishing contact with the Fellowship in their home communities. Administrators of treatment facilities as well as counselors frequently contact us for information about A.A., so this assignment provides many opportunities to explain what A.A. can and cannot do in fulfilling our primary purpose.

The correspondence over the past year seems to fall into two categories. One from A.A. members inquiring about the Bridging the Gap program, the other from A.A. members in treatment facilities explaining that they have no money and are in need of our books—*Alcoholics Anonymous*, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, and frequently, *Daily Reflections*. In accordance with our Tradition of self-support, the Big Book is usually sent with a letter of encouragement and an offer to send a limited supply of books to the facility's library for the use of all. The local treatment facilities chairperson is also alerted by a copy of our reply.

In accordance with a suggestion from the Conference Committee, a service piece to assist members introducing A.A. videos/films or making informational presentations in treatment facilities was completed. This information has also been printed on card stock and inserted in the "Hope" video case cover.

The Treatment Facilities Workbook has been revised and reorganized to implement suggestions from the Conference and trustees' Treatment Facilities Committees. The A.A. Guidelines for Treatment Facilities Committees have also been updated. Obtaining material for the "Treatment Facilities Newsletter," in addition to the Treatment Facilities section of *Box 4-5-9*, continues to be a challenge. While it is still too early to tell, it looks as though we will be able to publish this bulletin twice a year as asked by the Conference.

Sarah Price

At a general sharing session, when discussion droned on and on regarding computers, general manager George Dorsey commented, "We all know what Rule 62 is. Rule 63 is 'Never let drunks talk about computers.'"

After Conference members had viewed the P.I. film for younger inner-city alcoholics, there was some discussion about the A.A. logo on the birthday cake. One delegate commented, "Don't worry. They ate the evidence."

Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: Since the 1991 Conference, the Grapevine Corporate Board has held four quarterly meetings and a special meeting to elect officers, and has also met four times as a planning committee of the whole. Three principal, related concerns have engaged the board's attention: magazine circulation, finances, and special items.

Circulation: Last April, Stan Silverman as chairperson reported that we considered the budgeted 1991 average circulation, 130,000, a conservative, perhaps pessimistic, estimate. In fact, it proved to be all too accurate, and indeed slightly optimistic. Circulation for 1991 began at close to 134,000, and went to a low of 126,500 by the end of the year, averaging out to 129,600. There is historically a circulation downturn after a price increase, and the year has followed the usual pattern, with the added complication of poor economic conditions. At budget time in October, we estimated the circulation for 1992 at an average of 127,000, and four months into the year we are not yet able to predict whether that represents optimism, pessimism, or a clear view of reality.

Some special efforts have been undertaken to give circulation a boost—notably a lot of hard work by delegates in their areas to heighten awareness of the magazine and its uses as a sobriety and service tool. In July, a mailing of one copy of the magazine along with informational material and an order form went out to all registered groups, and resulted in orders for about 1,400 copies. In December, everyone whose subscription had expired within the past 18 months received a “loving invitation” to rejoin the Grapevine family, and about 2,000 past subscribers accepted that invitation and became regular readers once again.

Finances: Year-end results for 1991 were good, with a net income of \$103,680—higher than the budgeted \$65,000—and the corporation was able to forward to the Reserve Fund \$78,000 as a contribution over and above the liability for unfulfilled subscriptions. In spite of the circulation decrease, magazine income remained healthy due to the effects of the April 1990 price increase. Sales of special items were down considerably, a result that seems to be in line with the lower sales of all A.A. literature. The positive bottom line for the year can be attributed to magazine income, along with rigorous monitoring of expenses and cost-cutting measures.

Editorial: 1991 was, as they say, a very good year. Two special expanded issues have been published since the 1991 Conference: in September 1991, a special issue on all aspects of service, and in February 1992, an issue by and about A.A. oldtimers. In addition, section emphases have ranged from sponsorship in May and June 1991 to A.A. in Prison (July) and the annual classic issue of reprints in November, featuring Dr. Bob. Thus far, 1992 has highlighted various “ages” of our A.A. Fellowship, with newcomers in January, oldtimers in February, and young people in March. April's theme was the annual section on spiritual experience, and the May issue is another expanded issue, built around the words of our Preamble and emphasizing Tradition Five. The constant focus has been on the “basics,” with a series on the Steps running throughout 1991 and a series on the Traditions beginning in January 1992. We have continued to reprint stories from the first and second editions of the Big Book, which have proved to be extremely popular.

A joy for many readers was the “return of Victor E.” drawn by a new artist, beginning with the July issue. The first effort had our little friend running away from the bar in nothing more than his shorts, and in succeeding months he has continued to escape that drink in new and imaginative ways.

The 1991 Conference Advisory Actions abolishing the About Alcoholism section and adding an article in Spanish to every issue have received mixed reviews; in particular some readers have objected to an article in another language. The subject will be



examined and discussed by the Conference Committee.

Grapevine Index, 1944–1990: The Grapevine Index was completed in January, and will be made available to the Fellowship in printed form at a cost of \$40.00. The 300-page volume covers the years from June 1944 through the end of 1990, and annual supplements will be prepared for the next several years.

Special Items: The board has spent a good deal of time talking about the place of special items—both editorially and financially—in the total Grapevine picture. We have looked at the kind of materials that seem to be most needed by the Fellowship, and as a board we believe strongly in the importance of communication with the Fellowship in the planning stages of new items. The Conference Committee will be taking a careful look at the whole subject.

Grapevine Representatives: As always, the Grapevine representative network remains at the heart of area, district, and group activity. Most areas have active Grapevine committees, and the number of group GvRs grows daily. Over the past year, the popularity of Grapevine discussion meetings has increased, and areas have shared with us such creative projects as adopting a Russian group with a Grapevine subscription and a “literature dance,” where the price of admission is copies of old literature to be used in prisons or other aspects of service work.

As Grapevine chairperson, I have had the great joy and privilege of communicating with all the delegates over the past year, and their enthusiasm for the Grapevine has been an enormous and valuable support to the work of the Grapevine Board. As I rotate on to new service opportunities, I want to express my gratitude to each and every one of you. For myself personally, and on behalf of my fellow Grapevine directors—thank you for your lives.

Jacqueline Martin, chairperson

Staff report: This report might be subtitled “The Grapevine—How It Works,” for its purpose is to describe what goes on in the office: Who are the people? What do they do? How are office personnel trying to better serve the Fellowship?

The Grapevine office staff consists of 20 people: three A.A. members, who are responsible for content and appearance of the magazine, and 17 nonalcoholics who make sure the financial state of the Grapevine is in order, that subscriptions are entered, and that special item orders go out on time. Team management through the joint efforts of the executive editor, managing editor, and controller ensures a healthy operation and good communication.

Editorial: The executive editor, Ann Warner, has overall responsibility as chief executive for the Grapevine operation, and

reports directly to the Grapevine Board. Editorially, she assists and serves as back-up for managing editor Ames Sweet, who is responsible for all aspects of magazine editorial and production and also oversees the Grapevine representative program. Together, the two editors evaluate all material for publication, select the content of each issue, and stay in touch with everyone who writes for the magazine. These are also the two people who stay in touch personally with the Fellowship through trips to Regional Forums and, when invited, other events. Part-time art director John Naydich designs the magazine each month, and the editorial-art staff prepares camera-ready copy of each issue in-house (printing, binding, and mailing are done in Pennsylvania). These three A.A.s are assisted by a nonalcoholic editorial secretary. (A free-lancer, also an A.A. member, does light copy editing of the manuscripts for each issue.)

Financial: Controller Bob Scherer manages all business aspects of the corporation and heads up the bookkeeping-accounting department, assisted by a bookkeeper who supervises four accounting clerks and the shipping operation.

Office Management: Office manager and corporate secretary Naomi Strassberg's multifaceted job includes ensuring the general efficiency of the office as a whole, administering the health insurance program, supervising the day-to-day work of the GvR coordinator, and handling all copyrights and permissions requests.

Circulation: Circulation supervisor Zola Bodden oversees four data entry clerks, who enter all subscriptions into the computer and handle requests for changes and any problems that may occur.

What's New Since April 1991?: Given the state of the economy, a high priority for all concerned has been monitoring costs, while maintaining and improving service. To that end, the shipping of most special items was moved out of the office in May 1991, making it possible to reduce staff by two people, leaving a one-person mail and shipping room. We have held down the cost of producing the magazine and special items, achieved some postage savings, and generally watched every expenditure to make sure we received full value for the scarce dollar.

The flip side of holding costs has been using resources wisely, and with circulation on the downturn, we have sent out two special mailings: one to all groups and the other to subscribers who had not renewed over a period of about 18 months. Both these efforts were successful in raising the circulation base.

Internally, procedural checks and balances have been tightened across the board, especially in the circulation, bookkeeping, and shipping departments, and while there is always room for improvement, significant progress has been made in making an effective operation even more so. A new position, data processing coordinator, was added in 1992 to make sure the Grapevine takes advantage of the full capacity of the new computer system, and to serve as liaison with the G.S.O. Data Processing Department.

Happily installed in new quarters, the Grapevine looks forward to the coming year with optimism and with eagerness to keep producing a high-quality magazine and better serve the A.A. Fellowship.

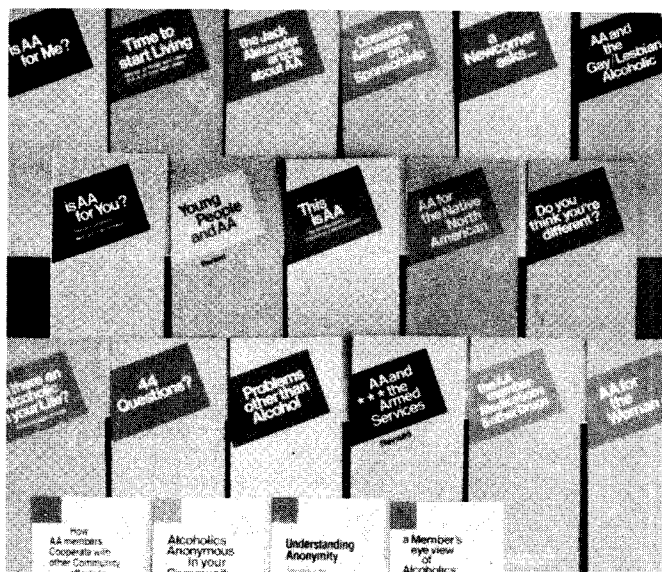
Ann Warner, executive editor

Although dad Ames Sweet, Grapevine's managing editor, waited throughout Conference week for that important phone call, newcomer Olivia Allen Sweet did not make her appearance until May 11, weighing in at 7 lbs. 13 oz. Olivia is Ames and Laurie Sweet's third daughter, joining sisters Caitlin, 8, and Annalee, 6. Laurie is also an A.A. member.

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION - GEOGRAPHIC BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE
	APRIL 1992	APRIL 1991	
UNITED STATES			
Alabama	1,458	1,410	48
Alaska	544	493	51
Arizona	1,559	1,557	2
Arkansas	789	784	5
California	11,277	13,824	- 2,547
Colorado	1,564	1,653	- 89
Connecticut	2,152	2,278	- 126
Delaware	392	403	- 11
District of Columbia	282	298	- 16
Florida	5,972	5,788	184
Georgia	2,770	2,830	- 60
Hawaii	476	441	35
Idaho	561	649	- 88
Illinois	5,386	5,808	- 422
Indiana	1,832	1,684	148
Iowa	1,598	1,675	- 77
Kansas	1,583	1,685	- 102
Kentucky	1,012	978	34
Louisiana	1,295	1,159	136
Maine	737	830	- 93
Maryland	2,387	2,099	288
Massachusetts	4,524	5,378	- 854
Michigan	3,512	3,483	29
Minnesota	3,282	3,492	- 210
Mississippi	657	704	- 47
Missouri	2,387	2,383	4
Montana	773	784	- 11
Nebraska	1,530	1,610	- 80
Nevada	616	608	8
New Hampshire	683	729	- 46
New Jersey	3,780	3,852	- 72
New Mexico	647	684	- 37
New York	8,393	8,955	- 562
North Carolina	2,979	3,315	- 336
North Dakota	568	586	- 18
Ohio	3,833	3,966	- 133
Oklahoma	1,437	1,552	- 115
Oregon	1,288	1,264	24
Pennsylvania	4,825	4,825	0
Rhode Island	611	633	- 22
South Carolina	1,342	1,613	- 271
South Dakota	522	548	- 26
Tennessee	1,511	1,484	27
Texas	5,377	5,664	- 287
Utah	542	539	3
Vermont	444	497	- 53
Virginia	2,707	2,840	- 133
Washington	3,443	3,463	- 20
West Virginia	535	550	- 15
Wisconsin	2,813	2,773	40
Wyoming	371	376	- 5
Puerto Rico	102	107	- 5
U.S. Possessions	29	2	27
Total	111,689	117,585	- 5,896
CANADA			
Alberta	1,233	1,315	- 82
British Columbia/Yukon	1,781	1,665	116
Manitoba	640	624	16
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	531	549	- 18
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	830	825	5
Ontario	4,153	5,373	- 1,220
Quebec	477	445	32
Saskatchewan	817	758	59
Total	10,462	11,554	- 1,092
FOREIGN	1,491	1,598	- 107
Grand Total	123,642	130,737	- 7,095

Literature Distributed – 1991



ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	632,140
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft-cover)	416,540
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	6,210
Daily Reflections	260,820
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	369,530
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	54,410
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft-cover)	157,050
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print) (new)	1,700
A.A. Comes of Age	21,480
As Bill Sees It	85,150
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	19,530
"Pass It On"	22,250
Total	2,046,810

Booklets

Living Sober	240,140
Came to Believe	110,300
A.A. in Prison (new)	27,970
Total	378,410

Pamphlets

A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs	42,200
A.A. and the Armed Services	17,500
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	35,300
A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession	53,000
A.A. for the Native North American	34,300
A.A. for the Woman	179,500
The A.A. Group	164,600
A.A. in Your Community	75,500
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	56,200
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	63,400
The A.A. Membership Survey	120,700
The A.A. Member – Medications and Other Drugs	179,200
The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service	32,000
A.A. Tradition – How It Developed	72,300
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	21,700
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	187,500
Circles of Love and Service	74,000
Bridging the Gap	74,000
The Clergy Ask About A.A.	40,800

The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	38,100
Do You Think You're Different?	213,200
44 Questions	418,300
G.S.R.	71,200
How A.A. Members Cooperate	33,500
How It Works	107,400
If You Are a Professional	81,600
Inside A.A.	95,000
Is A.A. For You?	505,200
Is A.A. For Me?	132,000
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	149,700
It Happened to Alice	85,700
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	90,300
The Jack Alexander Article	41,500
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	24,800
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	119,000
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	103,500
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	81,000
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	27,400
A Newcomer Asks	400,200
Problems Other Than Alcohol	152,100
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	362,500
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	38,100
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	29,300
The Twelve Steps Illustrated (new)	56,000
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	81,200
The Twelve Traditions of A.A.	14,900
This Is A.A.	439,600
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	43,500
Time to Start Living	92,300
Time to Start Living (large print)	10,700
Too Young?	158,800
Understanding Anonymity	108,700
What Happened to Joe	101,700
Young People and A.A.	216,000
Total	6,247,700

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards – two-fold	930,400
Wallet cards – I Am Responsible	123,400
Wallet cards – Anonymity	83,500
Parchment – scrolls	9,900
Placards	2,193
C.P.C. Workbook	1,100
Correctional Facilities Workbook	700
P.I. Workbook	1,200
Treatment Facilities Workbook	1,000
A.A. Guidelines	133,200
Group Handbook	6,000
Wire Racks	3,100
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	4,500
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	5,300
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	2,600
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	400
TV Spots (video cassette)	3,000
Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records)	600
Twelve Steps Shade displays	2,500
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	2,000
Fact Files	3,700
Total	1,320,293
Grand total	9,993,213

SPANISH

Books

Alcohólicos Anónimos	30,300
Como Lo Ve Bill	6,100
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad	3,300
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos	2,800
Reflexiones Diarias (new)	4,900
Total	47,400

Booklets

Viviendo Sobrio	12,000
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial	2,700
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones	23,300
Llegamos a Creer	7,000
Total	45,000

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad	12,200
44 Preguntas	35,700
Esto es A.A.	45,100
¿Es A.A. para Usted?	72,500
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica	9,900
¿Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida?	11,500
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser un Alcohólico	7,000
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A.	7,400
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander	4,500
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Médicas por Bill W.	3,200
A.A. y el Empleado Alcohólico	700
Un Principiante Pregunta	14,000
Como Trabaja el Programa	22,600
Lo que le Sucedió a José	15,300
Comprendiendo el Anonimato	6,000
El Grupo de A.A.	13,600
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento	15,700
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas	8,600
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas	8,600
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento	2,900
Los Jóvenes y A.A.	12,000
La Tradición de A.A. - Cómo se Desarrolló	2,600
Una Breve Guía a A.A.	10,000
A.A. en Prisiones	6,400
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol	11,800
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda	8,400
Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.	2,900
Dentro de A.A.	5,100
A.A. como Recurso para la Profesión Médica	3,000
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A.	2,300
R.S.G.	4,800
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente?	11,700
A.A. Para la Mujer	9,700
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A.	1,300
A.A. y los Programas de Alcoholismo Empresariales	1,400
Es A.A. para mí? (new)	1,100
Tiempo para Empezar a Vivir (new)	3,100
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (new)	2,700
Total	417,300

Miscellaneous

Guías	7,300
Parchments, Spanish	556
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera	13,800
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album)	360
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album)	630
Total	22,646
Grand total	532,346

FRENCH

Books

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (format relié)	5,260
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (format poche)	4,785
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte	918
Réflexions de Bill	3,839
Réflexions Quotidiennes	15,650
Total	30,452

Booklets

Nous en sommes venus à croire	2,199
Vivre . . . sans alcool!	3,346
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions	6,198

Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	2,207
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Total 13,950

Pamphlets

Voici les A.A.	16,276
Les A.A.: 44 Questions	2,297
Les A.A. sont-ils pour vous?	35,360
Les A.A. pour la femme	1,046
Coopération des membres A.A.	371
Les A.A. et les Programmes d'aide aux Employés	1,323
Le membre des A.A. face aux médicaments et à la drogue	1,564
Article du <i>Saturday Evening Post</i>	353
Collaborons avec nos amis	401
Questions et réponses sur le parrainage	2,398
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les médecins	654
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement	459
La Tradition des A.A. et son développement	1,205
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme?	1,185
L'Histoire de Nicole	981
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool	716
Les A.A. dans votre milieu	898
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme	2,221
Point de vue d'un membre sur A.A.	526
Les Douze Traditions illustrées	1,565
Les A.A. dans les établissements correctionnels	592
Ca vaut mieux que de poireauter en prison	711
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A.	6,557
Un ecclésiastique s'interroge	515
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A.	1,332
Message à l'intention des détenus	1,636
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels	270
Le groupe des A.A.	3,425
Les Douze Concepts illustrées	1,158
Le sens de l'anonymat	1,043
Trois causeries à des sociétés médicales	732
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie?	949
Le R.S.G.	1,179
Causeries à l'extérieur des A.A.	737
Trop jeune?	2,228
La Structure de l'Association des A.A.	1,246
L'héritage des Services des A.A.	238
Cercles d'amour et de service	1,704
Vous croyez-vous différent?	1,151
Lettre à une femme alcoolique	744
Sondage de 1989 membres des A.A.	1,682
Les Jeunes et les A.A.	1,553
Votre B.S.G.	1,630
Il est encore temps de vivre	1,534
Un nouveau veut savoir	7,835
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi?	1,518
Favoriser de rapprochement	633
Total	116,331

Guidelines

Miscellaneous

Le Gros Livre (cassettes)	125
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions	3,211
Carte anonymat (Français/anglais)	506
Cassettes	94
Notre Méthode	24,814
Les Meilleurs Articles de Bill	5,490
Manuel de Groupe	118
Manuel de l'Information Publique	24
Manuel des Centres de Détention	11
Messages d'Interet Publique	9
Manuel de la CMP	2
Prière Sérénité (Carte)	38,689
Slogans (série de 5)	318
Suggestions Réunions Débutants	322
Total	73,733

Grand total 239,855

Reports on Area Service Highlights



Alaska: We have 12 districts with active service committees in Alaska. Our G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s accept their responsibilities and strive to reach the goals they set. We have monthly meetings attended by G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s and committee chairpeople. Most districts have active intergroups. There is a quarterly assembly held at different locations and an area voting assembly every two years. We maintain an A.A. hot line to handle Twelve Step calls, give information about meetings and carry the message. Most of the jails in Alaska have some A.A. meetings, and members try to help inmates obtain sponsors when requested. Treatment centers also have in-house A.A. meetings and patients are usually required to attend so many meetings while in treatment. Alaska is a large state and has many remote areas, so a lot of emphasis is put on rural outreach. There are several Russian settlements in Alaska and many native villages in which alcoholism is a great problem. We try to reach as many of these areas as possible, furnishing literature and books and, in some cases, start meetings. Districts hold workshops and fund raisers to help support outreach programs. We also have a quarterly newsletter. Although expensive, plane travel is necessary for most quarterly assemblies; we still have good participation.—*O.B. Culley*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: Our area is the largest in North America. We have 75 districts and approximately 7,000 members. We have just started a welcome letter to new groups encouraging service participation. We hold two area assemblies and two D.C.M. meetings annually, each including at least one workshop. The "Bridging the Gap" program is working well in Area 78. Our C.P.C., P.I., correctional facilities, treatment facilities, and Grapevine committees all show increased activity. Our archives committee has created a newsletter named *Coffee Break*, which includes individual, group and district histories as well as other archival information. Selected A.A. literature will soon be available in northern-native languages. The W.R.A.A.S.A. was held in Edmonton in March with good attendance and participation. For the first time, our area delegate attended the P.R.A.A.S.A. to gain information and to foster sharing region to region.
—*Elaine Strome*

Arizona: We have two three-day assemblies and two one-day assemblies per year. We have 15 districts and most of them are divided into subdistricts; some have up to 22 subdistricts with D.C.M.s. D.C.M. chairs have been a big asset to the delegate and area chairman. We have had a strong rapport with our intergroups and central offices in the area. Our Spanish-speaking intergroups are doing well and have been a big help to the committee. Our area structure is designed after the General Service Conference structure with the panel system. Our panels meet at our three-day assemblies. The line of communication is open with our Native American friends who are involved in some service work and do not feel they are different. Though we could be a lot better, we are in the growing process and have work to do. Their culture is very important to them. We have reservations in all parts of the state and probably the largest number of square miles of reservation of any area.—*Bert Kluthe*

California (Mid-Southern): We have more than 2,000 groups, the majority of which have only one meeting. We have 23 districts, including four Spanish-speaking districts, and our area meetings are simultaneously translated into Spanish and American Sign Language. Most of our districts have a D.C.M. chairperson and are divided into several local or subdistricts, each with a D.C.M. We hold three regular area assemblies per year that meet in a single central location. Our area service committee meets six times a year. There are approximately 170 members of our area service committee. We have a pre-Conference symposium in the spring, a fall service event, and our semi-annual election assembly. On March 5-7, 1993, we will host the 26th Annual Pacific Region Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly (PRAASA) in Torrance.—*Jim Clough*

California (Northern Interior): Our area covers some 480 by 150 miles. Twenty-eight districts and seven area officers serve more than 15,000 members in 700 groups. Districts each serve between 11 and 63 groups. Almost 72 percent of groups are located in the southern half of the area, between two population centers, Sacramento and Fresno. A concern exists lest we disen-

franchise our northern half. Our newsletter, *Area Accents*, enjoys a circulation of more than 650. Seven area committee meetings (centrally held), four area assemblies (area-wide) and quarterly officers meetings provide adequate coordination and communication. A centrally located active archives, complete with a vault, houses our records, tapes and a Big "red" Book. A three-day fall assembly provides panels, roundtables, speakers and a biennial election. A two-hour G.S.R. school travels by invitation at the area's expense. Grapevine and literature chairs have substantial inventories for display and sales convenience at assemblies.

—Bill Cross

California (San Diego/Imperial): Our area assembly meets six times a year and our area committee meets once a month. We continue self-support through groups only, declining contributions from conventions and roundups. We added an additional district and a contact service committee for prisoners upon release. We developed a committee to handle anonymity breaks and also added four alternate officers. We bought two computers and our financial records, newsletter and group-listing information are all computerized. We look forward to seeing everyone in San Diego at the 1995 International Convention.—Paul Cleary

Delaware: Nine of our 13 districts and approximately 90 of our 150 groups are located in our single metropolitan area. In the remaining 80 percent of the state are two intergroups, four districts and the remaining 60 groups. Our primary concerns are to stimulate participation and financial support from many groups and to create viable districts. The area committee and several past delegates are helping to improve the service structure. This year an area registrar was appointed to assist in group and district registration. All three intergroups hold workshops on service, the Traditions and self-support. Interest and attendance at our four area assemblies and workshops is gradually improving. Our area archivist now has his own office and facilities to catalog and protect material. An archives display is presented at each annual convention, the 32nd of which takes place in Rehoboth Beach in May 1992.—Doug Tolley

Georgia: Our area now has 684 groups and 15,830 members. In February 1991 we completed the five-year plan of the Seventh Tradition challenge. Total special contributions to G.S.O. during this period was \$42,279.92. Five cluster service workshops are conducted throughout the state. We have three state service assemblies each year at which approximately 800–1,000 members attend. Normally, 100 percent of our 40 D.C.M.s attend each assembly. June is gratitude/appreciation month for special contributions to our state office. More than 76 percent of our groups contribute to G.S.O. on a continual basis. The prepaid Georgia State A.A. Convention each year continues to be successful. Our groups contribute on a continual basis to the convention. The Georgia A.A. Service Office in Macon provides vital A.A. support to all 684 groups five days a week.—Bo Welch

Idaho: Our area encompasses ten districts and 181 groups. All districts are active and each holds a monthly meeting. Most districts hold a mini-conference. At our most recent fall assembly we elected a new slate of officers. We hold three area committee meetings, one in January, one in March and one in August. At the January meeting the delegate presents to the D.C.M.s the topics for the General Service Conference. At the March meeting D.C.M.s give feedback to the delegate on these topics. During the August meeting we take care of area business and set the agenda for one fall assembly. Our area strongly supports the delegate as well as the working committees, which are P.I., C.P.C., treatment facilities, correctional facilities (east and west) and Grapevine.

We have an area newsletter, an archivist, three intergroups and six Spanish-speaking groups throughout the area.—Carlos Flores

Illinois (Northern): Our area includes 21 active districts and 889 registered groups. We hold four assemblies and four area committee meetings a year. We sponsor a large spring conference every year, as well as the Illinois state conference every third year. Our area standing committees are P.I., C.P.C., treatment facilities, correctional facilities, Grapevine, answering service and archives. These committees provide support, training and experienced help for the corresponding district committees. Most of our districts provide their own vital services, including directories, running an answering service and committee work. Recently many of our districts staggered D.C.M. terms to allow a mix of new and experienced D.C.M.s in the area at the start of each year. We are mostly a rural, suburban and small-city area. The strong feeling in our area is conservative regarding A.A. money and for simpler more basic literature and service pieces.

—Thomas Barlow

Indiana (Southern): Our area has 23 districts and approximately 500 groups. We have added one district to our area and have redistricted another. After four years of working as an area committee, all committees are active. The most active are correctional facilities, C.P.C. and our P.I. committee. The area does a terrific job of carrying A.A. inside the walls. C.P.C. has been very busy working with the courts and P.I. has been putting on workshops throughout the area. Our literature and Grapevine committees are busy attending area and district functions. Archives is busy collecting and showing archives films. Our treatment facilities committee has been working closely with facilities in the area. We now have an area newsletter called the *Hand-Out*. Districts are becoming more active and, as an area committee, our attendance is growing. This year we are having our first weekend assembly with workshops geared to the D.C.M. and G.S.R.s. The biggest challenges are communication and the Seventh Tradition.—Chuck Hickson

Kansas: Our area consists of 376 groups and 30 districts. We hold an area assembly four times a year. Workshops are conducted on Conference topics and other relevant issues. The C.P.C. chairman is providing instructional workshops for a medical school in our area on what A.A. does and does not do. Our treatment facilities committee continues to work on the Bridging the Gap program. Correctional facilities has instituted the yellow sunflower can for group literature donations to institutions. The assembly voted to charge \$5 for the area newsletter. The Grapevine committee chairman sells books and tapes at the assembly and conferences. The archives display cases were complete this year and many items that had been stored are now displayed. A committee has been formed to evaluate our corporate by-laws and institute any changes that may be needed.—Dick Brummel

Kentucky: We now have 29 districts and 709 meetings. The sizes of our districts range from 8 to 33 groups. The district with 33 groups uses local committee members to maintain group contact. Local committee members report to the district. Five central office/intergroup representatives attend area meetings. In April 1992 the areas will consider installing a liaison for central office/intergroups as a voting member of the area committee. Past delegates vote at the six area committee meetings and at our two October assemblies. District committees are active. Nearly all correctional facilities have regular meetings chaired by A.A.s. More treatment facilities are cooperating with A.A. in not overloading small meetings and helping with the cross-addicted identification problem. This is the direct result of friendly contact

by members of the treatment facilities committee. More D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s are participating at area meetings.—*Joe Sostarich*

Maine: Our area encompasses the state of Maine and a portion of New Brunswick, Canada. There has been rapid growth of A.A. in Maine in the past 10 years. In 1982 there were approximately 200 groups and meetings listed in our directory. In 1992 there are more than 700 listed; an increase of more than 300 percent. In this decade we have gone from 7 to 18 districts. We have area coordinators in P.I. and C.P.C., treatment facilities, correctional facilities and bridging-the-gap. Many districts have active committees in these areas. We have an archives committee and an archivist who is trying to put together area archives. We have two assemblies per year, in March and October, with a voting membership of 140–170. We hold a post-Conference forum in May for the delegate's report and we have an area round-up in July. We have an active central service office in Portland. The central service office sells approximately \$7,000 per month worth of Conference-approved literature only. Our greatest challenges are to keep our focus on recovery from alcoholism and to better carry that message of hope for recovery to the still-suffering alcoholic.—*Cena Robbins*

Manitoba: Our area has 14 districts. The northernmost district in our area recently submitted a proposal to divide by using local committee members in the most remote outlying region. We appointed a new, remote northern communities chairperson who will communicate via telecon with the remote communities and reservations in the north. It is hoped that this chairperson will implement new ideas and then report to the assembly on progress in carrying the A.A. message to the Canadian north. We also have started working toward a budget that would encompass the five levels of service. We feel that the groups, the districts, the area and intergroup would carry the message farther if they had an operating budget like that of G.S.O. This would mean revising the 60-30-10 plan to better suit our needs and still take in all five levels. Lastly, we are slowly looking at helping our neighbors when it is their turn to hold events such as W.R.A.A.S.A. or a Regional Forum.—*Ed Prince*

Maryland: Our area has 47 districts and approximately 800 groups. The redistricting committee is currently working to reduce the size of several districts. The area committee meets four times per year and the assembly meets five times a year. Depending upon the year, the additional assembly serves as either an inventory or an election assembly. The intergroup liaison committee meets at every assembly. All ten state intergroups are invited to attend each assembly as members of the ad-hoc intergroup liaison committee. The *Margenser*, Maryland general service's quarterly newsletter, provides updates and information and is available to all A.A. members upon request. Our area also hosts two annual conventions. Our most recent addition to the service structure is a registrar, who reports changes in group information to our secretary and to New York.—*John S. Curtin*

Massachusetts (Western): Our area comprises 207 groups and six districts. We have formed a treatment facilities committee which, with archives, C.P.C., Grapevine, P.I., Western Massachusetts Young People and Western Massachusetts Roundup committees, forms our general service structure. Area committees meet with the delegate monthly. The P.I. committee has formed subcommittees in some districts to handle the volume of commitments, which includes a weekly half-hour radio program. We have active and cooperative intergroup and treatment facilities committees. The treatment facilities committee holds 55 meetings per week in 33 institutions. We hold two two-day assemblies

each year. We have added the position of registrar to the area committee. One of our major concerns is lack of group representation at district meetings. A concerted effort is being made to dramatically improve representation. We hope to start printing an area newsletter soon.—*Tom Lawrence*

Michigan (Western): The high point of service in Area 34 during the past two years has been the strengthening of our districts and committees. The key to communication in the area is the D.C.M. and functioning districts are key to the smooth functioning of our D.C.M.s. There are 16 districts in the area. Our 36 D.C.M.s are each responsible for communicating with seven to ten groups. Fourteen districts hold monthly or bimonthly meetings. The D.C.M.s meet at our monthly area assembly where a report from each district is given. These reports are circulated with our area minutes. A G.S.R. school, hosted by districts in the northern part of the area, is planned for an inactive district. Functioning committees at the district level have strengthened the area committees. Our real successes are C.P.C. and correctional facilities but other committees are becoming more active. We are planning our Fourth Annual Corrections Workshop inside Kinross Facility for June 1992. In the past, our area committee chairpersons have been coordinators without real committees. Both C.P.C. and correctional facilities now hold monthly area meetings. We hope that other standing committees will follow suit. We are privileged to host the Michigan Conference of Young People in A.A. for the third consecutive year.—*Anna Cushman*

Minnesota (Northern): Our area has 20 districts, more than 500 groups and between 7,000 and 8,000 A.A. members. The predominant quality of our area is unity. One definition of unity is "to get together." Our area got together in 1951 and sent our first delegate to the General Service Conference in 1952. Since then we have continued to get together and have grown. The activity that has contributed most to our growth and unity is continually improving communications among the G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s and the delegate. Our service people want to know how to communicate. We had more than 200 attendees at the area workshop in January. Communicators are close to one another, know what others are doing for A.A., what they can do for A.A. and what they will do for A.A. Unity exemplifies the Fellowship in our area.—*Greg Gits*

Mississippi: We have put the finishing touches on the reorganization of our 226 groups into 25 active districts and have restructured our committee system to more closely follow the one used by G.S.O. In April of last year we approved separating our assembly and committee meetings from conventions or round-ups. Currently, our quarterly area committee and assembly meetings are day-long events held on Saturday in Jackson. Last year we separated our C.P.C. committee from P.I. due to a dramatic increase in activity in both areas. C.P.C. activity began in the northwest portion of the area and spread outward from there, touching the Jackson and Hattiesburg areas, then moved into northeast Mississippi and onward to the Gulf Coast. Many younger people have gotten involved in service work in these districts, bringing a new level of energy and excitement to us all. Our most recent improvements regarding the division of committees and the separation of our assembly meetings promise to offer enough challenges to keep all of us busy well into the future.

—*Howard Lowery*

Montana: We split the secretary/treasurer position and added another computer to make both jobs more efficient. Funding is now available for the area committee chairs to travel, making their message available to districts and groups that heretofore

could not afford to have then visit. Luncheons hosted by district P.I. or C.P.C. committees at our state roundups have been a pleasant surprise to many community leaders. While passing through the facility on the way to lunch they are presented with a picture of hundreds of alcoholics at their best—quite a change for most of them. Our area assemblies have a busy agenda but time is also set aside for workshops and breakouts for G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. At assemblies all districts and one-third of our groups usually are represented. All intergroups have been invited to attend assemblies and give a report.—*Bob Halvorson*

Nebraska: Our area is approaching 725 groups with about 43 percent contributing to G.S.O. Our area holds four assemblies a year at Kearney, a central site within the state. We have held an area inventory at the November even-year assembly and elections of officers at the odd-year November assembly. In the past year we have had a real challenge developing a budget plan for financial responsibility and accountability at the area level that would be acceptable to the groups. We experienced the power of the groups' purse strings as they voiced their concerns about the direction our plan was taking. We seemed to flounder toward our goal and saw our treasury slowly diminish to almost nothing. As a result of a few suggestions we changed our direction and made some real progress. This experience has given us a better focus on how the groups would like us to carry the message within the area. Their message has come through loud and clear: Help us carry the message, don't do it for us. We also put together the bridging-the-gap and temporary contact program for treatment facilities throughout the state. This program has filled a gap where before we were losing some prospective members. We changed the name of our area newsletter to *NebrAskAnews* and increased the information being printed and included a section for Grapevine articles.—*Barry M. Waddell*

New Brunswick/P.E.I.: A.A. is alive and well in Area 81; there are thirteen districts in our area, four in Prince Edward Island and nine in New Brunswick. During our October elections all positions were filled and everyone is excited about starting their new service work. We have a good cross-section of alcoholics in our area: French-speaking groups, native groups, English groups and now we have a Latin group. We hold two area workshops, two area committee meetings and two area assemblies per year. At the present time we are working on an area literature bank to service the district literature banks in our area. Our various committees work in cooperation with the treatment facilities, penal institutions and hospitals in our area. We are hoping to get an offshore Regional Forum on P.E.I. in 1993. All in all things are going very well in our area.—*Mel Larkin*

New Hampshire: There are now about 600 groups statewide, including French and Spanish-speaking meetings. For the past ten years we have had a service office where committee meetings are held, information passed out, and A.A. Conference-approved literature and tapes sold. Last year literature sales totaled \$81,000. Area committees include P.I., C.P.C., archives, correctional and treatment facilities. The area assembly held a mid-winter dinner dance recognizing past delegates; organized a June convention, including many workshops and social activities and; last October, organized a highly successful New England Regional Convention. A.A. is alive and flourishing in New Hampshire. We are faced with the same situations and dilemmas confronting other states, which we will be addressing at this Conference. With that Divine Power which has guided A.A. over the years, I know we will find answers.—*John Sweeney*

New Jersey (Southern): Our area consists of 483 groups, with

a total of 575 meetings, 29 districts and four sections. One district is Hispanic and encompasses our entire area. We have seven Spanish-speaking groups. Our four sections are situated so that they may serve the D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s. We conduct four area committee and four assembly meetings quarterly. Each section hosts these meetings on a rotating basis. Workshops are held before each meeting and throughout the year. A mini-conference is held about six weeks before the General Service Conference. Our convention takes place in the spring. The C.P.C. committee conducts presentations throughout the area and participates in many conferences. The Grapevine committee displays the Grapevine tools at all assembly meetings, workshops and at the convention. All committees have a close working relationship with our three intergroups.—*Jack Layden*

New Mexico: Our 299 groups are contained within 16 districts. Additional redistricting is being considered. Our practice of encouraging districts to bid for the privilege of hosting area assemblies and the state convention seems to be paying off with increased enthusiasm and unity within the hosting districts. Two districts, more or less dormant for several years, have been revitalized and are adding a great deal to the area structure. Holding assemblies and conventions around the state gives incentive to area committee members, D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s to visit A.A. throughout this fairly large area. We have recently formed an additional standing committee as liaison between the district convention planning committee and the area committee. The first revision and reprinting of our area service manual, *Area Information Pamphlet*, was accomplished at the end of 1991. Our standing committees also include P.I., C.P.C., treatment facilities, men's corrections, women's corrections, archives, Grapevine, and *El Farolito*, the area's monthly eight-page newsletter. Perhaps our greatest ongoing challenge is convincing members that there is A.A. beyond the group, and that it is fun and worthwhile to get involved in the district, area and regional matters necessary to insure the strong worldwide structure that is vital to the continuing recovery of all of us.—*Dick Clark*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): Our area is composed of 12 districts and 773 groups. We have four area meetings and two one-day assemblies each year. We are trying to establish better communication with treatment and correctional facilities regarding A.A.'s singleness of purpose. Our correctional and treatment facilities committees are active and our P.I. and C.P.C. committees provide information about our primary purpose. L.C.M.s assist the D.C.M.s with informing groups of area activity. All area committees are active. There has been more interest in the A.A. Grapevine recently. We are looking into the possibility of a central office for the area. A committee is studying the possibility of changing our method of election of area officers. On July 17–19, 1992 our area will host the 26th Annual New York State A.A. Convention in Albany.—*Caroline Bradley*

New York (Western): We currently have 277 groups registered with the General Service Office as well as countless meetings in our 23 districts. The assembly area includes the Niagara and NYPENN Intergroups and the Buffalo Central Office. We hold an annual spring convention, a Traditions Day and a Day of Learning. Central Office hosts our fall convention and each intergroup hosts a day of sharing. Increasing cooperation and communication among our service entities has ensured the success of these and many other functions by combining unity with service. In February 1991 our assembly elected its first treatment facilities and correctional facilities chairmen. In October 1991, we held our first G.S.R./D.C.M. workshop, which we hope to repeat regularly. We used our January 1992 area committee meeting to take a



group inventory for our assembly. The participation and enthusiasm of our G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s will keep our assembly alive, growing, and responsive.—*Terry Wymer*

North Dakota: Our area is made up of 13 districts with approximately 160 groups. Our two-day assembly meetings are held three times a year in different locations; at least one of the assemblies is held in a smaller city to encourage G.S.R.s from the smaller districts to attend. In the past two years, the area P.I./C.P.C./Grapevine committee has become more active, holding workshops centrally located, along with a P.I./C.P.C. luncheon for professionals in the area. We have changed the format of our assembly meetings to get more participation from the G.S.R.s, including adding a couple of What's On Your Mind sharing sessions. Also, at the beginning of each assembly, we have a G.S.R. only sharing session, where problems and solutions are exchanged and new ideas shared. We hold two workshops at the assemblies, using the experience, strength, and hope of our past trusted servants. In the last year, we started our own area newsletter which is self-supporting.—*Vail Jensen*

Ohio (Northwest)/Michigan (Southeast): Our area has 15 districts serving approximately 350 groups. We have eight area assemblies and one mini-conference a year. By dividing the area in four sectors our goal is to rotate our assembly meeting twice a year to better reach outlying areas. We have sent stamped, self-addressed contribution envelopes to each group, explaining that it is for their convenience, and that a thank-you letter will follow acknowledging their contribution. Our area mini-conference has also grown. We have seven standing committees, and have started a workshop committee to help carry the message of our Three Legacies. Our C.P.C. committee is working closely with the area intergroup P.I. Committee to better serve the community and our new group committee is reaching out to those who ask. Our shut-in committee is reaching out to those who are unable to get out. Our area officers are attending these committees to learn and to offer their help. We have three intergroups and have a good liaison with the oldest and largest intergroup. We would like to develop the same relationship with the other two.—*Vivien Gerten*

Ohio (Southwest): Our area has 28 districts and approximately 550 groups in the 16 counties we serve. We hold six committee and six general-assembly meetings annually. Our eight commit-



tees meet monthly before the area meeting. Our literature and Grapevine committees keep the Fellowship informed with displays at area meetings, conferences, and district and group functions. C.P.C./P.I. educates and informs through letters to professional organizations and to the public with radio and TV spots. Through the correctional facilities committee, awareness is gained and shared regarding meetings and services. The bridging-the-gap program has been initiated by the treatment facilities committee. Our archives committee has created an audiovisual lending library for groups in our area. The new groups committee helps new groups register and learn about the service structure. All group information has been computerized.—*Dian Wright*

Ontario (Western): We have 23 districts and 438 groups. We recently formed a committee known as the Ontario Delegates Committee, which met twice in 1991 and once in March 1992. These are sharing sessions primarily and an educational time for alternates. We started at the area level to bring the Grapevine to more districts through local conventions and roundups. We now have two Grapevine subcommittees to ensure that the workload is divided. At one time we had trouble filling subcommittee positions but at our area meeting in November 1991 there was an election for every position with most going to the hat. In 1988 we started a form of self-support and in 1991 we contributed \$18,000 to the General Service Office. We also have a reserve fund of \$17,500. This money came from the groups, districts and conventions in our area. We are now able to support our area committee and subcommittees.—*Jack Griffith*

Oregon: We now have 710 registered groups and 32 districts. We are no longer splitting districts as they grow but are subdividing and adding local district committee members. We have area chairs and co-chairs for our C.P.C., P.I., treatment facilities and correctional facilities committees. The Portland Intergroup P.I. committee has successfully taped (with anonymity carefully protected) ten A.A. meetings now shown on Portland public-access television stations. When our archives display is not at assemblies or workshops with our archivist it can be viewed at Portland Intergroup's central office. We have four service assemblies each year, with the election assembly in September. The assemblies include service workshops, sharing sessions and a business meeting. After we gave the G.S.R.s a voice and a vote on business matters at assemblies G.S.R. attendance increased dramatically.—*Helen McConnell*

Puerto Rico: Our area covers approximately 4,500 square miles with 124 groups in seven districts. Our groups hold 256 meetings per week; 143 open and 113 closed. We hold 32 weekly English-speaking meetings. Area meetings are held monthly, assemblies twice a year and a national convention is held every year and is rotated among the districts. During the January 1992 convention we conducted a three-hour workshop on the 1992 Conference theme. Area meetings and assemblies receive monthly updated reports from district coordinators, as well as from finance, literature, P.I. and other committees. Service seminars are periodically given at the districts. Last year we successfully accomplished the amalgamation of two service arms, area committee and central office, thus greatly improving the quality of the services rendered and reducing costs. We publish a monthly newsletter, *Despertar*, free of charge to groups and members. We are about to publish the history of A.A. in Puerto Rico.—*Santiago Rodríguez*

Quebec (Northwest): Our area now has 20 districts. We have six committee officers: president, vice-president, treasurer, secretary, delegate and alternate delegate. We also have coordinators who are responsible for P.I., La Vigne A.A. (Grapevine), sharing sessions on the Traditions, area bulletin and correctional and treatment facilities committees. There are 377 groups representing approximately 7,000 members spread over 1,400 miles to the north and south and 500 miles to the east and west. One district is as long as the distance between Miami and New York. Every two months we hold an area assembly at which the 20 D.C.M.s and the 15 local committee members attend. Our Seventh Tradition is respected by groups contributing to their respective districts, which contribute to the area, who in turn contributes to G.S.O. We are privileged to have so many members interested in service and to be the area, in Eastern Canada, to host the bilingual Regional Forum in September 1992 in Hull, Quebec. Finally, we plan to visit groups farther north and to contact the aboriginal people who live in those isolated areas.—*Michel Girard*

Quebec (Southwest): Our bilingual area contains 15,000 members in nearly 600 groups, divided into 30 districts in and around Montreal (including a growing Spanish-speaking district). In 1991 an excellent service-training program was developed jointly by Southwest Quebec Area general service and Montreal Intergroup, offering intensive two-day seminars to members of both service entities. We are busy working out the details of merging general service and intergroup, which entails combining the two offices, budgets and staff. The cost savings should significantly increase our self-support capacity. The new structure will provide all present services (and some new ones) through a central office and subcommittees and will help to administrate the three provincial service entities responsible to the four Quebec areas: *La Vigne*, *Le Service Des Publications Françaises* (our translation

and publishing house) and the *Comité provincial*, a thrice-yearly sharing forum.—*Paul Baatz*

Rhode Island: We have just celebrated 50 years of Alcoholics Anonymous in Rhode Island with a moving ceremony of history and thanksgiving. The committee included representatives from area service, central service and intergroup. We have more than 500 groups in eight districts. Each district meets monthly and holds a structure school before the business meeting. Additionally, each district holds an informational open house for group secretaries/treasurers. We have four area assemblies each year and each includes a service workshop before the business meeting. Minutes are then sent out in the form of a newsletter. The service committees are working effectively. The correctional facilities committee holds 18 meetings each week. P.I. works with the media and fills speaker invitations. Grapevine does "Adopt a School." Archives is preserving longtimers on tape. Treatment facilities has contacts to bridge the gap, and C.P.C. makes presentations and accompanies professionals. We have an area roundup and an annual state convention.—*Mary Jane Roy*

Saskatchewan: Our area consists of 16 districts, approximately 345 groups and 4,500 members. We hold a meeting in January for all D.C.M.s, alternates, L.C.M.s and table officers. We have had close to 100 percent attendance at these meetings for the past three years. Assemblies are held in spring and fall of each year. The location is determined by a bid system. Our assemblies have been held in cities and small communities to encourage participation. Attendance ranges from 175 to 225 participants. We have A.A. enhancement available through topic and Traditions workshops, gratitude nights, delegate reports and roundups. Various groups in each district host two to three events during the year. Our spring assembly will deal with Conference topics and will have presentations/discussions on area corrections, archives and district development.—*Verna Robinson*

South Carolina: Our area is grouped into three regions: upper, middle and lower. Our first area assembly was held in February 1992 and 112 G.S.R.s as well as 16 of a total 17 D.C.M.s attended. We had an excellent turnout and had a large number of alternates and other A.A.s in attendance. Our assembly meets eight times per year. Saturday's format consists of an informal D.C.M./delegate meeting, committee meetings, workshops and an open A.A. speaker meeting on Saturday evening. Our business meeting is held Sunday at 9 a.m. This year we will have a chairperson and two alternates for each committee. Our 1992 budget was accepted and it includes funds to assist the new committee structure. A decision was made to overhaul the name and address information for all registered groups in our area.—*Joe H. McGarity*

South Dakota: Our area comprises 14 districts with approximately 162 groups. Most districts are active in carrying the A.A. message on both the district and state level. One district recently held a P.I. and C.P.C. luncheon, with some very encouraging results. This luncheon is now slated as an annual event and other districts are planning similar events as well. One of our greatest challenges is how best to carry the message to the Native Americans living on reservations within our state. At our last assembly we decided to form a "carrying the message to minorities committee." The committee is mainly made up of Native Americans who are active in their groups and districts. The committee is working with the districts within the reservations and is providing help for starting new groups. The first meetings have been full of enthusiasm and are encouraging. We will continue our efforts in this area.—*Ted Stoa*



Tennessee: Our area has four weekend assemblies per year; attendance in the past has been around 30% out of 450 groups in the area; contributions throughout the area have amounted to only about 20%. A lack of assembly planning has made our agenda light, with little service information, except for personal sharing. As a result we have taken an assembly inventory, and formed a temporary agenda committee. As a result of this committee, we now have new G.S.R. and D.C.M. orientation meetings, G.S.R. and D.C.M. responsibility meetings, two to five service workshops, a red ball meeting, speaker meeting, six standing committee meetings and the regular business meeting at each assembly. Our assembly attendance was up at our January assembly. The next step is to work toward standing committee inventories. At the present time, the area has a few well-functioning committees, the rest seem only to share what is happening throughout the state. Speaking from personal experience, the inventory is my best friend in service responsibility.

—John Wampler

Texas (Northwest): Our area has 15 districts, 267 groups and 4,600 members. This is a very large land area and very sparsely populated. Area standing committees are functioning but improvement is indicated. Treatment and correctional facilities committees seem to be most active, with Bridge the Gap programs in place and many meetings in both treatment and correctional facilities. P.I., C.P.C. and Grapevine committees are doing well in some districts and are nonexistent in others. Ten districts are service-minded and it was gratifying to have the representation we had at the Regional Forum in Tulsa. Although we have Spanish-speaking groups throughout the area, one district in El Paso has 12 registered Spanish-speaking groups, each with a G.S.R. and a D.C.M. We try to rotate service meetings to different locations in an effort to stimulate participation.—Bob Barnes

Texas (Southwest): Our area now has more than 520 groups; we have two Spanish-speaking districts. The number of young people attending area meetings is increasing. Attendance totaled 207 at our first winter workshop. We are now compiling our area archives. Our correctional facilities committee is expanding rapidly and meetings are now carried to local, state and federal units. Almost all treatment facilities throughout the area now have A.A. members coming in to hold meetings. The area is holding several mini-workshops each month and attendance at regional functions is increasing. We are also seeing a growing interest in self-support. Our D.C.M. and G.S.R. workshops are

well-received at area meetings. Our main concerns include how to get more people involved in service work; how to handle new members who are not alcoholics; and how to get all our groups registered properly.—Jim Burke

Vermont: We have 224 groups in Vermont within our ten districts. Because our area is rural, most of our committee work is done at the district level. Our P.I. committee and our districts have been challenged with carrying the message to young people. We now have three A.A. meetings in high schools. The annual pre-Conference sharing session and full area assembly weekend proves to be our best-attended service event. With four full area assemblies and a newly revised committee schedule, we continually strive for an informed group conscience. All committee members, officers, and G.S.R.s now receive monthly minutes. Now in its 24th year, our annual spring convention continues to attract many out-of-state A.A. members. We gratefully look forward to hosting our first Northeast Regional Forum in 1993 in Burlington, Vermont.—Judith A. Ressler

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan: Our alternate delegate presents mini-service seminars from four to six times annually throughout our area. The seminars last one full day and basically cover A.A.'s Three Legacies. Their purpose is to assist in creating informed A.A. members so we may function collectively in our groups and assemblies as an informed body. We are in the process of creating area bylaws. Our purpose, in part, is to become more consistent in conducting area business and to reduce repetition at our assemblies. A final draft is not expected for at least two years. We continue to look at area finances. We hope to encourage a greater percentage of groups to contribute to area affairs as well as to G.S.O. We also are seeking a way to offer more reimbursement to our trusted servants. These three points assist us in becoming more effective in our primary purpose.—Chuck Stokes

Wyoming: We have 11 districts and 140 groups. Two annual conferences and business assemblies are rotated throughout the state. We are active in corrections and treatment facilities work; most committees of any size are holding meetings in jails. We have several young peoples groups in our area and they seem to be doing well and are participating in the conferences and business assemblies. This makes for greater unity in our area. Our area encompasses the entire state of Wyoming and we rotate our conferences and assemblies. The Grapevine committee and the archives committee are both active in our area and are striving for more participation. We are trying to get more involvement in our conferences and business assemblies from our D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s in each district. We try to stress the importance of being there to carry the message of A.A. and the meetings back to the groups. This would bring more unity to the area.

—Wayne Reed

Profile of a Delegate

The average age of a delegate is 53 years, with the oldest being 72 and the youngest 35 years; average length of sobriety 15 years, longest sobriety 34 years and shortest 6 years; average length of service 12 years, longest 30, shortest 4 years. (Compiled on responses from 86 delegates.)

Additional Committee Considerations Which Did Not Result in Recommendations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Conference Report." These items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reaffirmed a 1971 Advisory Action which states: "In view of the heavy agenda this year and the apparent problem in completing it on time, some items (possibly of lower priority) be shown as optional subjects. These should be so placed on the agenda that if we run out of time on earlier subjects, the optional items could be eliminated for that specific year."
- The committee reaffirmed a 1979 Advisory Action which states, "During the roll call at the 1980 Conference, Conference members should stand when their names are called."
- The committee discussed the practice of coordinating a trip to Stepping Stones every other year following the Conference and suggested that this practice be continued.
- The committee discussed the practice of making a trip to G.S.O. during Conference week and suggested that the practice be continued.
- The committee discussed a request to reduce the number of Conference session days and decided this was not feasible.
- The committee reviewed a suggestion from a past trustee to Conference members regarding communications and expressed their gratitude for his sharing and that it would be available in the archives as background.
- The recommendation that if a delegate or an area assembly requests that an item be placed on the agenda of a delegate's Conference Committee, such item will automatically be included on the agenda of the appropriate Conference Committee, was disapproved.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- To provide consistent and uniform information, the committee asked the Conference Literature Committee to consider deletion of the six-point definition of an A.A. Group from page 19 of the pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate . . ."
- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Workbook and made the following suggestions:
 1. The current format be retained based on the professional appearance and convenience of the three-ring binder and lack of substantial savings.
 2. The updated Section on "Working with Treatment Facilities" be included.
- The committee discussed A.A. C.P.C. informational meetings/presentations for persons referred by the courts and found no violations of Traditions. The committee agreed that informational meetings/presentations for persons referred by the courts are a matter of local autonomy.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee considered the need for another version of a

"bridging the gap" pamphlet for pre-release contact, and because this material is included in the Correctional Facilities Workbook saw no need for another pamphlet at this time.

- The committee considered the suggestion that the General Service Office be the coordinating temporary contact point for correctional facilities and felt this is not feasible and could best be handled at the area level.
- The committee considered the suggestion that the General Service Conference host an annual event related to "bridging the gap" between A.A. and treatment and/or correctional facilities and felt the need for this activity could best be met at the area level.
- The committee also discussed the length of time it has taken to produce the audiotape of "A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate," which was the only recommendation from this committee at last year's Conference. The committee felt the project has been unnecessarily delayed and would like to express its displeasure regarding this.
- The committee suggested that a guide letter directed to parole officers for inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook be prepared by staff and brought to the committee at the 1993 General Service Conference for its consideration.

FINANCE

- The committee discussed the pamphlet "Self-Supporting Through Our Own Contributions" and concluded that no revision is needed at the present time.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee discussed the suggestion from an area to develop a "Statement of Purpose" and affirmed the statement adopted by the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board at their January 1992 meeting.
- The committee discussed the suggestion from an area that the Grapevine Editorial Board have regional representation acting in an advisory capacity to the Grapevine editors, and took no action.
- The committee discussed the results of the questionnaire sent out to all delegate areas by the 1992 Conference Grapevine Committee, and decided to send a similar questionnaire this year. The committee further requested that Grapevine staff mail the results of the 1992 Questionnaire to all delegates and area Grapevine chairpersons for their information.
- The committee discussed the suggestion from Area 13 that GvR Guidelines be translated and published in Spanish, and took no action at this time.
- The committee discussed the letter from Eastern Massachusetts regarding a reaffirmation of support for area and district committees and urging continued interaction of such committees at all levels and reaffirmed the committee's support for area and district Grapevine committees.
- The committee discussed a list of possible special items presented by the Grapevine Corporate Board and suggested that in 1993 the Grapevine prepare a booklet of past Grapevine articles on the topic: The A.A. Group (Our Key to Unity).
- The committee discussed a proposal from Area 15 that the Grapevine produce a sobriety token for A.A. members to receive on A.A. birthday anniversaries, and concluded that the production of sobriety tokens is inconsistent with the Grapevine's practice of producing items that emanate from the magazine.

LITERATURE

- The committee considered a request from an area on producing an anonymity card similar to the one used by Al-Anon and suggested that the Fellowship submit "simple" statements of anonymity to the trustees' Literature Committee for review by the 1993 Conference Literature Committee.
- The committee considered the feasibility of printing the *Daily Reflections* book in hardcover or alternate bindings and suggested that a hardcover edition was not needed at this time.
- The committee reviewed "Your G.S.O. Today" video and suggested that a new video not be produced at this time.
- The committee reviewed "Your G.S.O. Today" pamphlet and suggested that an accurate and updated pamphlet be produced.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee suggested that all available requested background material be sent to Conference members on February 15, and again on March 15 each year.
- The committee suggested that in the future all Presentation topics to the Conference be first submitted to the trustees' Committee on the Conference for review.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Committee on the Conference and the Conference Committee on Agenda consider reducing the time of the Conference Monday Joint Committee meetings to one hour.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- It was suggested that this Conference membership extend appreciation to the three California Area Assemblies for making their Public Service Announcements available to the Fellowship without charge.
- The committee strongly suggested that the present policy regarding the photographs of our co-founders priced for sale to anyone be referred to the trustees' Anonymity Subcommittee for oversight and gathering of background to be provided for the 1993 Conference Public Information Committee on legal considerations, copyrights and family preferences, as stated in 1988 Conference Advisory Action #57:

"It was suggested that the 1971 General Service Conference Action be reaffirmed:

"A.A. members generally think it unwise to break the anonymity of a member even after his death, but in each situation the final decision must rest with the family.

"Further, the A.A. Archives continue to protect the anonymity of deceased A.A. members as well as other members."
- The committee expressed appreciation to the G.S.O. staff for identifying a potential problem with the distribution of the co-founders' photographs and referring it to the appropriate committee.
- The committee accepted the minor changes and additions to the text of the Public Information Workbook, with one additional change on page 3 of the section "How to Do P.I." paragraph #7, line 5: insert the word "give" after the word "could."
- The committee strongly suggested that A.A. World Services, Inc. not change the format of the present three-ring binder Public Information Workbook, and that they encourage more areas and districts to purchase these workbooks.

- The committee considered the need for a "generic" video about Alcoholics Anonymous appropriate for Public Access Cable TV and decided to take no action at this time.
- It was strongly suggested that for all future Public Information projects the originating committee should take into account that: 1) the Alcoholics Anonymous Fellowship is available to all alcoholics; and 2) that the targeting of publications and productions for limited populations should be minimized.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee considered a request to have all 12 committees of the General Service Board defined in the Eleventh Concept. The committee felt they were adequately defined under "Trustees Service Committees" in Chapter IX of *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- The committee considered a request to have the word "golden" deleted from line #2 page S68, Chapter V "The Delegate" in *The A.A. Service Manual*, and felt no action was necessary at this time as there were disclaimers in the paragraph.
- The committee considered a request to add "a paragraph or two" on rules for an area assembly to *The A.A. Service Manual*. The committee felt no action was necessary, that the matter was best left to local autonomy, and that area assemblies are adequately described in *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- The committee considered a request to eliminate the reference to "standing committees" in the Trustees Service Committee section on page S121 of *The A.A. Service Manual* to reconcile with the description of committees in the By-Laws of the General Service Board. The committee felt no reconciliation was needed.
- The committee considered a request to include in *The A.A. Service Manual* an organizational chart of the district structure. The committee felt this was best left to local autonomy and that there was adequate information about districts in Chapter III, "The District Committee Member and the District."
- The committee discussed two letters from delegates suggesting numerous editing changes in *The A.A. Service Manual*, and referred these routine changes to the staff for correction in the next edition.
- The committee considered a request to include "additional considerations" in the *Final Conference Report* as part of the section on Conference Advisory Actions, rather than as a separate section. The committee decided to reaffirm 1990 Conference Advisory Action #40 which added "additional considerations" as a separate section.
- The committee reviewed the rough draft of the 1992 General Service Conference Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9*.
- The committee will receive page proofs for the *Final Conference Report* in May and return any corrections by June 1.
- The committee considered a request to add information to "The Delegate's Job Is a Demanding One" regarding suggestions by the 1990 and 1991 Policy/Admissions Committees about better communications between the delegates and central offices/inter-groups. The committee felt there was adequate information in the section "Working Together—General Service and Local Inter-group Services."
- The committee considered a request to change lines 10 and 11, "Other Officers," Chapter V, page S61, in *The A.A. Service Manual* in reference to "a liaison chairperson." It was decided that this was best left to local autonomy.
- The committee considered a request to reinsert a paragraph



removed from *The A.A. Service Manual* by 1990 Advisory Action #37 in the section "Working Together—General Services and Local Intergroup Services." The committee decided there was no necessity to reinsert the paragraph.

- The committee considered a request that separate references to central offices and intergroups be rewritten as "central office(s)/intergroup(s)." The committee agreed with the suggestion and referred it to staff as a routine editorial matter.
- The committee considered a request to delete from *The A.A. Service Manual*, Chapter V, page S69 "Delegate's Primary Duties" from Item #9 the parenthetical phrase "particularly when there is no local central office or intergroup to take the responsibility to communicate with local central offices/intergroups" in keeping with 1990 Conference Advisory Action 29 (Policy/Admissions). The committee decided to take no action to delete this information from the 1990 Advisory Action.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee strongly suggested that Conference Advisory Actions be applied to all pieces of Conference literature uniformly, following review and recommendation by the Conference Literature Committee.
- It was suggested that the paragraph to be included on the "presentation" service card in the video case of "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous" read: "Many local A.A. service committees will, upon request, provide informational presentations for your organization."
- The committee suggested that the Treatment Facilities Workbooks be priced and sold at cost of production and distribution, and that the Treatment Facilities Workbook refills (MU 40) also be priced and sold at cost of production and distribution.
- Considered the suggestion that G.S.O. become the temporary contact point for treatment facilities and correctional facilities, but felt this service is the responsibility of local A.A. service committees.
- Considered the suggestion that the General Service Conference host an annual event related to "bridging the gap" between A.A. and treatment facilities and/or correctional facilities, and felt that this would best be left to local autonomy.
- The committee reviewed the suggested guidelines prepared by the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee for writing articles for the Treatment Facilities Newsletter, and suggested that it be included in the Treatment Facilities Workbook.

It was further suggested that the guidelines be included with the mailing of the next Treatment Facilities Newsletter.

- The committee suggested that the 'History and Highlights' (gray pages) in the "A.A. Bulletin" section of the Treatment Facilities Workbook be removed as it is a duplication of the section "A.A. Conference Committee History and Actions."

- The committee suggested that the Spanish version of the guidelines for both the Treatment Facilities and the Correctional Facilities Committees be removed from the Treatment Facilities Workbook since the workbooks for both these committees are now published in Spanish.
- The committee suggested that A.A.W.S. and the Publications Department consider a single sheet foldout format for the "Bridging the Gap" pamphlet.

TRUSTEES

- The committee discussed and reviewed terms of Class A trustees (page S109, 1991–1992 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*). The committee suggested that, hereafter, incoming Class A trustee terms be limited to two (2) consecutive three-year terms, and that this be considered at the 1993 Conference after appropriate study.
- The committee discussed and reviewed rotation of trustees as chairpersons of trustees' committees. The committee suggested that, in the spirit of rotation, a trustee serve as chairperson of a trustees' committee for no more than two (2) years, and that this be considered at the 1993 Conference after appropriate study. This does not limit a trustee serving as chairperson of more than one committee during his/her term.
- The committee discussed and reviewed term of the chairperson of the General Service Board (page S111, 1991–1992 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*). The committee suggested that, in the spirit of rotation, the term of the chairperson of the General Service board shall hereafter be not more than four (4) successive annual terms, and that this be considered at the 1993 Conference after appropriate study.
- The committee considered a request from an area delegate to add "four years' area committee service experience" to the requirements for applicants for appointed committee member and nontrustee director vacancies. The committee referred this subject to the 1993 Conference Committee on Trustees, for further discussion.
- The committee considered a request from an area delegate to add appointed committee members to the "Scope" of the Conference Committee on Trustees so that the committee could review resumes prior to appointment for disapproval, if any. The committee referred this subject to the 1993 Conference Committee on Trustees, for further discussion.
- The committee requested that the resumes of the final applicants approved by the trustees' Nominating Committee for appointed committee member vacancies be sent to each member of the Conference Committee on Trustees.
- The committee further suggested that, when filling openings for appointed committee members, each area delegate be informed as to who and where these positions were filled.

A sign Bert Haase (Northeast Ohio) kept in front of him throughout the Conference:

*Oh Lord, Help My
Words to be Gracious
and Tender Today,
For Tomorrow I May
Have to Eat Them*

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

1992 BUDGET

	<u>1992 Budget</u>	
PAID CIRCULATION — AVERAGE		\$ 127,000
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE (Schedule 1)		
Subscription income	\$1,524,000	
Single copies and back issues	<u>32,400</u>	
<u>Total magazine income</u>		1,556,400
<u>Total direct costs</u>		<u>581,100</u>
GROSS PROFIT ON MAGAZINE		975,300
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME (Schedule 1)	474,400	
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>192,500</u>	
GROSS PROFIT ON SPECIAL ITEMS		<u>281,900</u>
<u>TOTAL GROSS PROFIT</u>		<u>1,257,200</u>
COSTS AND EXPENSES		
EDITORIAL COSTS		
Salaries, including temporary help	\$ 223,500	
Payroll taxes and benefits	36,300	
Occupancy costs	56,300	
Office supplies and expenses	20,000	
Product development	<u>5,000</u>	
<u>Total Editorial</u>		341,100
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	473,600	
Payroll taxes and benefits	136,900	
Fulfillment costs — computer	9,000	
Occupancy costs	68,500	
Office expense, including agency fees	20,000	
Subscriber services	23,300	
Selling expense — regular	101,700	
— GvR program	25,200	
Postage	<u>22,000</u>	
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>		880,200
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	4,000	
Insurance	5,300	
Professional fees	25,000	
Meetings and conferences	25,000	
Furniture and equipment	10,000	
Canadian exchange and other	<u>2,000</u>	
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>		<u>71,300</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES		1,292,600
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS		(35,400)
Add: Interest earned		<u>103,000</u>
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD		<u>67,600</u>

() denotes red figures

The General Service Office 1992 BUDGET

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund		General Service Office Total
		Office	Other	
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$10,220,000			\$10,220,000
Discounts	<u>(417,000)</u>			<u>(417,000)</u>
<u>Net Sales</u>	9,803,000			9,803,000
Cost of products	(3,348,700)			(3,348,700)
Royalties	<u>(990,000)</u>			<u>(990,000)</u>
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	5,464,300			5,464,300
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$4,179,500		4,179,500
Interest income	<u>10,000</u>	<u>10,000</u>		<u>20,000</u>
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>5,474,300</u>	<u>4,189,500</u>		<u>9,663,800</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	1,743,200	1,995,400		3,738,600
Pension/retirement expense	191,650		10,000	201,650
Rent and electric	290,080	232,320		522,400
Box 4-5-9		191,000		191,000
A.A. Directories		41,900		41,900
Other service materials		253,000		253,000
Shipping and mailing	1,017,000			1,017,000
Other office expenses	64,700	542,500		607,200
Insurance and payroll taxes		810,900		810,900
Professional services	115,000		27,500	142,500
Board, committee and staff meetings	29,500	10,500	183,000	223,000
Writers' fees	118,900			118,900
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	23,000		120,450	143,450
General Service Conference		348,800		348,800
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	156,000			156,000
Regional Forums and Archives			133,100	133,100
Film development			21,250	21,250
Self-Support Project			12,600	12,600
Foreign literature assistance (net)	159,300			159,300
World Service Meeting			31,500	31,500
TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES	<u>3,908,330</u>	<u>4,426,320</u>	<u>539,400</u>	<u>8,874,050</u>
Net Operating Income (Loss)	1,565,970	(236,820)	(539,400)	789,750
Less extraordinary expenses:				
Duplicate Rent/Relocation			(242,900)	(242,900)
Relocation/Construction — Est.			<u>(1,738,000)*</u>	<u>(1,738,000)</u>
NET INCOME (LOSS)	<u>1,565,970</u>	<u>(236,820)</u>	<u>(2,520,300)</u>	<u>(1,191,150)</u>
EARNINGS ON RESERVE FUND — Est.				<u>550,000</u>

* **NOTE:** Based on preliminary construction plans, \$1,686,000 was intended to be expensed on the project in 1991 and \$1,440,800 in 1992. However, once the project was actually underway, only \$1,146,000 was expensed in 1991 and it became necessary to defer \$540,000 until 1992.

1992 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

Income: The sales income budget of \$10,220,000 is approximately \$560,000 less than that actual gross sales for 1991. This reflects lower anticipated sales volume. Gross profit from literature is projected at \$5,464,000, approximately \$400,000 lower than 1991 actual.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at approximately \$3,908,000, approximately \$395,000 less than 1991 actual.

Net: Net publishing income is expected to be approximately \$1,566,000, about the same as 1991 (\$1,582,000).

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

Income: Contributions have been anticipated at \$4,179,500, this amount, while slightly higher than the actual for 1991—\$26,000, is approximately one-half of one percent higher than 1991, for all intents is a flat budget. Contributions received from groups and members were actually \$262,000 (5.9%) less than those received in 1990. In 1990 contributions were actually \$361,000 (8.9%) higher than those received in 1989.

Expenses: Total group expenses (including the General Service Conference) to be directly charged against contributions are budgeted at \$4,426,000. This results in an anticipated shortfall of these expenses charged of \$237,000. This compares with actual results for 1991 of \$249,500.

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$2,520,300. This includes extraordinary expenses of \$1,980,900 budgeted for Relocation/Renovation expenses anticipated in 1992. Exclusive of this item, other expenses are budgeted lower than those in 1991 by approximately \$83,000. The actual amount budgeted for other expenses excluding the Relocation/Renovation project of \$539,400.

RECAP

The shortfall for 1992 "Group Services" (as defined by the 1986 General Service Conference) supported by group contributions, is budgeted to be \$786,220. It is anticipated that the net publishing income will offset the shortfall and approximately half of the extraordinary expenses. A drawdown from the Reserve Fund is expected for 1992, approximately one million dollars.

1992 Grapevine Budget

Total revenue: Magazine income of \$1,556,400 is based on an average circulation of 127,000. Direct costs of \$581,100 are consistent with 1991 actual direct costs.

Other publishing income of \$474,400 is derived from the sale of magazine-related special items. Direct costs of \$192,500 reflect a modest increase (1.0%) over 1991 actual costs.

The \$1,257,200 Gross Profit is also consistent with the 1991 actual Total Gross Profit.

Total expenses: Editorial costs are budgeted at \$341,100, \$17,300 (4.8%) below 1991 actual. Medical insurance shows a 30% increase over 1991 actual while Occupancy is budgeted at 38% below 1991 actual.

Circulation and Business expenses are budgeted at \$880,200, \$76,000 (9.4%) over 1991 actual. In addition to the medical insurance and occupancy changes as stated above, selling expenses were budgeted 25% higher.

These changes result in Total Costs and Expenses budgeted at \$1,292,600 or \$49,200 (4%) over 1991 actual.

Net: After including interest income of \$103,000 the budget shows a modest net income of \$67,600.

COMPARISON OF SHORTFALL OF 'GROUP SERVICES' SUPPORTED BY GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS

April 1986 Conference Advisory Action 16.a:

16. The area delegates strongly consider implementation of the following suggestions to improve contributions to G.S.O., area assemblies, districts, and central or inter-group offices:

- G.S.O. make available to all delegates an itemized list of group service expenses and other expenses of the board, combined into one total, representing group services supported by group contributions.

The following is a recap of these lists [detailed reports appear in delegates' Manual and *Final Conference Report*]:

1990

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$4,415,395
General Fund — Office Expenses (incl. G.S.C.)			
		\$4,426,366	
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board			
		\$824,145	
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Computer Acquisition	(311,422)	512,723	4,939,089
<u>Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions</u>			<u>(523,694)</u>

1991

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$4,153,572
General Fund — Office Expenses (incl. G.S.C.)			
		\$4,423,158	
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board			
		\$1,769,132	
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Relocation/Restoration	(1,146,287)	622,845	5,046,003
<u>Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions</u>			<u>(892,431)</u>

1992 BUDGET

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$4,179,500
General Fund — Office Expenses		\$4,426,320	
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board			
		\$2,520,300	
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Relocation/Renovation	(1,980,900)	539,400	4,965,720
<u>Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions</u>			<u>(786,220)</u>

1991 Total Contributions — by State / Province

(in U.S. dollars)

U.S.	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
Alabama	299	162	54.2%	\$ 19,572.86	4,945	\$3.96
Alaska	227	92	40.5	10,972.50	3,225	3.40
Arizona	768	360	46.8	49,419.50	14,138	3.50
Arkansas	263	127	48.2	17,218.17	3,966	4.34
California	7,038	3,655	51.9	537,498.24	217,237	2.47
Colorado	657	374	56.9	61,145.18	16,260	3.76
Connecticut	1,286	648	50.3	89,541.04	29,500	3.04
Delaware	162	106	65.4	24,275.69	2,685	9.04
District of Columbia	189	95	50.2	24,186.84	6,176	3.92
Florida	2,276	1,217	53.4	205,634.20	41,650	4.94
Georgia	665	486	73.0	75,180.26	15,348	4.90
Hawaii	250	157	62.8	41,582.38	5,215	7.97
Idaho	254	122	48.0	12,462.35	3,639	3.42
Illinois	2,434	1,081	44.4	150,056.16	50,773	2.96
Indiana	1,111	573	51.5	65,134.70	20,097	3.24
Iowa	644	352	54.6	45,852.97	12,744	3.60
Kansas	397	237	59.6	30,377.21	9,770	3.11
Kentucky	534	303	56.7	55,680.85	9,067	6.14
Louisiana	534	250	46.8	28,662.87	9,830	2.92
Maine	460	183	39.8	19,408.86	8,408	2.31
Maryland	1,051	579	55.0	89,360.39	20,084	4.45
Massachusetts	1,682	729	43.3	98,549.93	56,044	1.76
Michigan	1,745	828	47.3	145,777.22	37,587	3.88
Minnesota	1,511	776	51.3	74,751.49	32,985	2.27
Mississippi	241	122	50.6	9,853.59	3,270	3.01
Missouri	803	453	56.4	60,966.83	14,927	4.08
Montana	342	139	40.6	14,469.87	4,723	3.06
Nebraska	718	366	50.9	58,201.13	14,675	3.97
Nevada	295	145	49.1	16,800.35	5,554	3.02
New Hampshire	515	207	40.1	22,561.15	7,683	2.94
New Jersey	1,623	812	50.0	124,491.08	36,030	3.46
New Mexico	295	137	46.4	17,802.41	4,758	3.74
New York	3,403	1,600	47.0	289,873.52	75,274	3.85
North Carolina	765	463	60.5	75,454.95	12,370	6.10
North Dakota	178	89	50.0	7,866.79	3,091	2.55
Ohio	2,418	1,040	43.0	134,257.06	45,796	2.93
Oklahoma	392	263	67.0	36,991.16	6,256	5.91
Oregon	742	386	52.0	51,713.01	12,985	3.98
Pennsylvania	2,078	1,116	53.7	152,609.79	45,383	3.36
Rhode Island	233	110	47.2	12,876.08	4,715	2.73
South Carolina	281	177	62.9	24,853.59	5,218	4.76
South Dakota	171	69	40.3	9,246.11	3,609	2.56
Tennessee	437	242	55.3	35,033.72	8,254	4.24
Texas	1,698	824	48.5	151,304.96	47,917	3.16
Utah	280	185	66.0	22,193.03	5,216	4.25
Vermont	231	93	40.2	15,208.88	4,141	3.67
Virginia	1,059	620	58.5	89,629.95	21,052	4.26
Washington	1,228	626	50.9	110,347.69	24,216	4.56
West Virginia	268	147	54.8	13,777.30	3,138	4.39
Wisconsin	1,350	712	52.7	75,152.78	23,881	3.15
Wyoming	129	78	60.4	11,495.33	2,242	5.13
Commonwealth of Puerto Rico	118	70	59.3	5,547.18	1,530	3.63
Bahama Islands	10	2	20.0	400.00	145	2.76
Virgin Islands of U.S.	9	6	66.6	1,369.69	297	4.61
TOTAL for U.S.	48,747	24,791	50.9%	\$3,624,650.84	1,079,719	\$3.36

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists of percentages submitted by areas).

CANADA (stated in Canadian dollars)	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
Alberta	510	248	48.6%	39,830.26\$	6,752	5.90\$
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	168	79	47.0	7,479.04	2,231	3.35
Newfoundland	100	47	47.0	5,216.77	929	5.62
Nova Scotia	180	94	52.2	12,668.78	2,343	5.41
Prince Edward Island	72	28	38.8	2,866.08	1,332	2.15
Labrador	2	0	0.0	0.00	44	0
British Columbia	740	414	55.9	74,381.02	11,973	6.21
Manitoba	156	66	42.3	9,905.31	3,871	2.56
N.W. Territories	34	8	23.5	608.83	330	1.84
Ontario	1,308	627	47.9	156,915.27	26,029	6.03
Quebec	1,541	478	31.0 ①	158,622.90	30,049	5.28
Saskatchewan	347	188	54.2	22,424.56	4,656	4.82
Yukon Territory	15	8	53.3	1,073.59	196	5.48
TOTAL for CANADA (Canadian dollars)	5,173	3,007 ①	58.1% ①	563,666.46\$	90,735	6.21\$ ①
(converted to U.S. dollars \$ 492,192.39)						\$5.42
TOTAL for U.S. (U.S. and CANADA dollars)	53,920	27,798 ①	51.6% ①	\$4,116,843.23	1,170,454	\$3.52 ①

FOREIGN AND OTHER

Birds of a Feather	530.00
Correctional facility groups	545.02
Foreign	29,945.03
International Doctors in A.A.	3,000.00
International Lawyers in A.A.	1,000.00
Internationalists	30.00
Loners	789.00
Treatment facility meetings	853.72
World Hello	36.00
GRAND TOTAL	\$4,153,572.00

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON 1991-1990

(in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. 1991	48,747	24,791	50.9%	\$3,624,650.84	1,079,719	\$3.36
U.S. 1990	46,450	25,050	53.9	3,928,988.77	1,012,623	3.88
Increase (Decrease)	2,297	(259)	(3.1%)	\$ (304,337.93)	67,096	\$(.52)
Canada 1991	5,173	2,285 ①	44.2% ①	\$ 492,192.39	90,735	\$5.43 ①
Canada 1990	5,046	3,003 ①	59.5 ①	450,590.38	87,532	5.15 ①
Increase (Decrease)	127	(718)	(15.3%)	\$ (41,602.01)	3,203	\$0.28
U.S. and Canada 1991	53,920	27,076 ①	50.2% ①	\$4,116,843.00	1,170,454	\$3.52 ①
U.S. and Canada 1990	51,496	28,053 ①	54.5 ①	4,379,579.00	1,100,155	3.98 ①
Increase (Decrease)	2,424	(977)	(40.3%)	\$ (262,736.00)	70,299	\$(.46)

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.

Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

COMBINED STATEMENTS OF INCOME, EXPENSES AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES

Years Ended December 31, 1991 and 1990

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Combined 1991	Combined 1990
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund				
INCOME FROM LITERATURE							
Gross Sales				\$10,780,076	\$2,084,558	\$12,864,634	\$12,602,267
Less: Discounts				418,815	46,668	465,483	463,350
Net Sales				10,361,261	2,037,890	12,399,151	12,138,917
Cost of Literature Distributed							
Printing				(3,489,139)	(392,891)	(3,882,030)	(4,031,065)
Royalties on books				(1,009,225)	—	(1,009,225)	(1,014,202)
Gross Profit from Literature				5,862,897	1,644,999	7,507,896	7,093,650
CONTRIBUTIONS — A.A. groups and members	\$4,153,572			—	—	4,153,572	4,415,395
55th Anniversary Convention	—			—	—	—	181,029
Investment Income	20,113	\$ 550,137		22,826	97,797	690,873	686,924
Total Income	<u>4,173,685</u>	<u>550,137</u>		<u>5,885,723</u>	<u>1,742,796</u>	<u>12,352,341</u>	<u>12,376,998</u>
EXPENSES							
Office Expenses (Schedule A-1)	4,094,133			3,589,408	1,463,336	9,146,877	8,949,986
Relocation construction and duplicate rent (including capital expenditures of \$548,116—see contra below)	1,146,287			—	—	1,146,287	—
Computer Acquisition Expense (includes expenditures on capital projects: 1990 — \$148,548—see contra below)	—			—	—	—	311,422
Other Expenses (Schedule A-2)	951,870			713,877	175,780	1,841,527	1,452,139
Total Expenses	<u>6,192,290</u>			<u>4,303,285</u>	<u>1,639,116</u>	<u>12,134,691</u>	<u>10,713,547</u>
Excess of Income (Expense) for Year	(2,018,605)	550,137		1,582,438	103,680	217,650	1,663,451
Fund Balances							
Balance, January 1	57,013	7,095,359	\$ 566,000	2,498,630	585,740	10,802,742	9,496,351
						11,020,392	11,159,802
Increase—expenditures on capital projects (see contra above)			548,116			548,116	148,548
			1,114,116			11,568,508	11,308,350
Decrease—depreciation on capital projects			(254,747)			(254,747)	(505,608)
			859,369			11,313,761	10,802,742
Intercompany donations	2,018,605	(330,355)	—	(1,568,605)	(119,645)	—	—
Balance, December 31	<u>57,013</u>	<u>7,315,141</u>	<u>859,369</u>	<u>2,512,463</u>	<u>569,775</u>	<u>11,313,761</u>	<u>10,802,742</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

Years Ended December 31, 1991 and 1990

COMBINED OFFICE EXPENSES

SCHEDULE A-1

	1991	1990
Salaries	\$4,115,291	\$4,124,577
Employee benefits, including pension plan	1,114,497	1,027,701
Total Labor Costs	5,229,788	5,152,278
Postage express	1,227,348	1,151,431
Warehousing and packing	440,871	403,364
Stationery and office supplies	120,088	135,622
Rent and electricity	898,884	844,396
Telephone	76,049	81,830
Box 4-5-9	197,775	165,920
A. A. Directories	51,278	49,163
Other service materials	331,156	373,032
Writers' fees	137,855	103,385
Office equipment	16,436	16,527
Insurance	23,564	26,562
Office services and expenses	312,793	364,124
Maintenance and repairs	21,251	23,546
Staff and committee meetings	61,741	58,806
	<u>9,146,877</u>	<u>8,949,986</u>
BY ENTITY:		
The General Service Board of A.A.—General Fund	\$4,094,133	\$4,120,258
A.A. World Services, Inc.	3,589,408	3,443,958
A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	1,463,336	1,385,770
	<u>9,146,877</u>	<u>8,949,986</u>

COMBINED OTHER EXPENSES

SCHEDULE A-2

	1991		1990
Meetings, Forums and Committees			
General Service Conference	\$ 329,025		\$ 306,108
1990 World Service Meeting	—		80,635
Regional Forums	92,917		98,362
Other meetings and committees	<u>272,072</u>	\$ 694,014	<u>236,175</u> \$ 721,280
Data processing costs		189,764	97,107
Selling expense		158,018	136,684
Professional fees		305,230	228,837
Leasehold improvements		—	1,268
Foreign literature assistance		62,386	111,742
Loss on bad debts		23,833	14,968
Severance benefits		272,248	—
Film projects		71,249	45,624
Travel and other		<u>64,785</u>	<u>94,629</u>
		<u>1,841,527</u>	<u>1,452,139</u>
BY ENTITY:			
The General Service Board of A.A.—General Fund		\$ 951,870	\$ 818,831
A.A. World Services, Inc.		713,877	454,156
A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		<u>175,780</u>	<u>179,152</u>
		<u>1,841,527</u>	<u>1,452,139</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

EXHIBIT B

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
COMBINED BALANCE SHEETS
 Years Ended December 31, 1991 and 1990

	<u>General Service Board of A.A.</u>			<u>A.A. World Services, Inc.</u>	<u>A.A. Grapevine, Inc.</u>	<u>Combined 1991</u>	<u>Combined 1990</u>
	<u>General Fund</u>	<u>Reserve Fund</u>	<u>Capital Projects Fund</u>				
ASSETS							
Cash							
On deposit	\$ 371,312	\$2,489,490		\$ 578,331	\$ 287,343	\$ 3,726,476	\$ 3,696,907
Segregated for royalties	—	—		—	—	—	1,711,961
Accounts and interest receivable	—	117,982		227,388	21,506	366,876	387,588
Deposits on relocation/construction project	263,015	—		—	—	263,015	—
Intercompany balances	(599,072)	(1,259,659)		618,563	1,240,168	—	—
Inventories							
Books, pamphlets, etc.	—	—		1,528,172	138,221	1,666,393	1,731,426
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.	—	—		239,253	66,284	305,537	424,839
Investments							
U.S. Treasury Notes, due 1992/2000, at cost (market value: 1991 – \$6,458,353; 1990 – \$6,410,015)	—	5,967,328		—	—	5,967,328	6,259,053
Fixed Assets							
Leasehold improvements, computer hardware and software (net of accumulated depreciation: 1991 – \$2,639,742; 1990 – \$2,384,995)	—	—	\$859,359	—	—	859,369	566,000
Deferred charges	130,108	—	—	75,760	52,954	258,822	210,701
Other Assets	—	—	—	39,451	—	39,451	34,451
Total Assets	<u>165,363</u>	<u>7,315,141</u>	<u>859,369</u>	<u>3,306,918</u>	<u>1,806,476</u>	<u>13,453,267</u>	<u>15,022,926</u>
LIABILITIES							
Accounts payable	\$ —	\$ —	\$ —	\$ 442,827	\$ 68,053	\$ 510,880	\$ 925,817
Accrued royalties	—	—	—	221,484	—	221,484	1,935,014
Accrued severance benefits	89,750	—	—	70,717	—	160,467	—
Deferred income	18,600	—	—	59,427	1,168,648	1,246,675	1,359,353
Total Liabilities	108,350	—	—	794,455	1,236,701	2,139,506	4,220,184
Fund Balances (Exhibit A)	57,013	7,315,141	859,369	2,512,463	569,775	11,313,761	10,802,742
Total Liabilities and Fund Balances	<u>165,363</u>	<u>7,315,141</u>	<u>859,369</u>	<u>3,306,918</u>	<u>1,806,476</u>	<u>13,453,267</u>	<u>15,022,926</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITOR'S OPINION

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10115

March 16, 1992

Ladies and Gentlemen:

We have audited the accompanying combined balance sheets of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. and its wholly owned subsidiaries, ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC., as of December 31, 1991 and 1990, and the related combined statements of income, expenses and changes in fund balances for the years then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the organization's management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audits.

We conducted our audits in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audits provide a reasonable basis for our opinion.

In our opinion, the financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the combined financial position of the three corporations named above as of December 31, 1991 and 1990, and the combined results of their operations for the years then ended in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles.

Respectfully submitted,

Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants

**THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
NOTES TO COMBINED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
DECEMBER 31, 1991 AND 1990**

Note 1 Organization

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. is a not-for-profit corporation organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world. In furtherance of that objective, the organization also publishes books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to the A.A. program through two wholly owned not-for-profit corporations, A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in three separate funds, as follows:

The *RESERVE FUND*—established in 1954 for the purposes of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was redefined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the

A.A. General Service Board. That committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers, and, therefore, they are reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The *CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND*—This fund was established in 1990, with retroactive effect to 1989, to account for the costs of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects; and also to record annual depreciation on such assets.

The *GENERAL FUND*—is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies

The corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. Contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Intercompany balances and donations have been eliminated in the combined totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Inventories

Inventories held by A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are recorded at cost under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Fixed Assets

From its inception, The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous had consistently followed an accounting policy under which all costs of leasehold improvements and equipment were charged against income in the year incurred, rather than being capitalized. That policy was responsive to A.A. Traditions of avoiding the accumulation of unnecessary wealth or property.

In August 1987, the Financial Accounting Standards Board issued a Statement of Financial Accounting Standards No. 93 which requires all not-for-profit organizations to recognize the cost of using up long-lived tangible assets—depreciation—in general purpose financial statements. The original effective date for implementation was May 1988, but was later extended to years beginning in 1990.

In order to comply with that FASB Statement and be in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles, responsible officers of the General Service Board of A.A., with concurrence of the independent auditors, authorized the establishment of a separate Fund in which the cost of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions would be capitalized and depreciation provided over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equip-

ment. The costs of such expenditures continues to be recorded as an expense in the General Fund, but the effect on the overall Fund Balance is adjusted through changes in the Fund Balance of the new "Capital Projects Fund."

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 1991 and the accumulated reserves for depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Reserve
Leasehold improvements				
470 Park Avenue South	Terms of	\$1,877,513	\$ 59,664	\$1,877,513
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	<u>548,116</u>	<u>—</u>	<u>—</u>
		2,425,629	59,664	1,877,513
Furniture	8 Years	112,506	2,888	103,844
Equipment	5 Years	50,340	10,068	50,340
Computer—hardware	5 Years	638,965	127,793	473,749
—software	7 Years	<u>271,671</u>	<u>54,334</u>	<u>134,296</u>
		<u>3,499,111</u>	<u>254,747</u>	<u>2,639,742</u>

All depreciation is provided on the straight line basis. No depreciation was provided for leasehold improvements at 475 Riverside Drive in 1991 because the premises were not available for occupancy.

Investments

Investments held by the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board of A.A. are carried at cost. No recognition is made in the accounts for any changes in aggregate market value above or below cost because all of the investments are U.S. Treasury Notes with short or medium terms that are normally held to maturity.

Note 3 Retirement Plan

The trustees of General Service Board adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible employees of A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. The plan has been amended from time to time to improve benefits and to comply with current statutory requirements.

The report of the plan's actuaries stated that as of January 1, 1991, the most recent valuation date to these financial statements for which information is available, the present value of accrued benefits under the plan was \$3,280,746, of which \$3,070,035 was vested. The market value of the assets of the trust fund at the same date was \$4,883,261. The assumed rate of return used in determining the actuarial value of vested plan benefits was 7.5%.

Pension expense has been consistently reported as the contribution made to actuarially fund plan benefits, plus the actuarial, investment and custody fees paid by A.A. World Services related to the operation of the plan. That method of accounting was in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles that had been in effect since the issuance of Accounting Principles Board Statement No. 8 in 1966.

Effective as of 1987, however, Financial Accounting Standards Board (FASB) Statement No. 87 introduced a new concept of "net periodic pension cost," in which pension cost would be accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon actuarial factors which would not necessarily be the same as those presently used in calculating the annual funding requirement. In addition, FASB No. 87 would require, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the organization's balance sheet depending upon whether the plan was considered to be over or under funded. It is clear from the above actuarial data that there is no unfunded liability in the A.A. Retirement Plan. Management still believes the annual funding requirement

is a more relevant measure of pension expense, and that the cost of additional actuarial calculations is not warranted. The actuaries have stated that the difference would not be a material amount.

Prior to 1990, A.A. World Service had always paid the actuarial, investment and custody fees incurred by the plan. As of January 1, 1990, however, the A.A.W.S. Board elected to utilize the discretion granted under the plan provisions to direct such expenses to be paid by the plan. Accordingly, no such expenses are included in pension expense for 1990 and 1991.

Pension expense for 1991 and 1990 was \$208,258 and \$175,070, respectively.

Note 4 Lease Commitments

At December 31, 1991, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$1,283,200 yearly office rental lease at 470 Park Avenue South effective April 1, 1991 through March 31, 1992.

\$347,275 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective July 1, 1991 through September 30, 2001.

\$132,994 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective September 1, 1991 through September 30, 2001.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 1991 is \$5,003,000.

The rental expense for the years ended December 31, 1991 and 1990, were as follows:

	1991	1990
Total Rent Expense	<u>\$ 780,400</u>	<u>\$ 730,700</u>
Allocated to:		
A.A. World Services	\$ 362,000	\$ 338,900
General Service Board	265,900	248,900
A.A. Grapevine	<u>152,500</u>	<u>142,900</u>
	<u>780,400</u>	<u>730,700</u>

In addition to the rental expense shown above, the entire rent of \$240,700 paid in 1991 for 475 Riverside Drive, and the rent premium of \$357,500 incurred for the one year lease extension at 470 Park Avenue South, have both been borne by the General Service Board as part of the overall cost of the relocation and construction project.

In connection with the lease for 475 Riverside Drive, a real estate brokerage firm has commenced legal action on a commission claim for \$240,000. Legal counsel has advised that the claim appears to be without merit, but the outcome is uncertain.

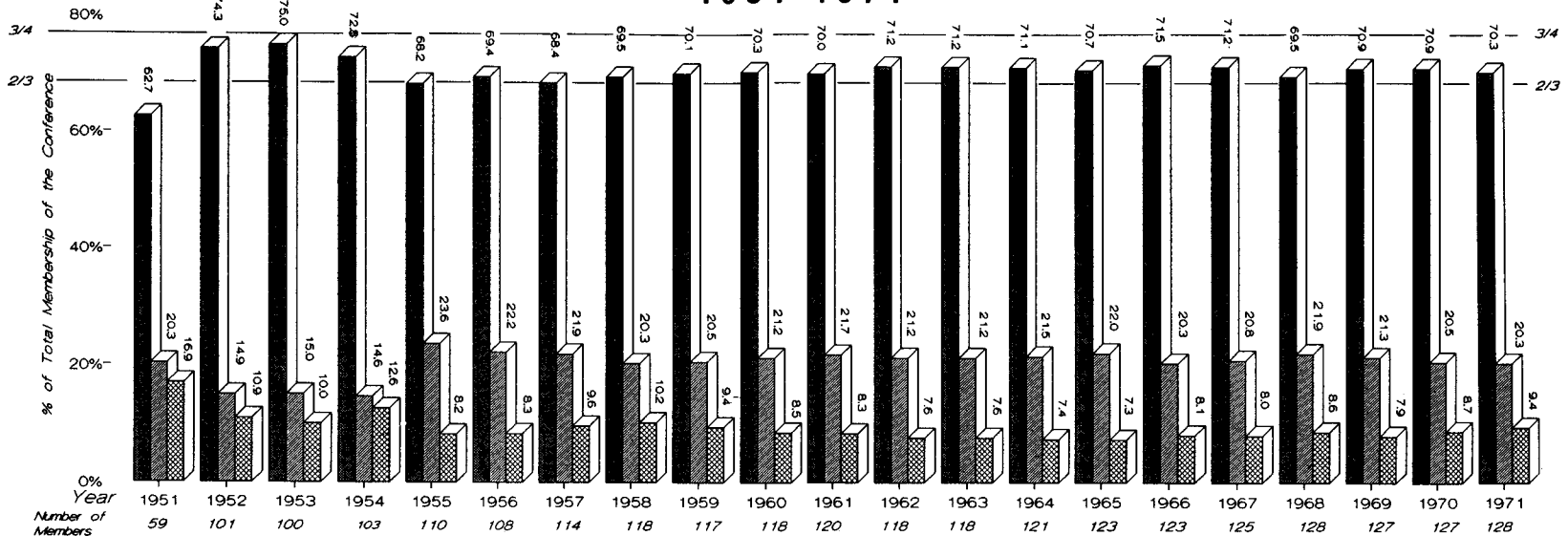
Note 5 Tax Status

The organizations are exempt from federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code. They are also exempt from the New York State Franchise Tax.

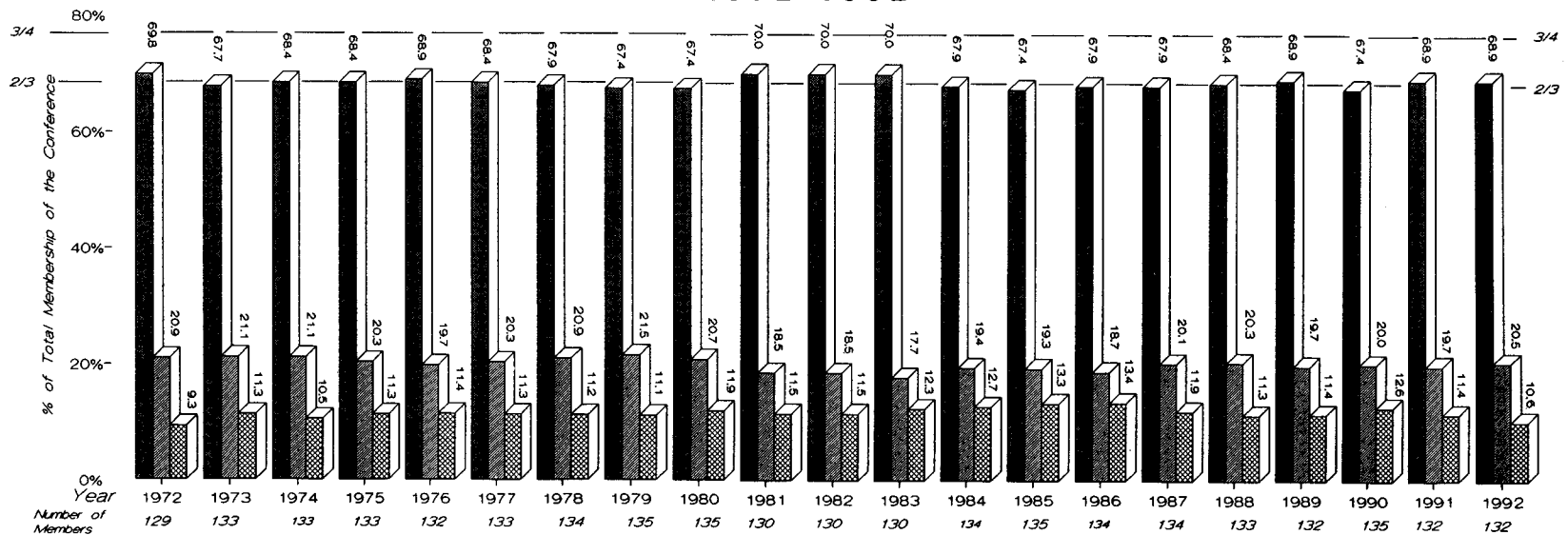
Pacific regional trustee Greg Muth took the Pacific region's delegates on a minibus tour of New York's A.A. highlights, including Bill's house on Clinton St. in Brooklyn. It proved to be enlightening for the busdriver, as well—Nick, from Brooklyn's Sheepshead Bay Group, who is sober 5 years.

CONFERENCE MEMBERSHIP

1951-1971



1972-1992



Percentage of Delegates, Boards, Staffs

Delegates Boards Staffs

1992 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Paul Baatz
Rod Brown
Dick Brummel
Elmer Chaney
²James Downes
Joe McGarity
¹Jude Tims
Diane Wright

Secretary: Pat Rosenstiel

Finance

Tom Barlow
¹Mike Bruce
O.B. Culley
²Ottis Dimick
Marcia Goldblatt
Chuck Hickson
Jacqueline Johnston
John Sweeney

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Policy/Admissions

Jim Clough
John Curtin
Vivien Gerten
¹Patrick Hogan
Don Huff
Klaus Kroeber
Robert McElroy
Cena Robbins

Secretary: Eileen Gatza

Treatment Facilities

¹Doug Bailey
Harold Douse
Norbert Haase
Santiago Rodriguez
Chuck Stokes
Bernard Sullivan
²Connie Wesley
Terry Wymer

Secretary: Sarah Price

Cooperation With the Professional Community

²Hugh Cochrane
George Croop
Michel Girard
¹Kenneth Kendrick
Jim Key
Melvin Larkin
Jack Layden
Maryjane Roy

Secretary: Valerie O'Neill

Grapevine

²Dennis Bauer
Bill Cross
¹David Every
John Griffith
David Jimerson
Richard LaGasse
Jimmy Matheny
Ted Stoa
Barry Waddell

Secretary: Ames Sweet

Public Information

Anna Cushman
Carlos Flores
²Bill McCaa
Linda O'Brien
¹Julian Rhinehart
Verna Robinson
Hugues Samson
Doug Tolley
John Wampler

Secretary: Joanie Moncrief

Trustees

Bob Barnes
Greg Gits
Howard Lowery
Helen McConnell
¹Scott McLarty
Barbara Madger
²Richard Patch
Harland Sercombe

Secretary: Susan Ulseth

Correctional Facilities

Jim Burke
Tom Duffy
¹Bob Greenfield
Vail Jenson
Tom Lawrence
Maxine Miller
Edward Prince
²Glenn Wyckoff

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

Literature

Frank Berls
Paul Cleary
Marne Crary
Bob Halvorson
Bert Kluthe
Wayne Reed
²Al Smith
Elaine Strome
¹Susie Terrell

Secretary: John Grant

Report and Charter

Caroline Bradley
Dick Clark
Bill Hellesen
²Sid Mayeux
Robert Pare
Joe Sostarich
¹Joe Sullivan
Bo Welch

Secretary: Richard Bush

1995 International Convention

Dick Clark
Bob Halvorson
Chuck Hickson
Jacqueline Johnston

Secretary: Eileen Gatza

Bill McCaa
Scott McLarty
Dick Patch
Edward Prince

1993 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Paul Baatz, Southwest Quebec	Dick Brummel, Kansas
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Maryjane Roy, Rhode Island	Mel Larkin, New Brunswick/P.E.I.
Correctional Facilities	Edward Prince, Manitoba	Jim Burke, S.W. Texas
Finance	Tom Barlow, N. Illinois	O.B. Culley, Alaska
Grapevine	Barry Waddell, Nebraska	Bill Cross, Calif., N. Interior
Literature	Paul Cleary, Calif., San Diego/Imperial	Bob Halvorson, Montana
Policy/Admissions	Jim Clough, Calif., Mid-Southern	John Curtin, Maryland
Public Information	Anna Cushman, W. Michigan	Carlos Flores, Idaho
Report and Charter	Joe Sostarich, Kentucky	Bo Welch, Georgia
Treatment Facilities	Harold Douse, Vermont	Chuck Stokes, N. Wisc./Upper Pen. Mich.
Committee on Trustees	Helen McConnell, Oregon	Howard Lowery, Mississippi

¹ Chairperson

² Alternate Chairperson

1992 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Joan Jackson, *chairperson*
Bernard Benziger
Ann Bruning
Harold Greene
Jacob Ham
John King
David O'Leary
Everett Smethurst
George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

Greg Muth, *chairperson*
Don Bruner
Ann Bruning
Phil Cels
Harold Greene
Jacqueline Martin
Michael McPherson
David O'Leary
Pat Rosenstiel, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

John Hartley Smith, M.D., *chairperson*
Peter Brock
Don Bruner
John Nelson Chappel, M.D.
Dorothy Driscoll
Marc Pineau
Amos Reed
Jane Murphy Schulberg
Jean Smith
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

Amos Reed, *chairperson*
Bernard Benziger
Don Bruner
John N. Chappel, M.D.
Hugh Freyer
Ray McDermott
Olga Morris
David O'Leary
Dennis Robbins
Helen Turnquest, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Robert Morse, *chairperson*
Hugh Freyer
Harold Greene
Michael McPherson
Jacqueline Martin
Marc Pineau
Fran Polek
John Quinn
Amos Reed
Stanley Silverman
Jan Whitney
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Gary Glynn, *consultant*
Dennis Manders, *senior advisor*
Donald Meuer, *secretary*

International

John Quinn, *chairperson*
Jacob Ham
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Greg Muth
David O'Leary
Marc Pineau
Fran Polek
Amos Reed
Stanley Silverman
Everett Smethurst
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

Phil Cels, *chairperson*
Ann Bruning
Jacob Ham
Jacqueline Martin
Michael McPherson
Jane Murphy Schulberg
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Jan Whitney
Eileen Gatza, *secretary*
— *International Convention*
Richard Bush, *secretary*
— *Regional Forums*

Literature

Jean Smith, *chairperson*
Phil Cels
John N. Chappel, M.D.
Jacob Ham
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
John King
Fran Polek
Everett Smethurst
Richard Steins
Vincina McCarthy, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
John Grant, *secretary*

Nominating

John King, *chairperson*
Phil Cels
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Greg Muth
John Quinn
Jean Smith
Desmond Towey
Jan Whitney
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*

Public Information

Stanley Silverman, *chairperson*
Bernard Benziger
Ann Bruning
Ed Butler
Jacques Filteau
Sarah Holland
F. Bradley Lynch
Jane Murphy Schulberg
Desmond Towey
Joanie Moncrief, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

John N. Chappel, M.D. *chairperson*
Hugh Freyer
Robert Lewis
Terry Lindgren
Nancy McComas
John Quinn
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Desmond Towey
Sarah Price, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Don Bruner, *chairperson*
Eileen Gatza, *secretary*
All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Michael Alexander and George Dorsey
are ex officio members of all committees.



Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson
Michael Alexander
First vice-chairperson
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Second vice-chairperson
John King
Secretary
John Quinn
Treasurer
Robert Morse
Assistant secretary
Eileen Gatza
Assistant treasurer
Donald Meuer

The new slate of officers
is given on page 37.

1992 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Michael Alexander (460 Park Ave., New York, NY 10022) was elected chairman of the board at the meeting following the 1988 Conference. Mike served as a trustee from 1976 to 1985, after 20 years as legal advisor to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, he was an associate of the late Bernard Smith—so significant in A.A. history. Mike is a director and past president of the British American Chamber of Commerce, director and national secretary of the Ireland-United States Council for Commerce and Industry, and trustee and past president of the Consular Law Society.

John N. Chappel, M.D. (University of Nevada, School of Medicine, Reno, NV 89557) was elected to the board in 1989. A graduate of the University of Alberta Medical School, John has been professor of psychiatry, University of Nevada School of Medicine since 1974. He serves as consultant to many professional organizations and is widely published in the field of alcoholism. John chairs the Treatment Facilities Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, and Literature Committees.

¹**Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.** (72 Downs Rd., Bethany, CT 06525) was elected to the board in April 1983. A graduate of McGill University, Montreal, and the University of Washington, Seattle, Joan taught sociology at both universities for many years. She has served on many local, state and national boards and committees on alcoholism and on health and human behavior. At the University of Washington Medical School in Seattle, she was involved in research and teaching about alcoholism, A.A., and Al-Anon. Joan chairs the Archives Committee and serves on the International, Literature and Nominating Committees.

²**Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.** (6631 Hunters Wood Circle, Catonsville, MD 21228) was elected to the board in May 1992. A graduate of Morgan State University, Baltimore, and the University of Maryland, Elaine has a distinguished background in the fields of alcoholism and substance abuse. She has lectured widely, been a consultant to regional and government agencies and published many articles in professional journals. Elaine is acting administrator of the Alcohol, Drug Abuse and Mental Health Administration.

John E. King (423 Hawthorn, Fayetteville, AR 72701) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of St. Mary's College, Kentucky, and Tulane University, Louisiana, John was an ordained priest and has a background in social work. Currently, he is on the faculty of the University of Arkansas in the Social Work Program, where he serves as consultant to many local, state, and regional agencies as well as in a treatment capacity. John has received numerous awards and honors for his professional and civic/community service. He chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the Archives and Literature Committees, and the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Robert P. Morse (230 Park Ave., 20th Fl., New York, NY 10169) was elected to the board in April 1984 after serving as a consultant to the Finance Committee from April 1981. A graduate of the Wharton School and the University of Pennsylvania, he has over 23 years' experience in the investment business, with an in-depth background in the fixed-income sector and management of equity portfolios. Robert is president of Morse Williams Holding, Inc., investment counselors, and is chairperson of the Wall Street Fund, Inc., a public mutual fund, and a principal in Hambrecht & Quist Group, Inc., San Francisco, investment bankers. He is also

treasurer and an executive committee trustee of the Bermuda Biological Station for Research, Inc., and serves as a director of the Arlington Institute for Policy Research, Inc. in Washington, D.C. He has served as an officer in the U.S. Navy and is an active member of various fraternal and charitable organizations. Robert is treasurer of the General Service Board and chairperson of the Finance & Budgetary Committee.

Amos E. Reed (2840 Holiday Dr. S., Salem, OR 97302) was elected to the board in April 1986. A graduate of McKendree College and Northern Illinois University, he has extensive background in corrections, education, and public welfare. He is past president of the American Correctional Association, National Association of State Correctional Administrators, and National Association of Training Schools and Juvenile Agencies, and has received many awards for his services in corrections and other agencies. Retired from his position as Washington Secretary of Corrections, Amos has also held leadership positions in North Carolina, Florida, Oregon, and Illinois. He chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, Finance and Budgetary and International Committees.

John Hartley Smith, M.D. (828 West 10th Ave., Vancouver, BC V5Z 1L8, Canada) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of the Queens' University Medical School, Belfast, he has specialized in occupational medicine and public health and has served on many professional committees and advisory councils, both local and national. John has been assistant deputy minister in the British Columbia Ministry of Health since 1979; in 1986 he was appointed senior medical consultant in occupational and environmental health to the government. In 1988 he resigned to do private consulting. He was also a director of the American Board of Preventive Medicine, 1978-87, and is a part-time clinical associate professor in the Faculty of Medicine at the University of British Columbia. John chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee and serves on the International, International Convention/Regional Forums and Treatment Facilities Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

¹**Donald J. Bruner** (6420 Bluff Dr., Bloomington, MN 55438) was elected West Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1988. Don has been active in area activities from home group to intergroup board member, and served as Panel 33 Conference delegate. He was trained as a civil engineer, was an officer of an international construction company and has served on the boards of several construction and engineering companies. Don, who is now retired, chairs the General Sharing Session of the quarterly board meetings, and serves on the C.P.C. and Correctional Facilities Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Ann Bruning (10728 Hunters Point Rd., Fort Smith, AR 72903), who was a Panel 37 delegate, was elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1991. Ann has served her area as G.S.R., area chair, and has been active in P.I. work, mostly in schools. A registered nurse, Ann now works at an in-hospital hospice, and serves on the boards of several community organizations, as well as presenting workshops for various organizations. Ann serves on the Archives, Conference, International Convention/Regional Forums and Public Information Committees.

¹**Phil J. Cels** (5 Balmoral Bay, Brandon, MB, R7A 6E5 Canada), who was elected Western Canada trustee in April 1988, served as a Panel 32 Conference delegate. He is involved in C.P.C. and

P.I. work for Southwest Manitoba, as well as being active in local A.A. activities. Phil now manages a paper recycling project. He chairs the International Convention/Regional Forums Committees and serves on the Conference, Literature and Nominating Committees.

²**Gerry Flegel** (Box 1246, Humboldt, Saskatchewan, S0K 2A0 Canada), who was elected Western Canada regional trustee in May 1992, is a former Panel 38 delegate. He now chairs the P.I./C.P.C. committee in Humboldt. Gerry has taught in high schools for 28 years. For the past ten years he has been a computer and math consultant—but is now back in the classroom.

Harold Greene (695 Americana Dr., Annapolis, MD 21403) was elected general service trustee in April 1989. Harold's service commitment began at the group level in Staten Island, N.Y.; he has served as a D.C.M. and as a member of the N.Y. Intergroup Steering Committee. From 1985-88 he was a director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Harold currently heads an agency involved in developing and financing rehabilitation of housing for the homeless. He serves on the Archives, Conference and Finance & Budgetary Committees and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Jacob B. "Jake" Ham (RFD 1, Box 1400, Winthrop, ME 04364) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1991. Jake began his service work in California as G.S.R., D.C.M., and H&I coordinator. After returning to his home state of Maine in 1980, Jake served in similar service jobs, including Maine area chair, and was a Panel 38 delegate. In his spare time, away from his job, he enjoys carpentry, gardening and camping. Jake serves on the Archives, International, International Convention/Regional Forums and Literature Committees.

²**Les Leuthaeuser** (1912 Ave. B, Scottsbluff, NE 69361) was elected West Central U.S. regional trustee in May 1992. In service work for over 20 years, Les was a Panel 30 delegate and has served as area chair and area finance committee chair. He is self-employed in the home improvement/repair business.

Jacqueline (Jackie) Martin (1305 Bluff Springs Ct., Louisville, KY 40223) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 1989. A Panel 30 delegate, Jackie has been active in her area's intergroup and treatment facilities committees and is past president of the Kentucky Alcoholism Council. With a background in real estate, Jackie recently went back to school to prepare for a new career in management. She chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board and also serves on the Conference, Finance & Budgetary, and International Convention/Regional Forum Committees.

Greg Muth (P.O. Box 30668, Honolulu, HI 96820) was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in April 1990. Greg, who has been active from group coffee maker on, served as a Panel 37 delegate, when he chaired the Conference Report and Charter Committee. An executive of a commercial construction company, he is also involved in local community organizations. Greg chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the International and Nominating Committees. He is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

David F. O'Leary (37 Wabush Pl., St. John's, NF, Canada A1E 5V5) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1991. A Panel 35 delegate from Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador, David has remained active in his area, serving on intergroup, convention and institutions committees. He is a maintenance technician with a large corporation. David serves on the Archives, Conference, Correctional Facilities and International Committees.

Marc Pineau (185 - 14th Ave., Iberville, PQ J2X 1B5, Canada), who was a Panel 36 delegate, was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1990. He has served as G.S.R., D.C.M. and area

secretary and chair. Marc is an engineer with a Canadian corporation, where he has participated in employees' programs, as well as setting up other rehabilitation programs. He serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, Finance & Budgetary and International Committees. Marc also serves on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

²**Fran Polek** (2301 E. 61st Ave., Spokane, WA 99223) was elected general service trustee in May 1992, after serving four years as a Grapevine director. A Panel 27 delegate, Fran also served as area chair. During his time as a director, he served as treasurer of the Grapevine Corporate Board and as a member of the trustees' Literature Committee and International Committee. Fran is a university professor, involved in teaching, research, lecturing, and writing.

John J. Quinn (66 Brookwood Pkwy., Jackson, NJ 08527) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 1989. A Panel 35 delegate, he has also served his area as D.C.M., treasurer and area committee member. With a background in accounting, taxation and personnel, John is currently a first vice-president of a major international bank with U.S. headquarters in New York City. He chairs the International Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary, Nominating and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Stanley N. Silverman (137 E. 36th St., New York, NY 10016), who was elected a general service trustee in April 1989, served on the Grapevine editorial board and later on the Grapevine Corporate Board from 1983-87. During that time he was a member of the trustees' Finance & Budgetary, Retirement, International, Literature, C.P.C. and Correctional Facilities Committees, as well as serving as treasurer of the Grapevine. Active at the group level, Stanley is a member of the American Institute of C.P.A.s and the New York State Society of C.P.A.s, and is a partner in a New York certified public accounting firm. He is chairperson of the Public Information Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and International Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Jean Smith (100 Bank St., New York, NY 10014) was elected general service trustee in April 1990. Jean has served on the Grapevine editorial board and was an A.A.W.S. director from 1987 to 1990, when she served on several trustees' committees. She is a senior vice-president of a publishing company and a division director. Jean chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community and Nominating Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

¹**J. Desmond Towey** (425 E. 58th St., #4H, New York, NY 10022) was elected general service trustee in April 1988. Des' introduction to service work was as a consultant on the trustees' Public Information Committee. He is owner and president of a firm specializing in shareholder relations and marketing financial products. He serves on the Nominating, Public Information and Treatment Facilities Committees. He also serves on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Jan Whitney (9700 Avalon Rd., Greenville, MI 48838) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 1989. A Panel 36 delegate, she has served as area secretary, chairperson for the area assembly, and program chair for area conferences. She also served as area Grapevine chairperson, and chaired the board of the local chapter of N.C.A. Now retired, Jan's professional background was in business and real estate. She serves on the Finance & Budgetary, International Convention/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees. Jan also chairs the A.A.W.S. Board.

¹ Rotating at the close of the 1992 Conference meeting.

² New trustee, elected by the General Service Board, May 1992.

A.A. World Services Directors

Jan Whitney, <i>chairperson</i>	Michael McPherson
Hugh Freyer	Greg Muth
Eileen Gatz	Everett Smethurst
Harold Greene	Jean Smith

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Jacqueline Martin, <i>chairperson</i>	Jane Murphy Schulberg
Bernard Benziger	Stanley Silverman
John King	Ames Sweet
Marc Pineau	Desmond Towey
Fran Polek	Ann Warner

General Service Office Staff

George Dorsey, <i>general manager</i>	Valerie O'Neill
Richard Bush	Sarah Price
Lois Fisher	Pat Rosenstiel
Eileen Gatz	Helen Turnquest
John Grant	Susan Ulseth
Joanie Moncrief	Tom Jasper, <i>services director</i>
Daniel Mooney	Frank Mauser, <i>archivist</i>

Grapevine Staff

Ames Sweet Ann Warner

Others Assisting the Conference (*nonvoting*)

Caryl Bertolino, *staff assistant*
Rosa Blanco, *financial secretary*
Joseph Dennon, *staff assistant*
John de Stefano, *editor*
Yee Eng, *staff assistant*
Lynda Maziarz, *staff assistant*
Owen Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*
Al Herr, *artist*, Conference Report
Margie Janicek, *receptionist*
John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller/business administration*
Elizabeth Lopez, *manager, support services department*
Vinnie McCarthy, *publications director*
Don Meurer, *controller, A.A.W.S.*
John Nayduch, *Grapevine art director/designer*, Conference Report
Carol Pickett, *clerical*
Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*
Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
Bob Scherer, *Grapevine controller*
Frank Segui, *staff assistant*
Joan Smith, *staff assistant*
Naomi Strassberg, *Grapevine administrative assistant*
Cynthia White, *staff assistant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird* Box 4-5-9, Conference Report

Trustee emeritus

Gordon Patrick

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 42nd Conference includes Panel 41 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 42 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	41	Bill McCaa, 2141 Vasco Dr., Lillian, AL 36549
Alaska	2	42	O.B. Culley, Box 783, Soldotna, AK 99669-0783
Arizona	3	42	Bert Kluthe, Box 2669, 1004 Sparrow Ln., VL3, Camp Verde, AZ 86322
Arkansas	4	41	G. David Jimerson, 3032 Quail Dr., Jonesboro, AR 72401
California Southern	5	41	Jacqueline Johnston, 1169 Nottingham Circle, Westlake Village, CA 91361
Northern Coastal	6	41	Barbara Madger, 4368 Ridgecrest Pl., Eureka, CA 95501
Northern Interior	7	42	Bill Cross, 4588 N. Meridian, Fresno, CA 93726
San Diego/Imperial	8	42	Paul Cleary, 140 Fourth St., Del Mar, CA 92014
Mid-Southern	9	42	Jim Clough, 1873 Parkview Circle, Costa Mesa, CA 92627
Colorado	10	41	Robert Greenfield, 6852 Palace Dr., Colorado Springs, CO 80918
Connecticut	11	41	Hugh Cochrane, 50 Spruce Peak Ln., West Haven, CT 06516
Delaware	12	42	Douglas Tolley, Box 479, 3 Tingle St., Ocean View, DE 19970
District of Columbia	13	41	Richard Patch, 19803 Wheelwright Dr., Gaithersburg, MD 20879-1048
Florida North	14	41	Thomas Duffy, Rt. 4, Box 4500, Monticello, FL 32344-9300
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I.	15	41	Richard La Gasse, 4820 Sawyer Rd., Sarasota, FL 34233
Georgia	16	42	Bo Welch, Rt. 1, Box 68, Poulan, GA 31781
Hawaii	17	41	David Every, R.R.1, Box 391, #203, Wailuku, HI 96793

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Idaho	18	42	Carlos Flores, 4842 Cole Rd., Pocatello, ID 83202	Missouri Eastern	38	41	Jimmy Matheny, 5967 Webb Rd., Hillsboro, MO 63050
Illinois Chicago	19	41	Frank Berls, 7938 S. Albany Ave., Chicago, IL 60652	Western	39	41	Connie Wesley, 5110 S. Delaware, Independence, MO 64055
Northern	20	42	Thomas Barlow, 609 Clarke Ave., Waukegan, IL 60085	Montana	40	42	Robert Halvorson, 2104 Rd. 4 North, Huntley, MT 59037
Southern	21	41	Elmer Chaney, R.R.6, Box 44, Decatur, IL 62521	Nebraska	41	42	Barry Waddell, 1710 King St., Sidney, NE 69162
Indiana Northern	22	41	Klaus Kroeber, 2616 Garden Park Dr., Fort Wayne, IN 46825	Nevada	42	41	Julian Rhinehart, 1127 Seno Court, Boulder City, NV 89005
Southern	23	42	Charles (Chuck) Hickson, 1124 North East St., Lebanon, IN 46052	New Hampshire	43	42	John Sweeney, 8 Donald St., Manchester, NH 03102
Iowa	24	41	Rodney Brown, 4100 73rd St., Urbandale, IA 50322	New Jersey Northern	44	41	June (Al) Smith, 129 Smith St., Newark, NJ 07106
Kansas	25	42	Richard Brummel, 300 N. Cedar, Garnett, KS 66032	Southern	45	42	Jack Layden, Box 3724, Cherry Hill, NJ 08034
Kentucky	26	42	Joseph Sostarich, 2210 Douglas Woods Court, Louisville, KY 40205	New Mexico	46	42	Richard Clark, Box 22536, Santa Fe, NM 87502-2536
Louisiana	27	41	Sidney Mayeux, 459 Mayfair Dr., Bossier City, LA 71111	New York Central	47	41	George Croop, 212 Groton Ave., Cortland, NY 13045-1814
Maine	28	42	Cena Robbins, Box 1147, Scarborough, ME 04070	Hudson/Mohawk /Berkshire	48	42	Carolina Bradley, 511 E. German St., Herkimer, NY 13350
Maryland	29	42	John Curtin, 11510 Georgia Ave., #225, Wheaton, MD 20902	Southeast	49	41	James Downes, 2584 Stedman Pl., Bronx, NY 10469
Massachusetts Eastern	30	41	*Ronald Gauthier, 44 Merrill Ave., Lynn, MA 01902	Western	50	42	Terry Wymer, 824 N. Union St., Olean, NY 14760
Western	31	42	Thomas Lawrence, 34 C St. Kolbe Dr., Holyoke, MA 01040	North Carolina	51	41	James Key, 4342 Witherow Rd., Winston-Salem, NC 27106
Michigan Central	32	41	Harland Sercombe, 6723 Hawkins Rd., Jackson, MI 49201	North Dakota	52	42	Vail Jensen, 2017 Seventh Ave. E., Williston, ND 58801
Southeast	33	41	Kenneth Kendrick, 22601 Essex Way, Apt. 625, Southfield, MI 48034-3331	Ohio Central & Southeast	53	41	Glenn Wyckoff, 4121 Burnell Rd., Columbus, OH 43224
Western	34	42	Anna (Cush) Cushman, 831 Reed St., Kalamazoo, MI 49001	Northeast	54	41	Norbert Haase, 1937 19th St., S.W., Akron, OH 44314
Minnesota Northern	35	42	Gregory Gits, Box 753, Bemidji, MN 56601-0753	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	55	42	Vivien Gerten, 323 Ridge St. S., Willard, OH 44890
Southern	36	41	Dennis Bauer, 410 N. Orchard St., Northfield, MN 55057	Southwest	56	42	Dian Wright, 450 Wilson Rd., Troy, OH 45373
Mississippi	37	42	Howard Lowery, Box 684, Columbia, MS 39429	Oklahoma	57	41	Ottis Dimick, 11004 SE 28th, Midwest City, OK 73130
				Oregon	58	42	Helen McConnell, 8480 S.W. Cecelia Terrace, Portland, OR 97223
				Pennsylvania Eastern	59	41	Marcia Goldblatt, 4719 Fowler St., Philadelphia, PA 19127

* Unable to attend Conference. Alternate delegate Robert McElroy was seated.

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Pennsylvania Western	60	41	Maxine Miller, Box 124, Polk, PA 16342
Rhode Island	61	42	MaryJane Roy, 65 Narragansett Ave., Narragansett, RI 02882
South Carolina	62	42	Joe McGarity, Box 1515, Irma, SC 29063
South Dakota	63	42	Ted Stoa, 402 S. Kline St., Aberdeen, SD 57401
Tennessee	64	42	John Wampler, 505 E. Scott Ave., Knoxville, TN 37917
Texas Northeast	65	41	Jude Tims, Rt. 5, Box 134, Waxahachie, TX 75165
Northwest	66	42	Bob Barnes, 19 Concord Rd., San Angelo, TX 76903
Southeast	67	41	Linda O'Brien, 5918 Valkeith Dr., Houston, TX 77096
Southwest	68	42	Jim Burke, 14210 Fairlee, San Antonio, TX 78217
Utah	69	41	Don Huff, 3628 S. 3325 W., West Valley City, UT 84109
Vermont	70	42	*Harold Douse, Box 283, Milton, VT 05468
Virginia	71	41	Joe Sullivan, 10001 Twin Valley Rd., Richmond, VA 23235-1881
Washington	72	41	Susan Terrell, 209 E. 8th St., Aberdeen, WA 98520
West Virginia	73	41	Patrick Hogan, Rt., 3, Box 11, Harpers Ferry, WV 25425
Wisconsin N. Wisconsin/ Up. Pen. Mich.	74	42	Chuck Stokes, 133 W. Grant Ave., Eau Claire, WI 54701
Southern	75	41	William Hellesen, 1233 Layard Ave., Racine, WI 53402
Wyoming	76	42	Wayne Reed, Box 97, Guernsey, WY 82214
Puerto Rico	77	42	Santiago (Chago) Rodriguez, 20 St. Block 52, #2 Santa Rosa, Bayamon, PR 00959

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/ Northwest Territories	78	42	Elaine Strome, 9 Elizabeth Dr., Ft. Saskatchewan, AB T8L 2M2

* New Panel 42 delegate. Former delegate Judith Ressler resigned due to health.

British Columbia/ Yukon	79	41	William (Doug) Bailey, Box 54, Black Creek, BC V0R 1C0
Manitoba	80	42	Edward Prince, 5-105 Main St., Selkirk, MB R1A 1R2
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	81	42	Melvin Larkin, 20 Vista Dr., Charlottetown, PEI C1A 3J9
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/ Labrador	82	41	Michael Bruce, Box 222, Port Hawkesbury, NS B0E 2V0
Ontario Eastern	83	41	Bernard Sullivan, 1459 Glencairn Ave., Peterborough, ON K9J 6S2
Northeast	84	41	Scott McLarty, 526 Parliament St., Sault Ste. Marie, ON P6C 3M7
Northwest	85	41	Marne Crary, 270 Harrington Ave., Thunder Bay, ON P7A 3T3
Western	86	42	John (Jack) Griffith, 252 Ferrier Ave., LeFroy, ON L0L 1W0
Quebec Southwest	87	42	Paul Baatz, 4823 Hutchison, Montreal, PQ H2V 4A4
Southeast	88	41	Hugues Samson, 15, rue Theroux, Arthabaska, PQ G6P 5R8
Northeast	89	41	Robert Pare, 4675 boul. des Cimes, Quebec, PQ G2A 3X9
Northwest	90	42	Michel Girard, 67 Boul Aubert, Repentigny, PQ J6A 4N9
Saskatchewan	91	42	Verna Robinson, 1424 Ninth Ave. N., Saskatoon, SK S7K 2Z5

